

CONFERENCE '74

Theme:

Understanding and Cooperation—Inside and Outside A.A.

Twenty-Fourth

Annual Meeting

of the

General Service Conference

(U.S. and Canada)

of

Alcoholics Anonymous

Hotel Roosevelt

New York

April 22-27, 1974



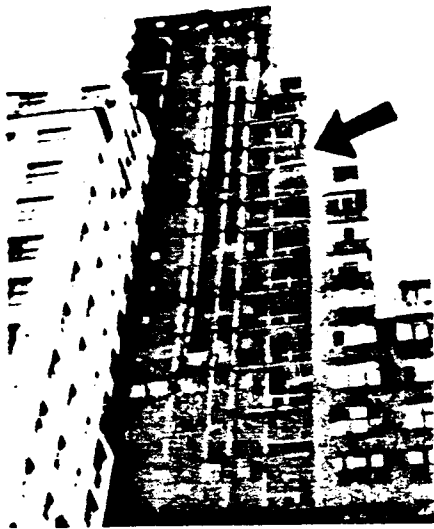
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EXPLOSION

Conference week in New York began with a bang that was not funny. The 25-story commercial building at 305 E. 45th St. was ripped by a massive explosion just before 7:00 a.m. Monday. Familiar address? Yes, G.S.O. was located there, on the 18th floor, from 1960 to 1970, before it moved to 468 Park Avenue South.

The blast awakened some delegates at the Hotel Roosevelt, four blocks away, and scattered debris and broke windows for blocks around.



An A.A. member may order a copy of this report through his G.S.R. or other group officer. Traditionally, all members have the right of access to information about all phases of A.A.'s general services. This report is "confidential" only because in it certain members must be identified by name (on "dotted line" pages, 41-46). The "confidential" designation protects the personal anonymity of such members at the public level.



ELECTORAL MAP OF U.S. & CANADA

How the 24th Conference Started

Asking for a moment of silence to remember those in A.A. who have gone before us, John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris, M.D. (nonalcoholic), chairman of the General Service Board and of the Conference, opened the first formal session of the 24th General Service Conference Monday morning.

It was attended by 44 Panel 23 and 47 Panel 24 delegates from U.S. and Canadian areas, plus 42 other voting Conference members (see p. 41).

Dr. Jack described the Conference as a way of exploring and learning the group conscience of A.A. as a whole. Then he introduced Matt N., regional trustee from Calgary, Alta., who gave the keynote talk (summarized on p. 6) on the Conference theme: "Understanding and Cooperation – Inside and Outside A.A."

When he began with "My name is Matt, and I am an alcoholic," the hearty "Hi, Matt!" chorused by those in the room established the usual Conference tone of friendliness to speakers which prevailed all week.

After the keynote, the taped voice of Bill W. was heard in "How We Learned to Serve," part of a talk the late co-founder gave at A.A.'s Second International Convention, in St. Louis in 1955, when the Fellowship "officially" accepted the Third Legacy, of Service, by approving the annual Conference as a replacement for the leadership and guidance first furnished by A.A.'s earliest members.

(The talk is on page 10 of this report.)

Dr. Jack's Monday-morning board report to the Conference is on page 20 of this report.

At the first session, Don P., Colo., chairman of the Delegates-Only meeting, introduced the Conference committee chairpersons. Bob H., G.S.O. general manager, introduced the G.S.O. staff and department heads, before reviewing the "ground rules" customarily followed at previous Conferences.

All present agreed that "the sense of the meeting" is frequently more desirable than formal motions and votes; that only Conference members should attend Conference sessions (except the opening dinner); and that no photographing or private taping be done during sessions.

Bob also pointed out the ever-present bell traditionally rung when a speaker ran overtime, and the Ask-It Basket for anonymous questions.

Cora Louise B., Conference secretary, described A.A. structure as the means through which A.A. delivers its service, which is carrying the message. Then she reviewed the agenda.

To open successive morning sessions, the following delegates agreed to read the General Warranties of the Conference, the Twelve

Concepts for World Service, the Traditions, and the Steps respectively: Travis H., West Monroe, La.; Zeb M., Newport, N.C.; Gus J., Warren, Mich.; Ike B., Salt Lake City, Utah.

John N., Louisville, Ill., Bill P., Altamonte Springs, Fla., Jim S., Fort Wayne, Ind., and Paul C., St. Charles, Mo., agreed to close the daily sessions in turn by leading the Serenity Prayer; Lucille T., Urich, Mo., to close Friday's last session by leading the Lord's Prayer.

The opening-night dinner was attended by over 250, including delegates' spouses, former trustees, G.S.O. employees and volunteers, the Al-Anon Family Group Headquarters staff, Lois W., and other guests.

Marcel L., delegate from Arthabaska, Que., led the A.A. meeting after dinner, at which speakers were delegates Anna K., Little Rock, Ark., George E., Charleston, W. Va., and Virginia H., Shorewood, Wis.

Digest of Agenda

Monday, April 22

Welcome and Keynote
Taped Talk by Bill W.
Area Delegate Chairman
Conference Committee Chairmen
G.S.O. and Grapevine Staffs
General Service Board Report
Presentation and Workshop: A.A.'s Relations
With Professionals in the Alcoholism Field
Opening Dinner and A.A. Meeting

Tuesday, April 23

Report on Professional Relations Workshop
Reports of A.A.W.S., Grapevine, and Trustees' Committees
Trustees' and Conference Committee Meetings
Presentation and Discussion: Special-Purpose Groups
Unstructured Workshop

Wednesday, April 24

Presentation and Discussion: *World Directory*
Conference Committee Meetings
Presentation and Discussion: Electoral Procedures for Regional Trustees
Regional Trustee Elections
Special Session

Thursday, April 25

Plans for Inside-A.A. Survey
Presentation, Discussion, Workshop, and Workshop Report: Relationship of Central Offices (Intergroups) and General Service Committees
Tour of G.S.O. and Grapevine Office
Delegates-Only Session

Friday, April 26

Committee Reports
International Convention Report
Discussion Topics
Conference Evaluation Questionnaires

Saturday, April 27

Brunch and A.A. Meeting
Trip to Stepping Stones

PERSONAL SERVICE HIGHLIGHTS: Each day, Panel 24 delegates reported their own service experience.

ASK-IT BASKET: Questions submitted anonymously from the floor were answered and discussed at several sessions.

Conference Uses New Procedure To Name Five Regional Trustees

Five new regional (Class B – that is, A.A. members) trustees were named for four-year terms on the General Service Board at the '74 Conference during a long, careful session Wednesday, April 24. They are:

Bruce W., Waukegan, Ill. – East Central U.S. (Ill., Ind., Mich., Ohio, Wis.), to succeed Jack M., Kalamazoo, Mich.

Stan W., Fairfax, Calif. – Pacific U.S. (Alsk., Ariz., Calif., Hawaii, Idaho, Nev., Oreg., Utah, Wash.), to succeed George G., Phoenix, Ariz.

Dave C., Raleigh, N.C. – Southeastern U.S. (Ala., Fla., Ga., Ky., La., Miss., N.C.,

Puerto Rico, S.C., Tenn., Va., W.Va.), to succeed Tom M., Pulaski, Tenn.

Peter W., Oakville, Ont. – Eastern Canada (Lab., N.B., Nfld., N.S., Ont., P.E.I., Que.), to succeed Bob R., Hull, Que.

Terry P., Brandon, Man. – Western Canada (Alta., B.C., Man., N.W. Terr., Sask., Yukon), to succeed Matt N., Calgary, Alta.

For brief biographies, see pp. 41-42. Formal "election" to the board occurred at the annual board meeting immediately following the Conference.

The five were chosen from a total field of 33 candidates, all rated as qualified by the

trustees' Nominating Committee at its February 3 meeting.

Procedure used for election was decided upon by the entire Conference before the new trustees were chosen.

Junior A., Needham Heights, Mass., Northeastern U.S. regional trustee and chairman of the trustees' Nominating Committee, and George E., delegate from Charleston, W.Va., chairman of the Conference Committee on Trustees, first made a presentation reviewing the history of the procedure for electing regional trustees as described in "The A.A. Service Manual" (p. 98), decided upon in 1963.

George noted that delegates to the 1964, 1965, 1969, 1971, 1972, and 1973 Conferences had all reviewed the procedure carefully. Various proposed changes had been rejected each time.

However, during the 1972 Conference meeting, there was some feeling that the distribution of votes (consisting of delegates

from the electing regions and members of both the trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees) could possibly be inequitable, George said.

Junior explained that in 1973 the trustees' committee had asked delegates to complete a questionnaire regarding the procedure, so results of the questionnaire could be used as a basis for a presentation to the '74 body.

Although 61% of the responding delegates said the 1963-73 procedure was satisfactory, Junior said, one of the eight suggested possible changes listed on the questionnaire received a large number of favorable votes. Therefore, the trustees' Nominating Committee decided to submit that change to the 1974 Conference, *without recommendation for or against*, for decision before the 1974 elections. It read:

"The trustees' Nominating Committee continue to review résumés for each candidate's eligibility for nomination. Voters to consist of delegates from the region involved,

plus an equal number of voters — half to come from the Conference Committee on Trustees and half to come from the trustees' Nominating Committee."

(The 1963-73 procedure called for voting by the *entire* trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees, plus delegates from the electing regions.)

The 1974 Conference voted to amend the Warranty of the Conference (a two-thirds vote was necessary for the change) by adopting the proposed new electoral procedure. By lot, names were drawn from the Conference and trustees' committees to reach a total equal to that of the number of regional delegates voting in each election.

Thereafter, the elections continued according to the usual Third Legacy procedure.

In a separate vote, the Conference also recommended a five-year moratorium on Conference discussion of these electoral procedures "to let time and experience teach us."

KEYNOTE

Cooperation Can Bring More Alcoholics to A.A.

The 1974 Conference theme is dear to my heart, and should be dear to all of us in the future.

In the olden days, we had our bleeding deacons, insisting that the way they did it was the *only* way. A.A. thinking should become more mature.

Last year, I heard an observation from the outside that we in A.A. might miss. While A.A. may have done a good job so far, we claim to have helped only about 5% of the alcoholics. What about the other 95%?

In 1960, Bill W. put the question "Where do we go from here? What is our responsibility for tomorrow? Some 25,000,000 men and women have suffered alcoholism since A.A. was founded. Nearly all of these are now sick, mad, or dead. A.A. has brought recovery to something like 250,000.

"The rest are still out of reach or gone beyond recall," our co-founder said. "Facing the gravity of this situation, shall any of us sit comfortably and say, 'Well, people, here we are. We hope you hear us and come around. Then maybe we can give you a hand?'"

More people are developing this disease each year than we reach through A.A. What can we do? Bill wrote a Grapevine article in 1958, "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends." Ask G.S.O. for a reprint.

About the first part of our Conference theme, cooperation *inside* A.A., I have a suggestion: When we say, "Let's Be Friendly

With Our Friends," why not start with each other?

Squabbles are going on in our Fellowship, within groups, among A.A.'s in and out of the field of alcoholism, between area committees and central offices. They aren't cooperating; they're downright competitive.

Honest differences of opinion should co-exist in A.A. But when our disagreements stand in the way of our primary purpose, we are in trouble.

We take a stand on "principle" or "tradition" and refuse to move, feeling virtuous about it. So does the other A.A. member or committee, also standing on principle as *they* interpret A.A. tradition.

Everybody is *standing*. Nobody carries the message. Everybody's too concerned with the controversy. We've seen these things drag on a long time, while a lot of alcoholics die.

STATISTICS

The average length of sobriety of the 91 delegates in 1974 was 13 years. In age, five delegates were under 40; 20, in their 40's; 43, in their 50's; 21, over 60. (Evidently, three weren't telling.) Fourteen of the delegates were women. A total of 31 spouses came to New York with delegates. Bob H., G.S.O. general manager, announced these statistics on opening day.

I suppose it is a miracle there isn't *more* controversy inside A.A. Does anyone deny we were at one time pretty argumentative, full of booze and boozy logic? Now we have to love each other or else, damn it!

In a workshop last year, our Honolulu friend suggested we return to visit the doctors who saw us as practicing alkie. We might tell the doctor "what it was like, what happened, and what it is like now." We must not give up. We must keep trying.

Understanding and cooperation with our friends in other fields are absolutely necessary if we are going to improve the percentage of those being helped.

An outstanding psychiatrist in Calgary does a lot of good for his alcoholic patients. He gives them the usual checkup, plus 586 questions. If they are alcoholic in his opinion he tells them they must go to A.A. for three months, then come back to see him. Very few patients come back. They either get the help they need in A.A. or find a new psychiatrist.

In Alberta, when a driver is convicted for impaired driving, he has a choice of going to an alcohol education class or going to jail. The results of this forced education are very encouraging, measured by the reduced number of repeaters in traffic courts and the reduced accident rate.

Treatment centers are springing up all over, and some of us fear these institutions as competitors. I hope we can eliminate this feeling, because we need these friends. Under-

standing and cooperation on our part will do more to eliminate friction than anything else. We should be extending our hand in friendship to all institutions if we believe in the Twelfth Step. Then we would be "practicing these principles in all our affairs." We can stay with the bleeding-deacon philosophy — and remain static. Or we can reach out our hand to all endeavoring to help the alcoholic — and grow.

Bill asked, "What of the millions of alcoholics who haven't yet hit prison, asylums, or skid row? These constitute the vast majority. At the moment, their best hope of recovery seems to be A.A. Well then, why haven't these millions come to us?"

"Any A.A.," Bill said, "can give a quick answer: 'They aren't ready.'"

"More than anything, the answer seems to be education," according to Bill. "Education in the schoolrooms, medical schools, among clergy, employers, families, and for the public at large."

It is up to us at this Conference to expand our thinking, so others, too, will be friendly with our friends. We certainly will not agree with all non-A.A. philosophies, but we must be tolerant. We made a lot of errors in our own early days. We must overcome any idea that we have the only solution. We must be open-minded about the approaches of others. Even if others are wrong, they will stimulate more education. Drug publicity has helped educate the public to understand that alcohol is the drug most used, and that alcoholism is 85% of the entire drug problem.

Anything that helps the alcoholic in the direction of recovery through education is good. Maybe we need to grow in "Understanding and Cooperation — Inside and Outside A.A.," so we can have peace of mind inside, and a strong helping handful of love to offer those outside.

— Matt N., regional trustee, Western Canada

'Walk Hand in Hand'

Lois W., widow of co-founder Bill W., closed the last official Conference session with a brief talk, summarized here.

I never know at a moment like this whether I am in Al-Anon or A.A. They are both my loves. A.A. was my first love. Al-Anon is an interpretation of A.A. for the families of alcoholics.

It was quite a while after Bill got sober before I realized that I, too, needed principles to live by. I had thought I already had enough

principles and was doing very well, thank you.

Something that kept me confused was the extent of my dependence on Bill. He and I were very close, because all our family and friends had gone away from us. We had just each other to depend on. I depended—emotionally—more on him than he on me.

Bill was always so very, very repentant after being drunk. At first, he had thought he could stop when he got ready, but when he wanted to, he could not. He then became one of the saddest sights anyone could ever see — a person without hope. He just sat at home and drank. So I had to take many responsibilities, particularly the financial.

When Bill finally sobered up, as I had hoped for for so long, I thought I was very happy. Bill wanted to sober up all the drunks in the world, and I thought he was bringing half of them home!

Then something woke me up. One evening, he made a mild remark about our getting ready to go to a meeting, and I got furious and threw my shoe at him. It did not bother him, but it shocked me that I had lost my temper over such a harmless remark.

It took a long time, but by degrees I realized I had been resentful that I hadn't brought about Bill's recovery. After all those years of my suffering and trying, someone else came along and did it in two minutes! I was jealous. Now he didn't need me any more. Who was I? What was I supposed to be doing?

Bill and I began to notice that in other cases the family and home situations didn't always change and get happy although people got sober. Slowly, we saw that something was needed for these families. As Bill put it, "They need to sober up, too."

So much martyrdom, possessiveness, suffering, and direction-giving gone through by the spouse are habits hard to change. Eventually, some of us family members began to meet together to do something about *ourselves*.

In the late 1940's, Bill went around the country and found there were many of these groups spontaneously formed, but they seemed somewhat shapeless and lacking in direction. He asked me to help start a sort of "General Service Office" for these family groups, and that is now the Al-Anon Family Group Headquarters.

An alcoholic's problem is quite obvious. But the family's troubles are more subtle and can be seen only very slowly.

Having just come from the 14th Al-Anon Conference, I am still as confused as ever about whether I am in A.A. or Al-Anon. But I do believe God wants both Fellowships to walk hand in hand as long as He shall need them.

From Five Trustees, Moving Au Revoirs

A bit weary but noticeably happy, 1974 Conference members gathered for the closing breakfast Saturday morning, and heard the five departing G.S. Board members emotionally bid "So long!" in their last talks as trustees, given here in condensed form.

'You Need Never Walk Alone'

Forty years ago, a man not too far from death, suffering the anguish known to the damned, cried out for help.

It was, of course, Bill W. Thereafter, he put his hand in the hand of God and never walked alone again. I think Elizabeth Barrett Browning would not mind if I used about Bill these words of hers: "The face of all the world is changed, I think, / Since first I heard the footsteps of thy soul / Move still, oh, still, beside me, as they stole / Betwixt me and the dreadful outer brink / Of obvious death, where I, who thought to sink, / Was caught up into love, and taught the whole / Of life in a new rhythm."

Like Mary Baker Eddy, Bill did not keep what he had to himself, but gave it to others. Now, thousands of other alcoholics need never walk alone.

How fortunate we are to be his heirs!

In 1923, the nine greatest business tycoons of America met in Chicago. Twenty-five years later, someone followed up on all of them. Three had committed suicide; many had been imprisoned; one was a penniless exile. None of them had the good fortune you A.A.'s have to do Twelfth Step work and help other people. They were all destined to die alone.

In my nine years on the board, I have been trying to understand the *raison d'être* for nonalcoholic trustees. I guess if we can't constitutionally become alcoholics, at least we can arrive here with you by the pathway of service. As a result, I have made lasting friendships with people all over the world.

Au revoir, and thank you, my friends, for your comradeship of a decade, or of a single hour. Thank you for taking me in, too, so that I never need to walk alone.

— Travis E. Dancey, M.D., Montreal, Que.

'I'll Go to Meetings and Do Anything Asked'

When I started my sobriety, a man said the first thing I had to do was admit I didn't have all the answers. "When you're green, you grow; when you're ripe, you fall," he said.

(continued)

I never found a happy medium in life, not in drinking and not in A.A. At first, I worried about where I was going to use all the outbursts of emotion and energy I had had while drinking. Could I use them on my job? What kind of A.A. was I going to be at home?

One A.A. friend said that the more good thoughts you have, the less room there is for negative ones.

In 1968, my oldest son, Bob, was killed in Vietnam. Because of A.A., I have been able to keep good thoughts in my head about him, instead of crying, "Why, oh why?"

A.A. has been so good to me, there's no way I can express it. And now I'm leaving as a grateful trustee—particularly grateful to the A.A.'s in all five states of my region.

People say I'll miss being on the board, and ask what I'm going to do. Well, I'll just keep going to meetings and do anything they ask, and try to "practice these principles" in all my affairs.

—Jack M., Kalamazoo, Mich.

'Thank You, God, for Everybody'

This is the worst spot I've ever been in during my A.A. life. First, I want to express my gratitude and admiration for G.S.O. They even found a map of North America that actually showed Pulaski, Tennessee, on it!

However, when I saw it, I realized I was just a pinhead — and after today, just a pin-hole.

I have to tell you that my oldest son came into A.A., and I hadn't even known he had a problem! At first, I actually resented it. "Why me?" I asked.

But then I said, "Fool, be thankful!" And I am. He has been very active and has not had a drink since joining.

Over 23 years ago, my own sponsor was a nonalcoholic, a young Episcopal minister who had gone to the Yale School. He was himself a teetotaler, but he started an A.A. group from which many others have sprung.

Three months ago, I learned that he had come into A.A., in Texas, as a member. I just had to call him. He said, "Over 23 years ago, you said I helped you. I'm coming to Tennessee this summer, because I want you to help me." Believe me, tears flowed from Tennessee to Texas and back.

When I first came to A.A., I wanted the whole program right now. Six months later, I told that sponsor I didn't feel anything spiritual. He asked, "Are you asking God for sobriety each day? Thanking Him for it each night? Trying daily to improve your relationships with your fellowman?" When I said yes to all three, he said, "Don't worry."

About a year later, walking on the street one day, I realized I had got into a spiritual contact. It was just by developing the habit of saying ten or more times a day, to myself,

what I say to you now: "Thank you, God, for everybody."

—Tom M., Pulaski, Tenn.

'Less Fun, More Pleasure'

Hi, ladies and gentlemen and fellow has-beens. I'm so excited that even my nitroglycerin pills don't help.

It is with real regret I have to resign. I sincerely thank all of you for letting me serve. I have found we all have so much to learn. Maybe some of us have less fun now than in our drinking days — but we have more pleasure.

Now, in the mornings, instead of looking at ourselves in the toilet bowl — fun? — we see ourselves in the mirror. Pleasure.

A young relative of mine developed alcoholism rapidly. One morning, he staggered to breakfast looking horrible, with tears streaming from his eyes, his nose, and his ears. His young wife looked at him sadly and said, "Do you *have* to do that?"

He replied, "No, I just like it!"

To quote that great baseball philosopher Yogi Berra when his Mets had a disastrous season, "We made too many of the wrong mistakes." But they got us here. And I can't help remembering at this moment the words faith, hope, and love. And the greatest of these is love — which is what our service is all about.

—Matt N., Calgary, Alta.

'Rotation Means Sharing So Others Can Serve'

Fifteen years ago, I was a desperate drunk, friendless, with no place to go, with no idea what to do next. I made a prayer: "Please, after 25 miserable years, take me out of the dark."

I did not know I had ever heard of A.A., but like a light it flashed into my head, and I called it. Twenty minutes later, a man was at my door. I knew I had got what I asked for. He became my sponsor.

He talked to me about service, told me to make myself available wherever possible. Five years later, I was a delegate, and 11 years after that, a trustee. On that first dark night, I never dreamed this Fellowship could offer me so much.

As a trustee, I've learned of the magnitude of A.A. and that I can serve more and more and more.

Rotation is a wonderful idea. It is a way of sharing, of thinking of others, so others can serve, so all A.A. can go and grow.

Sometimes we ask, as Bill did, "Why me? Why am I so blessed, not my next-door neighbor?"

Maybe it is because we feel a need to be of service. Serving gave me a chance to come to admire so much our nonalcoholic friends on this board. I am so grateful they serve, without even needing to, without suffering our problem.

I was told, "Once a trustee, always a trustee." Once we get service into our hearts, we see so much that needs to be done. I plan to carry on doing it. This is not *adieu*, but *au revoir*.

—Robert R., Hull, Que.

'Looking for What I Was Lacking'

Two guys came to, sitting in an old, beat-up car in a junkyard. One said, "Joe, I think we got thrown away."

That's the way I felt before A.A. They used to call me the Drunken Swede. That didn't bother me. I'm Norwegian.

Beginning at the age of 17, I spent seven years on skid row. I wasn't running away. I was looking for what I was lacking. It was my God.

I found Him in A.A., at age 35.

An oldtimer asked me, "You're so young, are you *sure* you're an alcoholic?"

I thought, "Oh, my God, do I have to drink again?" I had had problems with pills, too, but I was afraid to tell anybody. You might kick me out.

"Just going to meetings" has not made me an A.A., any more than just sitting in a hen house would make me a hen. I had to work the Twelve Steps, in order.

The George that used to be had to die—using the Fourth and Fifth Steps. Now I have been given a brand-new life. But it has not all been easy.

I have prayed for tolerance—and been sent people I couldn't get along with! I've had to learn to pray for people who give me resentments.

Some folks speak of a day when there will be a "cure" for alcoholism. Will there be a pill that gives me faith, love, honor, and the other things I have found in A.A.?

I have to keep on serving God. As long as He asks, I have to go. But I can't give it away if I haven't earned it through our Twelve Steps, our Traditions, and service. It's only in *doing* that I can show my gratitude, not just in talking about it. I think if we always build on the rock of gratitude, we'll always have our house of service.

I probably need A.A. now far more than I ever did. I'll know I have it made when St. Peter says to me, "Have a drink, George," and I can say, "No thanks, I don't want one, today."

Maybe we are called the "trustees," but I think you delegates are the real trustees of A.A. It is in your hands. *Vaya con Dios*.

—George G., Phoenix, Ariz.

Understanding and Cooperation

PRESENTATIONS
AND WORKSHOPS

...Outside A.A.

Lights in the Hotel Roosevelt Terrace Room dimmed as soon as the first set of Personal Service Highlights ended Monday afternoon. Suddenly, above the podium glowed a giant photo of the late Dr. W. D. Silkworth.

And in the darkness the words of co-founder Bill W. were heard, read by G.S. trustee Robert M., Pleasant Valley, Conn., chairman of the board's Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community. (For the committee report, see p. 23.)

It was the leadoff of the committee's pictorial presentation on understanding and cooperation between A.A.'s earliest members and nonalcoholic professionals — an inspiring example for A.A.'s today. Here are highlights:

Nonalcoholic medical director of Towns Hospital, New York, "Silky was [in Bill's words] the benign little doctor who loved drunks, very much a founder of A.A. From him, we learned the nature of our illness: the *obsession of the mind* that compels us to drink and the *allergy of the body* that condemns us to go mad or die. . . . In close cooperation with A.A., Silky ministered to over 10,000 alcoholics.

"It was from the Rev. Samuel Shoemaker, nonalcoholic rector of Calvary Church, New York, that Dr. Bob and I in the beginning absorbed most of the principles that were afterward embodied in the Twelve Steps."

The value of the many contributions of nonalcoholic psychiatrist Dr. Harry M. Tiebout, Greenwich, Conn., is "beyond calculation. . . . He held up A.A. for his professional colleagues and for the public to see, and . . . he continued to endorse A.A. and its work to the psychiatric profession."

Bernard B. Smith, New York, nonalcoholic attorney, "served so faithfully and brilliantly during the planning years of the G.S. Conference. His singular skill and ability to reconcile different viewpoints were deciding factors in the formation of the Conference upon which A.A.'s future so heavily depends."

Nonalcoholic Sister Mary Ignatia of the Sisters of Charity of St. Augustine, St. Thomas Hospital, Akron, Ohio, later in Cleveland at St. Vincent Charity Hospital's Rosary Hall, "in 1939 developed that great partnership between Dr. Bob and herself. . . . The ministry of Dr. Bob, his nonalcoholic wife Anne, Sr. Ignatia, and Akron's early-timers set an example . . . that will remain for all time."

In 1935, co-founder Dr. Bob S. helped form the first A.A. group in Akron. "Who could express the gratitude of the 5,000 sick alcoholics he gave a physician's care to?"

"In Dr. Bob's words, 'I was just another alcoholic trying to get along. . . . Forget me, but go you and do likewise. Add your own link to our chain.'"

"Dr. Bob was what we have come to call



"Silky"



Bill



Rev. Sam



Dr. Bob



Sr. Ignatia

today a 'two-hatter' — actually, our first two-hatter," Robert M. added.

The title of Bill's pamphlet "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends" is "what this presentation is all about," the speaker said. "Is there a Dr. Silkworth or a Rev. Shoemaker in your community, waiting for a member of A.A. to call him and ask for his cooperation and support? . . . It is of no importance who gets the credit as long as the alcoholic and his family are the gainers. . . .

"Let me read from pages 114-118 in 'A.A. Comes of Age': 'Alcoholics Anonymous will never have a professional therapeutic class. No A.A.'s have been more buffeted by emotional gusts than those bold enough to accept employment with outside agencies dealing with the alcohol problem. We have no right or need to discourage A.A.'s who wish to work as individuals in these wider fields. It would be actually antisocial were we to discourage them. We cannot declare A.A. such a closed corporation that we keep our knowledge and experience top-secret. If an A.A. member, acting as a citizen, can become a better researcher, educator, or personnel officer, why not? Everybody gains, and we have lost nothing. Our Twelfth Step, carrying the message, is never to be paid for. But those who labor in service are worthy of their hire.'

"May we ever remember our pledge 'I am responsible,'" Robert M. concluded, "and that we say, 'anyone, anywhere, any time.'"

'With Faith, Nothing to Fear'

I had my first contact with A.A. in 1940, and have been very close since 1947. At that time, never even in my dreams did I expect to see so much governmental and professional activity in the field of alcoholism as there is today.

The prayers of many of us have been answered — even if not always exactly as we planned! At any rate, we now have more alcoholics at our A.A. doors than ever before.

I'm much encouraged by the way A.A. groups are handling these opportunities. One year ago, one group near my home had 20 members and one meeting per week. Now, it has quadrupled its size and has five weekly

meetings, because it was responsive to local alcoholism treatment programs. They're having a ball.

A.A. has absolutely nothing to fear from non-A.A. activity. It can only help A.A. reach more alcoholics.

Most important in A.A.'s relations with the professional community, in my opinion, is our *keeping A.A. always at its best*. And independent. We need not feel any sense of competition or fear or possessive pride so long as we keep our faith secure and strong, and give freely what we have.

—Milton Maxwell, Ph.D. (nonalcoholic),
co-chairman, trustees' Committee on
Cooperation With the
Professional Community

Suggestions on A.A. Relations With Professionals

Divided into nine sections, Conference members met for the week's first workshop Monday afternoon, right after the pictorial presentation by the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

The four topics, covered in each section, and the summary "sense of the meetings" reported back to the entire Conference were:

1. *Is your area ready for a committee on cooperation with the professional community?*

The majority of delegates said the need is felt, but some said groups they represented are not yet informed enough.

2. *In many areas, A.A.'s cooperate with other programs by signing attendance slips for people referred to A.A. Is this done in your area?*

About half the delegates reported such slips are signed, with initials. A number of delegates said groups have not been asked to do so; some said groups are undecided; others said groups do not.

All felt friendly explanations of A.A.'s Traditions to judges should be tried, and some reported it has been found better when A.A.'s act as "court sitters" than when offenders are referred directly to A.A.

3. *How are A.A. contacts and information provided to community agencies?*

PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

Intergroup offices, answering services, public information and institutions committees, area G.S. committee members, and individuals are the most common methods. Two-hatters make A.A. contact easy, several delegates pointed out. Other devices reported for informing community agencies include special A.A. meetings for professionals, wide distribution of A.A. meeting lists, special "training" of local P.I. speakers, and personal letters to professionals.

4. *Is an effort made in your area to understand the role of the A.A. member who "wears two hats"?*

The majority agreed such efforts are needed, but have not yet been very successful. It was suggested that area seminars and workshops on the subject be tried.

How I Wear Two Hats

I am an alcoholic, also a two-hatter — an A.A. member employed in the field of alcoholism. I direct a 20-bed male residence and an eight-bed female residence — halfway houses.

Things I try to keep foremost in my mind are:

1. *My limitations.* I know I got sober listening to other people's experiences and what the Fellowship taught — about staying sober. In other areas, such as marital and financial problems, I now defer to agencies experienced in these matters.

2. *Cooperation with other agencies.* I must keep an open mind and, most of all, have patience. Sometimes this means biting my tongue. But I can make suggestions if the agencies are open to them, and eventually they may try our way. Should it work, I must never say, "I told you so."

3. *Which hat I am wearing.* I must always know what hat I am wearing when speaking to people interested in alcoholism. I clearly ask, "Do you want a talk on my A.A. recovery, or on halfway houses?"

4. *What about my own A.A.?* At A.A. meetings, when certain problems arise, I hear the remark "Ask Murray — he runs into this problem every day." I say, "I'm sorry. I have to come to this meeting for myself, to insure my own sobriety. However, maybe we can get together after the meeting."

5. *Understanding our Traditions.* Some people seem to enjoy trying to stir up an argument about A.A. They pick on new members or on those not well informed about our Fellowship. I must be ready to smooth things over. We do not want controversy. This can be done if I keep my cool. Sometimes, I use a little psychology — simply give credit where credit is due.

—Murray S., Ontario (Northwestern)

How One 'Cooperation' Committee Began

After last year's Conference, I broached the subject of A.A. relations with the professional community at our monthly assembly. We studied the *Conference Report* and Bill's article "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends." We looked at the 1971 A.A. survey, showing nearly a third of our membership came to A.A. because of professionals. We voted in favor of committees on cooperation with the professional community, and we now have six or seven local committees.

In the beginning, some concerned mem-

How We Learned to Serve

From this hour, we know that the beloved Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous can gladly and confidently accept whatever destiny God may have in store for us all. I do not think that any of us would presume to believe that Alcoholics Anonymous in its present form will necessarily last forever. We can only hope that it will lead to better things for those who suffer from alcoholism; that the lessons and examples of our experience may in some measure bring comfort and assurance to the suffering and confused world about us, the world in which it is our privilege to be alive in this exciting and perilous time, this century in which spiritual rebirth may be the only alternative to extinction.

In the years ahead we shall, of course, make mistakes. Experience has taught us that we need have no fear of doing this, providing that we always remain willing to confess our faults and to correct them promptly. Our growth as individuals has depended upon this healthy process of trial and error. So will our growth as a fellowship. Let us always remember that any society of men and women that cannot freely correct its own faults must surely fall into decay if not into collapse. Such is the universal penalty for the failure to go on growing. Just as each A.A. must continue to take his moral inventory and act upon it, so must our whole Society do if we are to survive and if we are to serve

usefully and well.

I have a great faith that we shall never embrace and persist in a fatal error; and yet we still *might* do so, fallible human beings that we are. This is the area in the future life of A.A. where we can never be too prudent or too vigilant. Let us not suppose, just because A.A. as a whole has never had a grievous problem, that it never can have one. If such a difficulty ever comes, I feel sure that it will center about false pride and anger, the two most destructive defects that we alcoholics have.

As a society, we must never become so vain as to suppose that we have been the authors and inventors of a new religion. We will humbly reflect that each of A.A.'s principles, *every one of them*, has been borrowed from ancient sources. We shall remember that we are laymen, holding ourselves in readiness to cooperate with all men of goodwill, whatever their creed or nationality.

Then, too, it would be a product of false pride to believe that Alcoholics Anonymous is a cure-all, even for alcoholism. Here we must remember our debt to the men of medicine. Here we must be friendly and, above all, open-minded toward every new development in the medical or psychiatric art that promises to be helpful to sick people. We should always be friendly to those in the fields of alcoholic research, rehabilitation,

and education. We should endorse none especially, but hold ourselves in readiness to cooperate so far as we can with them all. Let us constantly remind ourselves that the experts in religion are the clergymen; that the practice of medicine is for physicians; and that we, the recovered alcoholics, are their assistants.

There are those who predict that Alcoholics Anonymous may well become a new spearhead for a spiritual awakening throughout the world. When our friends say these things, they are both generous and sincere. But we of A.A. must reflect that such a tribute and such a prophecy could well prove to be a heady drink for most of us — that is, if we really came to believe this to be the real purpose of A.A., and if we commenced to behave accordingly. Our Society, therefore, will prudently cleave to its single purpose: the carrying of the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Let us resist the proud assumption that, since God has enabled us to do well in one area, we are destined to be a channel of saving grace for everybody.

On the other hand, let us never be a closed corporation; let us never deny our experience for whatever it may be worth to the world around us. Let our individual members heed the call to every field of human endeavor. Let them carry the experience and spirit of A.A. into all these affairs, for whatever

bers felt the Traditions might somehow be violated. Others felt we would get into politics as the Washingtonians did. But certainly we can be guided by past experience so these dire events need not occur.

Three months ago, local committees got together at our assembly and formed an area committee. It meets every month, just as our institutions and P.I. committees do. G.S.R.'s keep their groups informed. Local chairmen submit reports at intergroup or district meetings. We are moving, I think, in the right direction.

Let me illustrate. On the Rochester Regional Council on Alcoholism, one woman physician had a reputation of being anti-A.A. When she heard of the local committee, she invited its members, as private citizens, to participate in planning sessions. Learning of *About A.A.*, the newsletter for professionals that is sent out by G.S.O., she asked to be added to the mailing list. We have found she really is not anti-A.A., but had been turned off some time ago by one A.A. member.

In Binghamton, we have A.A. meetings with both an A.A. and a public-agency or

professional nonalcoholic speaker on the program. This lets the nonalcoholic see how our program works, and we learn how others are trying to cope with this complex disease.

— Larry J., New York (Central)

Good Results From a Court Program

Working in the Police Department, I was painfully aware that many defendants whose alleged crimes were alcohol-related needed help. I read about court programs in other areas (I think first in the Grapevine), then approached our municipal judge in Hackensack. We started on a trial basis. At his request, we gave him the Big Book and "Twelve and Twelve." He makes a sincere effort to understand our principles. He doesn't even use the word "cure" about alcoholics any more! I was deeply touched when he told us we were making his job much easier.

At first, just a few cases were referred to us. We did reach enough people to be encouraged to continue. So we began weekly meetings *about* A.A. in the courtroom. The police chief told his men to mark "A" on

the arrest blank if a charge was alcohol-related. Charges have included obscene phone calls, shoplifting, false fire alarm, breaking and entry, and larceny.

When an arrest blank is marked "A," a volunteer A.A. member contacts the person before the court date. The approach is "You're in trouble and you were drinking. Did you ever think drinking could be the cause of the trouble?" Volunteers report interview results for the judge, who then sentences the defendant. He often suspends sentence, with attendance at the courtroom "meeting about A.A." as a condition of probation.

A.A. members do *not* act as probation officers. We just set an example of sobriety, answer questions, and encourage the newcomer. The Probation Department gives the offender a little booklet to be signed when he (or she) attends the courtroom sessions. It is the Probation Department that rides herd on him — not A.A. We cooperate, not affiliate.

If the judge sends an individual to jail, A.A.'s can visit. If the inmate will then
(continued)

by Bill W.

good they may accomplish. For not only has God saved us from alcoholism; the world has received us back into its citizenship. Yet, believing in paradoxes as we do, we must still realize that the more the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous as such tends to its own affairs and minds its own business, the greater will be our general influence, the less will be any opposition to us, and the wider will be the circle in which our Fellowship will be likely to enjoy the confidence and respect of men.

Having examined the perils of pride, let's look briefly now at how anger, even so-called righteous indignation, could harm us. Within A.A., I suppose, we shall always quarrel a good bit — mostly, I think, about how to do the greatest good for the greatest number of drunks. We shall have our childish spats and snits over small questions of money management and who is going to run our groups for the next six months. Any bunch of growing children (and that is what we are) would hardly be in character if they did less. These are the growing pains of infancy, and we actually thrive on them. Surmounting such problems, in A.A.'s rather rugged school of life, is a healthy exercise.

But there are, nevertheless, some areas where anger and contention could prove to be our undoing. We know this because stronger societies than our own have been undone.

The whole modern world is in fact coming apart as never before, because of political and religious strife, because men blindly pursue wealth, fame, and personal power regardless of the consequences to anyone, even to themselves. These are the destructive drives that are inevitably spurred by self-justification, and in all their disastrous collisions they are powered by righteous indignation, then by unreasoning anger, and finally by sheer blind fury.

With the most heartfelt gratitude, I can report that we have never yet had to endure any such trials by fire in A.A. In all these twenty marvelous years, no such thing as religious or political dissension has touched us. Practically no one has tried to exploit A.A. for wealth or public fame or personal power. We have had great problems, but they have always been resolved. Never has a grave issue cut across and scarred the face of this far-flung Fellowship. But, again, this is no earned virtue of ours. Too many of us in our drinking days have suffered the terrible penalties of these vain, proud, and angry pursuits to forget them now. These very pains have been the beginning of whatever wisdom we have since incorporated in A.A.'s Twelve Traditions. Hence, I feel confident that these forces of destruction will never rule among us. We are prepared to pay the price of peace. We will make every personal sacrifice neces-

sary to insure the unity of Alcoholics Anonymous. We will do this because God has taught us how to love Him and how to love each other enough.

As these meetings began on a theme of gratitude, so should they end. We give thanks to our Heavenly Father, who, through so many means and channels, has allowed us to construct this wonderful edifice of the Spirit in which we are now dwelling. It seems as though He had directed us to construct this cathedral whose foundations already rest upon the corners of the earth. On its great floor 150,000* of us are now sustained in peace, and long since we have inscribed thereon our Twelve Steps of Recovery. The older ones among us have seen the side walls of this cathedral going up, and one by one the buttresses of the A.A. Tradition have been set in place to contain us in Unity for so long as God may want it. And now willing hearts and hands have lifted the spire of our cathedral into its place. That spire bears the name of Service. May its beckoning finger ever point straight upward toward God.

**As of 1974, the estimated total A.A. membership is 725,000, not 150,000. (This is transcribed from a talk Bill W. gave at the Second International A.A. Convention in St. Louis in 1955. In almost identical form, it can be found in the book "A.A. Comes of Age" pp. 230-234.)*

accept a stay at a rehab facility, the judge lifts the rest of the sentence. A.A.'s take the alcoholics to rehabs.

This approach is often called "constructive coercion." Some attending courtroom classes are hostile at first, but many soon change. We don't reach everyone, of course; but in less than two years, we already have seven members sober a year or more, and nearly 30 with more than three months. Others, for whom the courtroom door was a revolving one, have improved in some degree.

We did not get 100% cooperation from all A.A.'s at first. I spoke to many members individually, explaining how we were operating within the Traditions. I used the Guidelines and Box 4-5-9 to back up what I said. But the recovered referrals have been our best advertisement. Many A.A.'s who earlier had qualms are now offering to work with us.

I have wondered at this success. These people didn't ask for help — we offered it. We often say, "They have to want it." Well, how do they know whether they want it if they don't know what "it" is? Exposure to our program is part of the answer. But also there is exposure to A.A. members living happily without alcohol. Maybe exposure plus knowledge about the disease of alcoholism, presented at a crisis period, equals probable recovery.

—Marge R., New Jersey (Northern)

Problems . . . or Just Edginess?

Many queries from our districts concern outside agencies and two-hatters. Some districts were delegating individuals to deal with various problems. But we found a lot of problems arose because no one really knew whether they were, in truth, "problems" or "personalities before principles." Further, we really didn't know whether we had problems, or merely a bit of edginess about others we feared were cutting into our turf. So we made it an assembly floor topic last October, and the question is still there — right on the floor.

First, the name "professional relations committee" was a big hang-up. (Now that our trustees have changed the name of their committee to Cooperation with the Professional Community, that may ease that objection.)

After all, we do have the pamphlets "A.A. in Your Community" and "Cooperation but Not Affiliation," all the other G.S.O. literature for professionals, and the *About A.A.* newsletter. So the answers are all there. All we have to do is use them — and the Traditions — and most any conflict can be solved.

"The A.A. Service Manual" suggests that

delegates establish communications with other alcoholism programs in their areas. This I did by letter and in person, achieving good rapport with our state Director of Alcoholism Programs. I urged committee members to seek out their local programs, get acquainted, and talk things out face to face.

After that assembly discussion, the state chairman appointed a study committee, to report back in October. A questionnaire has gone out. From the replies, we hope to establish patterns of problems, or ideas, then see what may be required. To form such an area committee, you involve P.I.C. and H. & I. people, committee members, central offices, and intergroups.

Perhaps here is a job for ex-delegates, a place oldtimers can become involved, because this work takes knowledge of A.A. Traditions and experience, plus patience and time.

In 1963, at Rutgers, Allan B., then chairman of the G.S. Board's P.I. Committee, said, "[We] welcome the opportunity to exchange ideas and experiences with other agencies. . . . We can likely find we are in agreement on most issues and, upon discussion, can reach an agreement on other things. . . . We can learn to respect each other's point of view; we can expand our broad areas of agreement and not dwell too heavily on minor points of disagreement."

With A.A.'s primary purpose in mind, education extending from G.S.O. to area to district to G.S.R. to the individual member will keep the A.A. hand outstretched in love and understanding to individuals — and to other agencies that also want to help about 9,000,000 people still suffering from the same illness we all did.

—Ted K., Washington

GROUPS and MEMBERS Spring 1974

	Groups	Members
United States . .	12,869	225,911
Canada	2,122	35,091
Overseas	5,428	101,611
Lone Members . .		397
In Hospitals . . .	1,030	22,915
In Prisons	1,018	34,764
Internationalists		462
Totals	22,467	421,151

(Including nonreported members, actual membership is estimated at 725,000 worldwide, in 92 countries. This total includes the estimated U.S. membership, 425,000.)

Understanding

SPECIAL-PURPOSE GROUPS

'For Those Yet to Come'

The Third Tradition, like our others, was born of painful soul-searching. A.A. had to be for *everyone* if it was to survive and address itself honestly to the problem of alcoholism. What, then, do we say to groups that *seem* to qualify their attendance by words such as stag, women's, gay, young people's, family?

Our area has many groups in all these categories. Most are of the closed, discussion type. Those attending feel they can communicate more freely there than in mixed meetings. All make strong cases for their groups.

We attended some of the meetings, including those of the gay group. We also took up this subject during our "mini-conference." The stag and women's groups say everyone is welcome, and strongly support their groups. Family groups feel the same way. In the workshop, the vote was two to one in favor of open discussion meetings with both A.A. and Al-Anon participating. The deaf group is open to all alcoholics. At times, they use nonalcoholic interpreters. The young people also welcome everyone and are active in other groups.

The gay group is very active, with three weekly meetings (two closed, one open), all well attended by both men and women. They welcome all alcoholics. We spent one and a half hours with their steering committee of 12 after a meeting. Their argument is that new people who are gay are much more comfortable at a gay group and anticipate misunderstanding in regular groups. Whether this feeling is real or imaginary, the group recommends that newcomers start at a gay meeting and eventually become active in other groups. They claim they are no more "special" or "exclusive" than other groups whose names indicate a particular profession or sex. Many gay members hold office in other groups.

Prior to the emergence of this Traditions question, special-purpose groups were listed in the *World Directory*. Are gay groups the reason the Third Tradition is being given a hard look at this time? If so, it may behoove us to remember that the *only* qualification for A.A. membership is "a desire to stop drinking."

But the question remains: "Are special-purpose groups in line with the Third Tradition?" A majority of A.A.'s in our area feel they are *if*, as they say, every alcoholic is welcome no matter what the composition of the group may be.

I'd like to add a personal thought. We are a very communicative fellowship; our "grapevine" is fantastic. Would not word get around that if you are gay, such-and-such a meeting

and Cooperation...Inside A.A.

PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

was the place to go? Or that there are lots of that type of A.A. in such-and-such group? Those desiring this type of meeting would go; others would not.

A thoughtful memorandum from the gay group says, in part, "Although hesitant at first, we have now come to open all our meetings to all alcoholics. We believe we observe the Third Tradition, as well as every other Tradition, in all respects." They also note that "traveling A.A. members are often unable to find gay meetings which in fact exist."

If we conclude that special-purpose groups and the Third Tradition are in opposition, and rule against their listing in the *World Directory*, let us make certain our judgment has not been swayed by emotional or rational considerations that do not apply here. We are responsible for seeing the hand of A.A. is there for those who reach out for it. Only very important matters threatening the existence of A.A. should be allowed to shorten that outstretched arm.

Our workshop opinion was two to one in favor of listing in the *World Directory*. But two other possible solutions are: (1) a special listing of these groups; (2) a separate booklet prepared by G.S.O. for this purpose.

This problem varies from one section to another. All areas will not see eye to eye on either the question or the answer. The solution seems to me to call for the wisdom of Solomon, who once *proposed* dividing in half so he might save the whole. In our Fellowship, the wisdom of Solomon resides, we hope, in our group conscience. I have faith that this question will be resolved in a manner that will keep A.A. united for those yet to come.

— John W., District of Columbia

'Let Us Act With Love'

If our *World Directory* lists one kind of special-purpose group, should it list all? Or should G.S.O. stop listing *any* such groups, but continue to provide services for them?

Special-purpose *meetings* are held throughout the Fellowship, for deeper understanding of a subject such as public information, Steps, institutions, etc. These meetings are never listed in the *World Directory*. But when some members with a special purpose meet regularly and call themselves an A.A. group, they want to be listed. Such groups not only violate some Traditions, but also disregard other spiritual principles of A.A.

The front cover of our *World Directory* says, "When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible." In my opinion, all groups between the two covers of the directory should be open to "anyone, anywhere."

Our primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Doesn't this mean "anyone, anywhere"? "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking." Doesn't this mean "anyone, anywhere"?

Creation of special groups which exclude some alcoholics from membership is not creating unity, but dividing the Fellowship — which is contrary to our First Tradition.

As these groups spring up, are they affecting A.A. as a whole, violating the Fourth Tradition? No unity, no future. Special-purpose groups bring into the Fellowship outside issues such as sex, age, religion, in violation of Tradition Ten.

If we take action on special-purpose groups, I hope we act in good faith. The responsibility of being a delegate means we cannot allow petty differences, prejudice, or bigotry to influence our decision.

Bill spoke of "compelling love." The life of each member and group is built around our Steps and Traditions. The penalty for extensive disobedience is death for the individual and dissolution for the group. But an even greater force for A.A. unity is our compelling love for our fellow members and for our principles.

Let us, as trusted servants, act with love and instruct G.S.O. to discontinue listing special-purpose groups in the *World Directory*.

— Donald S., Massachusetts (Eastern)

In an advisory action (see p. 28), the Conference affirmed that all A.A. groups should be listed in the *World Directory*.

SURVEY

Proposed 1974 A.A. Survey

The purpose of the 1974 survey of Alcoholics Anonymous will be threefold:

1. To update the findings of the 1968 and 1971 surveys, and compare the changes in the composition of the typical A.A. meeting from 1968-71 to 1974.
2. To develop a new understanding of the characteristics of the typical member attending an A.A. meeting.
3. To provide the public with a realistic appraisal of the effectiveness of A.A. in arresting the disease of alcoholism.

The previous surveys have proved very useful in carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. They have helped identify key factors attracting new members. Knowing as much as we can about this is basic to Twelfth Step work at the public level.

The 1971 survey reconfirmed the continuing strong influence of A.A. members in

attracting new members on a person-to-person basis, but it also highlighted the growing influence of family members, doctors, and counseling agencies. As a result of these findings, new emphasis has been put on directing the A.A. message to these channels of influence. (1) We have prepared and directed specific messages to the family of the alcoholic; (2) we are conducting a continuing evaluation of what the public thinks about A.A.; (3) we are exploring ways and means to overcome the negative features of A.A.'s reputation; (4) the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community is increasing its work with doctors and other professionals.

The information gathered in the 1974 survey will be used to improve this effort.

As in the past, distribution will be done by delegates working with area committee members and G.S.R.'s. A supply of questionnaires with instructions will be available.

— Walter M., chairman,
trustees' Public Information Committee

In an advisory action (see p. 28), the Conference approved the proposal for the 1974 A.A. survey.

CENTRAL OFFICES AND GENERAL SERVICE COMMITTEES

Cooperation Happens When Needed

The first cooperative effort undertaken by groups in Cleveland was begun in 1940. One man persuaded each group to send a representative to periodic meetings to consider matters of interest to all groups. Within a short time, these meetings were formalized. The central committee has met each month ever since. Subcommittees serve A.A.'s collective interest: hospital, institutions, consolidated meeting, action, training, *Central Bulletin*, etc.

A central office opened its doors in 1945 with the name A.A. Cleveland District Office, operated by a full-time paid secretary. The committee which founded the office became autonomous (independent of the central committee) and became the office operating committee, a board of trustees directing office affairs. Eleven members serve three-year terms, which overlap. Members represent all sections served by the office, all races, and both sexes. Following the office opening, representatives from each group convened as the office advisory committee. It meets four times a year, elects the office operating committee, and keeps the office and groups mutually responsive.

The office is now staffed by the secretary, full-time paid assistants, and part-time volunteers. Calls are received from alcoholics and

others seeking information about A.A. or the office services. An up-to-date list of meeting places and times and group secretaries is distributed several times a year. The office sponsors an annual intergroup dinner, handles sales of literature, and arranges for speakers, upon request, for A.A. and non-A.A. functions.

Cooperation between the district office and the area G.S. committee does not occur often, because there is not much occasion for it. However, relations are very good, and there is no problem making cooperation happen when needed. Meetings of the central committee and office advisory committee are attended by the delegate. Every four years, Northeastern Ohio is host area for the state convention, and the office provides literature, sets up the display, and keeps it manned. This is a tremendous assist to convention-planners and gives the office opportunity for public relations. The G.S. Committee of Northeastern Ohio never tries to duplicate the services of any of the bodies mentioned, nor to infringe on their functions.

Our area's participation in the General Service Conference was lackluster from 1951 through 1954, nonexistent in 1955-56. But the founder and editor of the *Cleveland Central Bulletin* vigorously campaigned to make the area aware of its responsibilities. The district office set up a meeting and recruited capable people to get the ball rolling again. As a result, Northeastern Ohio has sent a delegate to every Conference since 1957.

—John B., Ohio (Northeastern)

'Study the Material, Select the People'

One aspect of my pink-cloud stage has evaded me ever since, and that is the urgency I felt to read about (not study) our program. Perhaps I didn't learn properly, but I've never been able to get around to spending as much time reading since then.

G.S. committees and central offices are clearly covered in Guidelines and "The A.A. Service Manual." Great on paper! How much real study have I or my group given to these Guidelines? Does the central office delegate always attend G.S.R. meetings, and vice versa? How many educational meetings are held in my group? Where, in the name of God, is our sense of gratitude?

In our area, reality is a far cry from what the Guidelines say. I'm sorry to report that personalities have crept in, and our present performance can be rated only fair. How-

ever, we're working on it. We have the instructions and the people. All we have to do now is read *and* study, then select the proper people. And if I would devote 10% of the time I devoted to drinking, my area as well as myself would be helped greatly.

Perhaps some of us are complacent. Before we had a detox facility in our city, every week we had several sick alcoholics in the city hospital "tank." Members generally understood they would often be expected to act as "sitters." Then the facility opened, and we don't get one hospital call a month. Guess what? When we *do* get a case, it's more difficult than ever to get volunteers!

In my opinion, we win by giving of ourselves in helping another human being and also by offering our experience, strength, and hope to *educate* and *select* the proper people for vital A.A. jobs at group, central, or G.S. levels.

— Al M., Nova Scotia/
Newfoundland/Labrador

Two Good Examples, One Problem

We have 11 central offices or intergroups in our area. Their services vary from minimal (using voluntary help for Twelfth Step calls, group information, and public information or speakers) to excellent (such as those at the San Francisco C.O., performing all functions that could be expected within our Traditions).

Some central offices originate by the revolt of a few disgruntled people, disregarding matters affecting other groups or A.A. as a whole.

A good example of excellent relations is an East Bay central office where:

1. G.S.R.'s frequently alternate as intergroup representatives, or attend intergroup meetings and participate.
2. D.C.M.'s or G.S.R.'s attend intergroup meetings as a liaison, and give full G.S. reports.
3. C.O. gets all G.S. meeting minutes and other material, such as Guidelines.
4. Committee members and G.S.R.'s frequently visit C.O. for discussions with the secretary, and telephone each other with questions.
5. G.S.R.'s are asked to attend all secretaries' meetings, and report.
6. G.S. is invited, and expected, to participate in C.O. functions, such as "All Groups Day."
7. C.O. assists in distribution of G.S. announcements, mentioning G.S. items regularly in C.O.'s monthly letter.

In this area, it is felt that "The A.A. Service Manual" errs in recommending no interaction between G.S.R.'s and central offices or intergroups. This has been done

for years, with separation of functions.

Our area and the San Francisco C.O. Service Committee have formed a joint committee for improving public information and cooperation with the professional community.

An exact opposite of the two above examples of cooperation is of much concern to us. Eight people have started what they call a C.O. and have named it "Alcoholics Anonymous Information Center." The officers are self-appointed, without any group-representative elections or rotation. Their purpose is the distribution of, not only A.A. literature, but Al-Anon, Alateen, National Council on Alcoholism, and other non-Conference-approved literature to doctors, lawyers, and other professional people. They do not list a telephone number nor have an answering service. This is the second time they have revolted from their existing C.O., which serves the same community and adheres to A.A. Traditions. The loss of contributions from A.A. groups has nearly wrecked the central office. We have tried to get this new enterprise to drop "Alcoholics Anonymous" from its name. We are trying to better inform A.A. districts and groups about A.A. service structure, Traditions, and Concepts.

Perhaps it would be good for our Guidelines to recommend the minimum number of groups necessary — say 23 to 25 — to start a new C.O. successfully.

— Merle G., California (North Coastal)

How Are A.A. Services Provided Where There Is No Central Office?

Four sections of the Thursday-morning workshop dealt with this topic, compiling the following answers to four questions:

1. *Does the G.S. committee in your area engage in these activities?*

- a. Receive, distribute, and follow up Twelfth Step calls? 7 yes, 35 no.
- b. Answer inquiries about A.A.? 21 yes, 21 no.
- c. Maintain information about hospitals and recovery facilities? 18 yes, 23 no.
- Arrange admissions? 5 yes, 23 no.
- d. Public information work? 40 yes, 14 no.
- Professional relations work? 1 yes, 18 no.
- e. Carry the message into institutions? 28 yes, 13 no.
- f. Provide an area meeting list? 17 yes, 24 no.
- g. Print a local A.A. newsletter? 18 yes, 23 no.
- h. Order, sell, distribute Conference-approved literature? 11 yes, 30 no.

2. *If these services are not provided by the G.S. committee, how are they given?* By groups, individuals, central offices, and district committees.

3. *If such services are not given, would your area committee like to provide them?*

Most area committees would be willing to assume responsibility for such services.

4. *Other suggestions from delegates?*

Over large rural areas with scattered

groups, G.S. committees can be very helpful in providing services; in some metropolitan areas, support for central offices is being sought by informing groups of the need. "The A.A. Service Manual" is an excellent guide for resolving problems.

Better Cooperation Between Area General Service Committees and Central Offices Reported

A definite trend toward improved understanding and cooperation between local A.A. intergroup offices and area general service committees came to light during workshops for delegates on the topic, as figures below

indicate. They also show that — in line with the A.A. local-autonomy Tradition — who does what varies from area to area.

Answers to 11 questions on this subject, totaled from five workshop sections, follow.

1 - 2. *Which A.A. services are performed in your area by —*

	Area G.S. Comm.?		Central (Intergroup) Office?	
	Yes	No	Yes	No
a. Receive, distribute, and follow up Twelfth Step calls	13	34	45	2
b. Answer inquiries about A.A.	17	30	45	2
c. Maintain information on hospital and recovery facilities	19	28	30	7
Arrange for admission	5	42	21	26
d. Public information work	30	9	41	7
Professional relations work	34	11	34	4
e. Carry the message into institutions	24	23	32	15
f. Provide area meeting lists	15	30	40	7
g. Print local A.A. newsletter	11	36	37	5
h. Order, sell, and distribute Conference-approved literature	13	34	32	3

3. *Is there any overlap or duplication of services?* 19 yes, 28 no.

4. *Are the central office and G.S. committee separate structures?* 44 yes, 2 no.

5. *If structures are separate, do representatives from C.O.'s attend area assemblies or other area functions?* 37 yes, 10 no.

6. *Do representatives from the G.S. committee attend meetings of intergroup representatives or steering committee?* 20 yes, 17 no.

7. *Does a G.S. area committee officer or district committee member serve on the C.O. steering committee?* 7 yes, 40 no.

8. *If the exchange of representatives occurs in your area, is this a satisfactory method of communication?* 21 yes, 26 no.

9. *On the whole, do you feel understanding and cooperation in your area are:*

Fair? 23.

Good? 15.

Poor? 7.

10. *One area put on an all-day workshop about A.A. service — local services (central office) and area service (G.S. committees). Do you think such a project would increase*

understanding and cooperation in your area? 43 yes, 4 no.

11. *What ways of improving understanding and cooperation can you share from your area's experience?*

Among suggestions were: one- or two-day workshops open to all A.A.'s; strong district, area, state G.S. structures; joint assembly-C.O. meetings for discussion of Conference agenda topics; discussion at state conventions of difference in G.S. and C.O. roles; publishing by intergroup of minutes of assembly meetings; putting reports on C.O.'s on assembly agendas; cooperation in publishing a statewide meeting list; holding assemblies at different locations, open to all A.A.'s; joint C.O.-G.S. area committees on institutions, public information, and cooperation with the professional community; updating C.O. bylaws and publications; rotating Conference ex-delegates into C.O. responsibilities; liaison committees; joint dinners and picnics; voting representatives from C.O. on G.S. district committee; charts showing different service responsibilities; preparation of Guidelines on C.O.-G.S. area committee cooperation; dele-

gates' report on Conference to C.O. steering committees; delegates' and area G.S. committees' making sure C.O. staffs get *Box 4-5-9* and the final *Conference Report*; delegates' avoiding meddling in C.O. internal affairs; "schools" for G.S.R.'s; booklet on state structure given to all G.S.R.'s; a G.S. committee's helping provide things a C.O. needs — such as a typewriter or mimeograph machine, or help with the rent or telephone bill.

Delegates Share Experience In Wide-Open Discussions

For unstructured workshops, delegates met in nine sections. They raised any questions they wanted to, for sharing of experience with those from other areas.

No report-back occurred Conference week, but G.S.O. afterward compiled a summary of section reporters' notes and mailed it to delegates.

Recurrence of certain topics (except those covered in other Conference sessions) indicated widespread interest in these subjects, among others:

1. *Building better district and area service structures.* Use of "The A.A. Service Manual," the G.S.O. filmstrip, workshops, interesting assembly agendas, and assembly meetings open to all A.A.'s were suggested.

2. *Improving interest in the Traditions.* Using a Grapevine series about their effect on individual recovery, and stressing that they permit us to unite in A.A.'s primary purpose, instead of arguing about extraneous matters, were proposed.

3. *Clubs for A.A. members.* Wider use of G.S.O.'s Guidelines on Clubs was recommended.

4. *Relationships with Al-Anon Family Groups.* Autonomy of local A.A. groups and the separateness of A.A. and Al-Anon were pointed out.

5. *Long-term members.* Rotation, "The A.A. Service Manual," and the group conscience were commended.

6. *"Floating" members who do not join any one A.A. group.* A sense of belonging and responsibility was described as sobriety insurance.

7. *Getting a better head count of A.A. membership.* Averaging numbers of people at meetings was one idea offered.

8. *Groups' excluding some alcoholics.* Starting a new group was suggested.

9. *Accepting "expenses" for Twelfth Step calls.* It was agreed this violates A.A. tradition.

10. *Increasing group support for G.S.O.* "Tithing" (10% of group income), the Birthday Plan, and Gratitude Dinners were brought up.

Four topics brought up by delegates were discussed at the last formal session Friday afternoon, and a "sense of the meeting" was reached on each one, as follows:

Are We Placing Personalities Before Principles at A.A. Conventions?

A.A.'s who plan these events think they have to go far off to get speakers. The cost can be staggering. And is it always best to have these events at the finest hotels? If we are trying to outdo the other fellow, are we forgetting what it will cost to attend?

For the "circuit speakers," this could be touchy. Are people who do the planning as much at fault as the speakers? Should we look for new faces? If a speaker is asked to keep coming back, should he be big enough to say no? To suggest another speaker?

The success of a convention does not lie in the speakers alone. In planning any event, shouldn't we look to the new person first? In A.A., we don't have to be in competition. Is there really a logical reason for us to outdo the last event? We should not plan an event to see how much money we can make; this leads us away from the primary purpose.

A lot of members are tired of hearing the same jokes and stories, watching the same acting behind the podium. Like many others, I will continue to go to conventions, not just because of the program, but to renew old friendships and make new ones.

Those of us here today can help put back principles before personalities. We can become involved in planning these events. We can make conventions more attractive and less expensive. We can't tell anyone how to plan anything, but by suggestion we just might be able to get back to conventions with the primary purpose of carrying the message to the suffering alcoholic.

— Don A., Texas (Southeastern)

Sense of the Meeting: This can get out of hand; however, guest speakers can be educational and do attract large attendance, thus helping finance such events. Each convention committee might take a hard look at Tradition Twelve.

Guidelines for Assembly Business?

In many areas, oldtimers set up ways of conducting area business, and sometimes still do. This type of operation is often based on individual theory and personalities. Changes are made to fit a situation at some meeting or assembly, are based on the desires of a few people, and are made on the spot — "all for the good of A.A.," of course. The group conscience cannot be obtained "on the spot," so such changes should be eliminated, except

in emergencies. Individual A.A. members have emergencies, but A.A. seldom has one. Changes should be made only after much deliberation.

Those early members deserve enormous credit for seeing the program through some difficult times. But the passing of oldtimers is at hand. The former close-knit relationship within an area no longer exists. Written guidance is needed for the thousands of new members. We can no longer depend on sponsors' passing words on to the newcomer. Many newcomers don't have a sponsor, and many sponsors are so new, they don't know, either. The uninformed are guiding the uninformed. Guidance is needed for those now serving and for those yet to come. It would be better to have this from a written document than by word of mouth.

Well-thought-out guidelines would serve many good purposes. Some examples are:

1. Participants in area committee meetings and area assemblies could know the ground rules before they attend.
2. Meetings and assemblies could be conducted with minimum dissension and deviation.
3. Politicking could be drastically curtailed, if not eliminated.
4. G.S.R.'s with only two weeks' sobriety could be discouraged from representing a group.
5. Too many G.S.R.'s and committee members are recruited overnight. They attend assemblies for a special purpose and are never seen again. This would end.
6. Major changes, except in emergencies, would be based on the group conscience. This should be the rule, not the exception.

No doubt, the list could be extended. It is suggested that each area draw up guidelines, because it is desirable that each have its own agreed-upon procedure for conducting its business. Our area conducted a survey and found almost as many different answers as there were assemblies. We decided on our answers to these questions:

1. How long should a member be sober before serving as G.S.R.? Committee officer? Delegate?
2. Who is eligible to vote at assemblies?
3. Who is eligible for election as delegate or committee officer?
4. As each group has only one vote, what about the votes of D.C.M.'s or committee officers who also belong to these groups?
5. If the D.C.M. also serves as G.S.R., should he have two votes?
6. Do the chairmen of special committees, such as public information, institutions, Grapevine, etc., have a vote?
7. How long must a group exist before its G.S.R. is eligible to vote?
8. Can one G.S.R. represent two groups?
9. When the G.S.R. cannot be present, can

he vote by proxy?

10. Are voting restrictions placed on G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, and committee officers absent at the preceding two (or more) assemblies?

If we are businesslike about A.A. service business, we will help to change what many members think about Service and to awaken the group conscience — thereby contributing to Unity, the gateway to our future.

—David H., California (Southern)

Sense of the Meeting: Large majority of delegates said area committees and assemblies do operate under some written ground rules and procedures.

Picture-Taking at A.A. Functions

Recently, a local member took pictures of all tables at a personal anniversary meeting, not asking if anyone wished to be photographed. The celebrant (with many years in A.A.) was photographed with the speakers, and cutting the cake, like a wedding! The photographer, asked if he had permission from those present to take their pictures, said, "This is my group and my camera!"

Another member was photographed in a group celebrating his anniversary and innocently left the picture on his home coffee table. A neighbor came in, pointed at someone in the picture, and said, "I didn't know he was in A.A."

At our largest annual dinner, there was picture-taking where it was nearly impossible to avoid persons at nearby tables and on the dais, including one famous person.

Because of such instances, the topic was brought to our assembly. Some people said, "Everybody saw me drunk, so why should I hide in A.A.?" But most people felt such incidents violated each member's right to be anonymous. It was also felt newcomers might either (1) be frightened away or (2) decide it's all right to come to the next anniversary with camera. It was suggested, too, that picture-taking could encourage ego-tripping.

After discussion, our assembly passed a motion that our area committee "very strongly suggests" no pictures be taken at any A.A. meeting, to protect the anonymity of all present and not to frighten away newcomers, since picture-taking violates "the spirit of the First, Eleventh, and Twelfth Traditions." We'd like to hear other delegates' experience.

— Ruth H., New York (Southeastern)

Sense of the Meeting: Unanimously, delegates agreed private picture-taking should not occur at A.A. events.

Topics

Help Share the Conference Experience

Every delegate says something like "It's a once-in-a-lifetime experience — can't be described. Too bad you can't *all* go." But the experience rarely comes to life for the people at home.

When I returned last year, I tried to paint word pictures of the physical setup, as well as report on the actions. I described the meeting rooms, the placing of microphones, the adjoining dining room with informal atmosphere and excellent food, and so on. Interest took a giant step forward.

Last winter, we decided to pattern our assembly after the Conference, calling it a "mini-conference." We engaged a motel floor that permitted a layout like this one. We asked each group to send its G.S.R. and at least one other member.

At the opening dinner, Niles P. told about the G.S.O. operation. We showed the G.S.O. filmstrip, followed by discussion. Members were asked to look over a packet of material and come in the next morning ready to work.

Workshops and committees were headed by active, experienced members. We returned to the assembly room for reports and had spirited Ask-It Basket sessions.

We did get some criticism: "We didn't have enough time. We should take several days to do it right!"

Over 130 A.A.'s worked hard all day on a tight schedule, and they enjoyed it.

We asked a Panel 7 delegate to give the sense of the mini-conference. He said, "Gosh, this was great. I feel just like a delegate again!"

— John W., District of Columbia

Attracting People to Service

I hardly know this question, much less the answer. I have asked a lot of loudmouth questions in A.A., so I've been given a lot of jobs to do, under the guise of "Twelfth Step work" and "rotation." In answer to "What will I do with free time now I don't drink?," I was allowed to set up chairs and empty ashtrays.

Webster defines "service" as "contribution to the welfare of others." Surprise! The answer is "Empty the ashtrays"; the price of sobriety is being "willing to go to any length" if I want what you in A.A. have.

In the triangle that holds the circle of our continued sobriety, Service keeps Unity and Recovery from falling flat. Without Service we will not have Unity; and without Unity we may start calling each other something else.

I have trouble managing my own life, and suddenly I'm supposed to manage myself in

relation to other people. That's why I don't want to hear about Service! I want to twelfth-step the world grandly, single-handed — and I find I have to cooperate with others. This means extra exertions on my part — inventory, self-control, and accepting the group conscience. I have to work on the inner steps of my recovery. The "any length" has suddenly lengthened.

I have failed at group service at times, but God has given me strength and wisdom to come back, to work under His will to give service. My reward is in doing the jobs necessary to help A.A. carry the message.

The service message I carry to the A.A. who carries the message is the same one he carries: I know a joy of living from the spiritual awakening I have received from working *with* others to contribute *to* others. I cannot promote service. I may attract you to it, if you see in me the joy I find in working with others to make A.A.'s wheels turn in my group and around the world.

— Norm A., Illinois (Chicago)

Sense of the Meeting on last two: A delegate's task is far from finished after the Conference. Whatever means are chosen to report back to the area membership, the appreciation of service must be kept alive. If it were not for service, where would we all be?

ASK-IT BASKET

Questions and Answers

Submitted in writing (unsigned) by the delegates, questions were read and answered on the floor whenever possible. But the busy Conference schedule set a limit on Ask-It Basket time. The following record also includes answers that resulted from a sharing session of the G.S.O. staff, held shortly after the Conference.

GROUP AFFAIRS

Q. How can we prevent ex-delegates from taking over groups as secretaries for years and years?

A. Read "The A.A. Service Manual" on rotation of officers.

Q. By a show of hands from each delegate, who is working with a fellow alcoholic? Doing Twelfth Step work?

A. Everyone.

Q. Should we sell available wall placards, bumper stickers, fountain pens, and ciga-

rette lighters, etc. in our offices or groups?
A. Not considered good policy. Stick to Conference-approved literature.

Q. Should a married couple, both alcoholics in A.A., be allowed to attend both A.A. and Al-Anon meetings?

A. Yes, as long as they keep A.A. principles and Al-Anon principles separate.

Q. How do we handle the many who are now coming to us through clinics and are obviously heavily medicated?

A. Try to convince them to seek help through prayer and meditation, rather than prayer and medication. In some areas, members try to have a friendly chat with clinic directors.

Q. When does a group remove a person who is drunk or drugged and disruptive to the meeting?

A. Immediately.

Q. How can A.A. groups better accept and

respond to the variety of people who come seeking help?

A. If any newcomer has a drinking problem, it is a Twelfth Step job.

Q. Are we neglecting to maintain A.A. contact with A.A. members who are too old to attend regular A.A. meetings, or have become invalids and are unable to attend?

A. A.A.'s should be encouraged to visit sick or shut-in alcoholics.

Q. Is there such a thing as a drinking member of A.A., or are all members total abstainers?

A. The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking.

Q. Should groups have picnics, Christmas parties, etc. put on for spouses and children?

A. Such a decision is up to the individual group conscience.

Q. May a collection basket be placed at the
(continued)

rear of an A.A. assembly hall for contributions to an outside agency?

A. No, this is not usually done.

GRAPEVINE

Q. Who started calling November Tradition or Gratitude Month? When was it started and why?

A. Back in November 1949, the first editor of the Grapevine suggested that a week be set aside every November for discussion of the Traditions. This suggestion was preceded by an article by Bill W. on the subject, in full approval.

Q. Why do they use the word "recover" in the Preamble when we all know that we are in a constant state of recovering — never recovered?

A. The word "recover" in the Preamble is the only form that could be used in that context. In 1946, some nonalcoholics who happened to read the Grapevine were curious and wanted to know more about the purpose and philosophy of A.A. The first editor of the Grapevine composed the present Preamble, not for A.A.'s, but to inform the general public. The Fellowship liked the Preamble so much that it is almost universally used at all open meetings.

TRADITIONS

Q. May announcements of outside activities be made at A.A. meetings? Specifically, requests for funds?

A. All agreed that this should not be done.

Q. Many area conferences list on the conference programs the name of a person or company from whom tapes of the conference may be purchased. The meetings are usually taped by several people, and some of them are professional; but only one person or company is listed on the program. Doesn't this indicate an endorsement, which is contrary to the Sixth Tradition?

A. It is not in violation of the Traditions, but some delegates objected to this practice. However, it is up to each area conference committee to decide what it wants to do.

Q. Should A.A. groups consent to tape recordings of any A.A. meeting? Does this invade our anonymity in any way?

A. Previous Conferences have discussed this subject and have suggested that speakers be asked to give their permission before being taped.

Q. Should tapes of A.A. meetings be offered or lent to groups or agencies outside A.A.?

A. Not unless the individuals whose speeches are recorded have given their consent and

have protected their anonymity by using first names only.

Q. Is it necessary to break professional anonymity to attract newcomers and crowds at special events?

A. Most A.A.'s feel we should follow the A.A. Tradition of placing principles before personalities.

Q. Should we be using tapes as a method of auditioning speakers for our assemblies, conventions, and meetings?

A. Every area makes its own decision, based on its own group conscience, on matters of this kind.

Q. What will we do about anonymity when using sound and audiovisual cassette messages?

A. At A.A. meetings, these should not be used without permission of the people speaking on the cassette recordings.

Q. What about A.A. members who collect names of people seen at or outside A.A. meetings and put them on mailing lists?

A. Perhaps groups should make a greater effort to familiarize members with the A.A. Traditions.

SERVICE STRUCTURE

Q. Our area has decided, not only to invite past delegates to attend all area assemblies, but also to allow them to vote, to give an added incentive for attendance. Is this being done elsewhere? With what results?

A. Some areas do this. The choice is up to the group conscience of the assembly.

Q. How many area (or state) committees operate under formal bylaws?

A. Most don't have formal bylaws, but they have policies and guidelines which they follow, based on "The A.A. Service Manual."

Q. In our area, a monthly communication is printed and mailed by an individual A.A. member (secretary of the state committee). It is published by a nonprofit corporation, sent to any A.A. member or group requesting, and supported by individual contributions. Is it in order to have "A.A." in its title?

A. Yes, provided the material shares A.A. news and follows A.A. principles.

Q. Aren't agenda topics discussed by *one group of voting members* (namely, the trustees) before the Conference? This is in relation to the suggestion that the delegates *not* discuss Conference topics at the Delegates-Only meeting.

A. Conference topics are recommended by

the Conference Agenda Committee to the trustees' Subcommittee on the Conference, which refers them to the trustees' Policy Committee for approval. The topics are discussed only in terms of suitability for the Conference agenda.

Q. How many trustees, both Classes A and B, are employed by or associated with outside agencies in the field of alcoholism?

A. Five.

Q. Why not call the general service representative the "group service representative"?

A. He is the group's representative to the general service assembly and the General Service Office.

CLUBS

Q. Clubs and A.A. become known as one and the same to many people in the area. Imagine the impact on local people when a club is raided, several members are arrested for gambling, and their names are listed in the newspaper, along with the location. This has happened twice in this area. How do others control gambling?

A. This subject is covered in Guidelines on Clubs.

WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Q. Why was Dr. Norris given permission to select the other delegate to the World Service Meeting in London?

A. Dr. Norris was elected delegate unanimously by the board of trustees, and it was also the unanimous wish that Dr. Norris appoint the other World Service Meeting delegate. It was felt that the staff would be well represented in London by the two staff members from G.S.O. who will be in attendance.

LITERATURE

Q. It is felt we need a hard-bound, pocket-size edition of the Big Book. Can this be done?

A. This subject has been discussed at A.A.W.S. on several occasions, but we will be happy to refer it for further consideration.

Q. Some members have inquired about the possibility of there being literature clearly defining an agnostic.

A. There is a chapter on this subject in the Big Book.

Q. How about dating the various editions of "The A.A. Service Manual," especially the last one, which has the most changes?

A. All A.A. publications are supposed to be

dated. The date was inadvertently omitted from the last edition of the manual.

Q. Why is there not more literature on sponsorship?

A. Revision of the "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" pamphlet was suggested by the 1974 Conference Literature Committee.

WORLD DIRECTORY

Q. Could we place *World Directories* as meeting lists in embassies abroad for traveling members?

A. We will try to get guidance on this subject from the delegates to the World Service Meeting.

Q. What can be done about individuals who exploit A.A. by using the *World Directory* as a promotional mailing list?

A. Write to the company using the directory and explain the *World Directory* and its purpose. G.S.O. also writes to the company.

Q. Why are group contributions listed in the *World Directory*? Some groups feel it is a put-down on groups that are unable to contribute.

A. It was the feeling of the General Service Board that the groups as a whole preferred to have their contributions listed.

INSTITUTIONS

Q. In hospitals, clinics, etc., where the stay is less than 30 days, should A.A. activities be by C.P.C. or institutions committees?

A. Institutions committees. C.P.C. usually deals with the professional staff.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Q. Can we get a show of hands on how many delegates are "two-hatters"?

A. Six present.

Q. What can be done to educate M.D.'s who are prescribing drugs of the addictive type to alcoholics?

A. We only share our experience. We are not in the business of educating professional people.

Q. Do we need firmer guidelines on whether it is advisable for members professionally engaged in the field of alcoholism to hold office as delegates or trustees?

A. Please see the report of the 1974 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community (p. 29).

Q. When newcomers have been instructed by courts to attend A.A. meetings, should members sign attendance slips?

A. See the workshop report on p. 9.

Q. Why does a nonalcoholic, Dr. Norris, always represent A.A. at all government functions?

A. We are happy we have Dr. Norris to represent us, but the G.S.O. general manager and the secretary, chairman, and members of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee frequently attend these meetings, as well.

Q. What has A.A. or G.S.O. done to make sure A.A. groups in hospitals, halfway houses, and detox centers are separate entities?

A. See the Guidelines on Rehabilitation Centers and on Cooperation with Alcoholism Agencies and Facilities, and the pamphlet "Cooperation but Not Affiliation."

Q. Many clubs, treatment places, etc. give their programs much press and air publicity in which they recommend A.A. and say it may be obtained at their location. At the same time, a request for money contributions is often made or implied.

A. Perhaps you might take a look at "Cooperation but Not Affiliation." You might have accurate news stories about A.A. published. Also, try to talk the matter over with the responsible individuals.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Q. Do we really attract anyone by saying we have doctors, ministers, etc. in A.A.? Does this possibly turn some people off A.A.?

A. We do these members a disservice when we treat them differently. For P.I. stories, however, this statement is useful information.

CENTRAL OFFICES

Q. Why do we refer to a group representative to a central office (intergroup) as the "delegate" or "alternate delegate"? This causes confusion with delegates to the General Service Conference.

A. G.S.O. Guidelines should refer to central office (intergroup) "representatives" rather than "delegates."

Q. Should intergroups and/or answering services be incorporated?

A. Most intergroups are incorporated, but not all. Answering services are generally commercial services that groups rent.

Q. Should a central or intergroup office be in a church building?

A. It seems inadvisable, because it may imply affiliation with the church.

AL-ANON

Q. What about Al-Anons attending area meetings?

A. They attend open meetings and social functions, but not assemblies, closed A.A. meetings, or business meetings.

Q. At conventions, rallies, and roundups, should Al-Anon and Alateen be actively involved without cost to them?

A. In many areas, A.A. pays all expenses, but A.A. also keeps excess funds as a start for the next convention. (See Guidelines on Conventions, Conferences, and Area or Regional A.A. Get-Togethers.)

G.S.O.

Q. How many complaints has G.S.O. had on poor quality of TV spots?

A. Two complaints. If there are others, please return defective spots for replacement.

Q. Could we have the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions made up in a 2' x 4' or other size suitable for hanging in meeting places?

A. The matter will be discussed at a meeting of A.A.W.S.

Q. How can we help G.S.O. to sort out the geographical areas of Canada? Mail is continually going to the wrong areas.

A. We are working with the delegates now to define all Conference areas.

Q. Can something be done to have the Internal Revenue Service issue a directive stating that individual members' contributions to recognized A.A. groups be allowed as a deduction — and not allowed only under medical expenses?

A. G.S.O. cannot make such a request to the Internal Revenue, nor can the G.S. Board. But A.A. members can contact the regional director of Internal Revenue to determine whether or not such contributions are deductible in a particular region.

Q. Are we going to get a "Unity" plaque similar to the "I Am Responsible" plaque?

A. Up to now, we haven't had a need for it, but will refer the matter to A.A.W.S.

Q. We sent one order, but literature was sent in separate packages at different times. Why?

A. Books and pamphlets are shipped separately, but usually at the same time. This has to do with postal rates.

G.S.O. and Board Committee Reports

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Board Actions Reflect A.A. Growth; Money Gap Widens

TRUSTEES' REPORT: It gives me great pleasure to report to the Conference the continued growth and increasing vitality of our Fellowship. We are carrying the A.A. message to more alcoholics than ever before.

Contributions were up each month (except December) in 1973 over 1972. So far in 1974, they are up from 1973. However, group contributions still do not begin to meet the cost of services rendered by your G.S.O. Furthermore, the gap is widening, although total contributions are up.

I regret to inform you that, in addition to the four A.A. trustees who are rotating off the board, two other trustees are leaving at the end of the Conference. Matt N. is resigning at the urging of his physician, and Dr. Travis Dancey, despite protests from other board members, feels it is time to step aside.

I would like to mention a few other matters, as well as tell you about my own activities on behalf of A.A. during the past year. Your board: (1) because of growth, authorized additional space at G.S.O.; (2) authorized new committees — 1974 Convention, Conference, and Archives; (3) recommended that the "Traditions" film continue to be shown before A.A. groups only.

There were two meetings of the Long-Range Planning Committee. We learned of progress by other agencies in the fight against alcoholism, as well as progress in "people's hearts." We discussed the philosophy underlying other approaches to alcoholism, and some problems that arise among all organizations in efforts to cooperate.

Within the past year, I have attended an A.A. convention in New Hampshire and a conference in Southern California, where I also visited several central-offices and spoke at a clinical conference in an alcohol and addiction hospital. I met with past delegates and trustees in Seattle, Wash., and found exciting A.A. growth and activity in that area. At the American Medical Association's first major meeting on alcoholism — a mile-

stone! — in Washington, D.C., October 11-12, I talked briefly on ways physicians may work with A.A.

—John L. Norris, M.D., chairman

A.A.W.S.

Literature Sales Rise; G.S.O. Fills 23,800 Orders

DIRECTORS' REPORT: A.A. World Services, Inc., is a membership corporation, a subsidiary of the G.S. Board, with seven directors elected by the trustees each April. Monthly meetings establish prices on literature, review reprint-permission requests, and attend to administration of G.S.O.

A management consultant firm recommended changes in office systems and procedures, and most are being implemented. Mechanization of systems and equipment is still under study. We enlarged our office quarters to allow for A.A.'s continuing growth.

In 1973, A.A. literature sales totaled \$1,152,900, an increase of \$322,600 over

LITERATURE DISTRIBUTED — 1973

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	110,297
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Reg. Edition) ...	44,887
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Gift Edition) ...	15,815
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	12,045
As Bill Sees It	18,425
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish Edition	1,823
Total	203,292

BOOKLET

Came to Believe (new)	58,699
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PAMPHLETS

This Is A.A.	303,859
A.A. — 44 Questions and Answers	244,200
Is A.A. for You?	566,715
Young People and A.A.	158,755
A.A. for the Woman.	124,791
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	128,940
The Alcoholic Husband	105,379
The Alcoholic Wife	118,100
Memo to an Inmate	39,259
Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic	279,669
The Jack Alexander Article — About A.A.	82,085
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	89,413
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	111,795
What Happened to Joe	116,347
It Happened to Alice	96,507
The A.A. Group	63,774
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	42,287
Inside A.A.	46,633
The G.S.R.	71,126
The A.A. Service Manual	9,196
Twelve Traditions Illustrated	41,756

A.A.'s Legacy of Service	19,571
The Co-Founders of A.A.	42,192
Understanding Anonymity	94,836
A.A. and the Medical Profession	64,012
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	69,946
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	60,465
A.A. in Prisons	24,792
A.A. in Hospitals	40,260
If You Are a Professional	109,536
Alcoholism Is a Management Problem	126,745
The Fellowship of A.A.	100,640
A.A. in Your Community	111,474
Profile of an A.A. Meeting	82,345
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	21,248
A Member's-Eye View of Alcoholics Anonymous	85,782
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	140,318
Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous	73,722
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	36,990
Problems Other Than Alcohol	80,427

Total 4,225,887

MISCELLANEOUS

Tapes of A.A. Talks	364
Wallet Cards — 2-fold	517,916
Wallet Cards — "I Am Responsible"	76,995
Wallet Cards — Anonymity (new)	185,641
Parchment Scrolls	8,129
Plaques	1,039
How It Works	142,617
Beginners Meeting Kit	2,257
Group Handbook	3,102
Wire Racks	851
Cassettes	103
A.A. Public Information Manual	4,538
Twelve Concepts for World Service	2,308

Reveal Increased Interest in A.A.

G.S.O. AND
G.S.B. REPORTS

1972. A.A.W.S. donated \$150,000 to the General Fund to defray costs of services which contributions failed to meet. Free pieces of literature, sent to new groups and distributed to familiarize the public with A.A., amounted to 324,600, with an inventory value of \$11,557.

Nine employees in the Accounting Department, under the supervision of Rita Buttermilch, process all literature orders and contributions. They also maintain the general books and prepare payrolls, financial reports, and budget controls. In 1973, there were 24,000 contributions and 23,800 orders.

Lena Machado, assisted by Carol Nielson, heads the Records Department, with four full-time employees, one part-time. They compile *World Directories* and institutions directories and maintain files on groups, Loners, Internationalists, delegates, committee members, etc. New group cards go to this department.

Shipping, with 14 full-time employees and three part-timers, is supervised by Al Cryan, assisted by Haywood Hicks. They process all incoming and outgoing mail and pack and ship all orders. Shipping also maintains the G.S.O. mailing list and keeps inventory on books, pamphlets, and miscellaneous items.

The 16 members of the Steno/Clerical Department are under the supervision of Denise Stern, assisted by Mary Feeley. Ten transcribers are assigned to G.S.O. staff members. They also act as recording secretaries to trustees' committees and handle form letters and special literature requests, aided by the receptionist and the telephone operator.

— Walter M., chairman

POLICY

Big 'Town Meeting' Guides General Service Board

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE: All matters referred to the General Service Board are reviewed by this committee. It is a "town meeting" in which everyone is welcome to contribute. This allows a free-wheeling kind of four-hour open discussion among 40-45 people, which shows the group conscience at work. Trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff, and members of all trustees' committees attend.

Voting members are eight regional trustees, two trustees from outside New York, two G.S.O. staff members, president and a director of Grapevine, president and a director of A.A.W.S., and two other trustees designated by the board chairman.

Some topics on the agenda have been: (1) TV appearances representing A.A.; (2) whether or not "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" should be

shown outside A.A.; (3) theme and agenda suggestions for the 1974 Conference; (4) formation of Archives Committee; (5) trustees' committee reports to the board; (6) regional trustees' reports; (7) choosing Conference committee members by lot; (8) the energy crisis.

Few formal votes are taken, since the idea is to get a sense of the meeting to help guide the thinking of the board. Minority opinions are truly important here, as in every aspect of A.A. service. These are always brought to the board's attention.

— Tom M., chairman

LITERATURE

New Pamphlets Ready; Need For Others Being Studied

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE: In cooperation with the Conference Literature Committee, we have worked on or discussed the following: (1) "Is A.A. for You? — Short and Simple" (now available); (2) "A.A. and the Armed Services" (now available); (3) new title, "The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse," to replace "Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic"; (4) cartoon-style "Young People and A.A." (idea tabled since need is not evident now); (5) the need for a pamphlet directed to the North American Indian; (6) a suggestion for a pamphlet for the elderly; (7) first manuscript pages of the booklet "Staying Sober" (going to the Conference Literature Committee for comments); (8) Big Book case histories, to see whether they answer the need of today's newcomer (recommendations for the Conference Literature Committee); (9) story in *Box 4-5-9* about the difference between Conference-approved literature and local material; (10) a recommendation that A.A.W.S., Inc., reproduce the original Big Book (turned down as too costly, with no demand evident); (11) setting up literature for specific kinds of alcoholics (no definite committee policy formed — each request to be handled individually).

— George G., chairman

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff Sees 1,000 Visitors, Answers 12,400 Letters a Year

STAFF REPORT: Each of our nine staff members has a specific service assignment. These are: Staff Coordinator, Service Coordinator, Conference (U.S.-Canada). Cooperation with the Professional Community, Public Information, Overseas, World Service Meeting, 1975 Convention, Institutions, Internationalists, and Loners. They are responsible

for appropriate bulletins and reports. Staff members also serve as secretaries to the pertinent G.S. Board and Conference committees.

As in 1941, when the first letters began to come into our office as a result of Jack Alexander's *Saturday Evening Post* article, the work of first importance is answering mail. We answer personally approximately 12,400 letters a year. The staff coordinator sees that this flow of mail gets out as rapidly as possible during vacations, times of sickness or absence, or when a staff member has a special project requiring full-time work for a while. Otherwise, each staff person handles mail from assigned areas.

A very rewarding part of our work is invitations received yearly from the ever-increasing number of A.A. conferences, assembly meetings, and state or provincial get-togethers. During these trips, we can make G.S.O. better-known to A.A.'s, and get information about local activities, which helps us be a better service office.

In 1973, about 1,000 visitors from our A.A. world came to see us and had a tour of G.S.O. and the Grapevine. Each staff member greets them, and the visitor can spend time with the staffer corresponding with his or her area.

The staff coordinator represents the staff at weekly meetings of the Office Policy and Procedures Committee and at department managers' monthly meetings. She also tries to keep the staff informed on activities which may concern them at the office or outside. Daily folders of answers to correspondence go to all the staff and the Grapevine, and a weekly folder of publications is also circulated.

Staff meetings three times a month are very helpful. They provide discussion on problems arising in correspondence which need direction from the group conscience.

— Ann M.

SERVICE COORDINATOR

500 New 'Box 4-5-9' Readers Added in Three Months

STAFF REPORT: *Box 4-5-9* — This publication goes out every other month in English, Spanish, and French. Individual and bulk subscriptions are available. In January, 300 copies each were sent to six Conference areas, six local central offices, and six local convention committees. Subscription forms were also sent, and over 500 new subscriptions have come in.

New Groups — Complimentary literature and a Group Handbook go out to each new group. We add it to the mailing list, so it receives *Box 4-5-9* and the *World Directory*.

Guidelines — Overseeing preparation of these

by assigned writers is a service-coordinator job. There are 14, on: Alcoholic Rehabilitation Centers; Armed Services; Central or Intergroup Offices; Clubs; Conventions, Conferences; Court Programs; Institutional Committees; Public Information; Relationship Between A.A. and Al-Anon; Industry Programs; Cooperation With Alcoholic Agencies and Facilities; Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field; Carrying the Message to "Hard to Reach" Alcoholics; Current Usage of *World Directory*. As need arises, Guidelines are updated.

Films, Tapes, and Cassettes — Two 16mm color films are available. "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" go free to A.A. groups in institutions, and are rented to other A.A. groups (\$35.00 weekly). The G.S.O. filmstrip sells at \$6.00. Eight tapes are available at \$3.00 each. One cassette, a talk by Bill on the A.A. Legacy of Service, is priced at \$3.50.

Service Material — Our service file includes material on all the G.S.O. services. For example, we have lists of armed forces groups, industry programs, and A.A. members who like to exchange tapes.

Service Meeting — Each month, the service coordinator conducts a meeting to share staff experience and suggestions about each service. One meeting recently dealt with correspondence and how to answer it.

Form Letters — To keep up with the immense work load, a helpful tool is form letters. The service coordinator is responsible for these.

Conference-Approved Literature — This includes preparation of all Conference-approved literature not connected with other staff members' specific assignments.

Traffic Control Board — All bulletins, service material, pamphlets, and books are routed to the service coordinator's desk, and a control board shows each step involved and complete schedules for each item. At a glance, we know just what progress is being made.

A.A.'s Copyright — All Conference-approved literature is copyrighted, and for any of it to be used or quoted, permission must be granted by the directors of A.A. World Services, Inc.

—Beth K.

INTERNATIONALISTS and LONERS

G.S.O. Reaches 420 Seagoing A.A.'s; 400 Lone Members

STAFF REPORT on Internationalists: Approximately 420 Internationalists (seagoing A.A.'s) carry the A.A. message around the world. The service helps these A.A.'s keep in touch through mail with each other and G.S.O. G.S.O. gives each Internationalist names and addresses of other Interna-

tionalists, and all receive the *World Directory*, which serves as their meeting list.

Six times a year, our newsletter — the *Round Robin* — is sent out. It shares excerpts of letters from Internationalists and A.A. news items. Internationalists also receive *Box 4-5-9*.

An Internationalist started a ham radio group years ago. It carries the A.A. message through the air around the earth.

—June R.

STAFF REPORT on Loners: We "cleaned" this mailing list during the past year. It now numbers 400, including 43 Spanish- and 41 French-speaking Lone Members. We send each new Loner: ideas on staying sober without an A.A. group; complimentary literature; a list of other Loners; *World Directories*.

Every other month, Lone Members receive *A.A. Loners Meeting*, a meeting-by-mail, with excerpts of letters from Loners and Loner Sponsors. They also get *Box 4-5-9*. We now have nearly 400 Loner Sponsors, who correspond with the Loners and share group experience with them.

Lone Members are encouraged to do Twelfth Step work and, if possible, to form A.A. groups. Through their efforts, new groups started this last year in Teheran, Iran, in Burns Lake, B.C., and in Manama, Bahrain.

Much of our Fellowship's growth can be traced to service to the Lone Member. Sharing in it is deeply rewarding.

—Betty L.

OVERSEAS

Membership Grows 10,000; Overseas G.S.O.'s Stronger

STAFF REPORT: Group membership overseas — 96,763; total number of groups — 5,775. The increase in membership since April 1973 is approximately 10,000; the increase in groups, over 1,000.

At the first World Service Meeting, in 1969, Bill said: "The first meeting of the Conference was held in 1951. It was hoped other countries would form service centers of their own. It was never thought New York would be the seat of A.A. government. Rather, as the center with the oldest experience, it would share this experience with other offices, which would be free to make their own choices."

Our W.S. Meetings show exactly that pattern. The U.S. and Canada together are represented with only as many delegates as other single countries — two. Eventually, responsibility for A.A. services will lie within each country itself. G.S.O. in New York will only share experience.

Outside the U.S. and Canada, 20 literature distribution centers are functioning. The following give complimentary literature to their new groups: Australia, Belgium (Flemish and French), Brazil, Colombia, El Salvador, Finland, France, Germany, Guatemala, Holland, Ireland, Mexico, New Zealand, Norway, South and Southwest Africa, Sweden, and Switzerland (French and German).

G.S.O. (New York) has put forth guidelines for literature centers which publish Conference-approved material. We work closely with all such centers to assure that our Steps and Traditions remain intact.

The concept of nationalism is dangerous for A.A. One Finnish delegate said, "There is only one A.A., not a Finnish A.A. or an American A.A. It may differ in every country in the same way that every member has his own approach to the program. The program and the Traditions should always be the same. There should be only one A.A. in the world, although there are many ways of following the A.A. life."

—Ann M.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

A.A. Visits and Exhibits Draw 2,139 Queries by Professionals

STAFF REPORT: Committee members and staff attended this last year 17 events, including: quarterly meetings of the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and its annual conference; a special meeting called by the American Medical Association (A.M.A.); annual Halfway House Association meeting; Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies; annual dinner of the National Council on Alcoholism (N.C.A.) New York City affiliate; annual meeting of the American Medical Society on alcoholism (A.M.S.A.); an A.M.A. conference; N.C.A. dinner honoring Senator Jacob K. Javits; Interstate Regional Conference on Alcoholism; and others described below.

A.A.'s Professional Exhibit was shown at meetings of 15 professional associations: American Personnel and Guidance Association; Medical Society of the State of New York; National Catholic Clergy Association; New England Hospital Assembly; N.C.A.; American Industrial Health Association; National Conference on Social Welfare; American Orthopsychiatric Association; A.M.A.; National Medical Association; Alcohol & Drug Problems Association of North America (A.D.P.A.); American Academy of Family Physicians; American Public Health Association; National League for Nursing. As a result, we received from professionals 2,139 requests for A.A. literature.

Six groups of students, from Rutgers and New York Hospital, visited G.S.O.

The second issue of our newsletter for professionals and paraprofessionals, *About A.A.*, was mailed to our list of 2,200 alcoholism workers.

We offered delegates the addresses of programs associated with N.C.A., N.I.A.A.A., and A.D.P.A. Twelve hundred copies of "Understanding Anonymity" went to the Utah Summer School on Alcoholism for their students.

—Mary Ellen U.

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE: In January, this committee changed its name, as you see.

We participated in several national meetings last year. A member presented a paper — "A.A., a Force in Community Education" — to the Canadian Foundation on Alcohol and Drug Dependence. For N.C.A., we arranged a workshop on "A.A. and How It Relates to Other Agencies." For A.D.P.A., we had two workshops: one on A.A. and professional cooperation; the other for A.A. members who "wear two hats." Your chairman attended the Conference of the National Association of Anti-Poverty Alcoholism Programs. At a workshop on "How A.A. Relates to the Minority Groups," it was agreed that professionals should be encouraged to cooperate with A.A. groups.

We are working on a complete revision of "Cooperation but Not Affiliation."

It has been a good year for A.A.'s relations with the professionals. We know a great percentage of our A.A. growth is due to their interest in helping the alcoholic.

—Robert M., chairman

PUBLIC INFORMATION

7,915 Inquiries Answered; 159 P.I. Committees Served

STAFF REPORT: This assignment carries the A.A. message to the alcoholic and the potential alcoholic. It uses the media (news-papers, magazines; radio, TV) to reach those in a position to help the alcoholic — the spouse, doctor, clergyman, employer, and others.

During 1973, we provided responses to 7,915 inquiries. We also processed 3,520 press clippings.

A.A. is now listed in 37 encyclopedias and reference books.

We now have 159 local P.I. committees and 446 P.I. contacts. We provide them with:

(1) The P.I. Manual, with background editorial material, radio-TV material, and the A.A. Fact File; (2) the bimonthly *P.I. Bulletin*; (3) radio-TV spots; (4) Guidelines for P.I. Committees.

The following are useful P.I. pamphlets: "A.A. in Your Community," "Brief Guide to A.A.," "Profile of an A.A. Meeting," "Understanding Anonymity," "The Fellowship of A.A.," "A.A. Fact File," and "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings."

Information was supplied to 32 professional writers who requested it. Material was also provided or interviews arranged for radio and TV programs. Seven educational and community service organizations also asked for and received information.

—Phyllis M.

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE: During the past year, we worked to provide information about A.A. to the Fellowship and to the public.

Projects Completed: (1) 20 radio spot interviews with A.A. members were sent to 500 top radio stations; (2) 200 of our new color-TV spots were distributed in 1973; (3) the annual anonymity letter to the press was mailed to 750 dailies; (4) an announcement about A.A. and our literature and tapes appeared in *New Outlook for the Blind*.

Projects in Progress: (1) *The Saturday Evening Post* is considering a story on A.A.; (2) trustees approved the proposed 1974 membership survey; (3) "Who Is the A.A. Member Today?," stressing the positive aspects of A.A. recovery, is ready for distribution; (4) two senior citizens' publications have been contacted about an article to reach older alcoholics; (5) a special Discount Package of literature for P.I. speakers is being prepared; (6) "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" is being revised.

For the future, some type of film or film-strip about A.A. for use by P.I. committees and the Fellowship as a whole is under consideration.

—Walter M., chairman

CONFERENCE

Staff, New Board Subcommittee Work Year Round on Conference

STAFF REPORT: Bill once said, "The group conscience is not a miracle, but it is a marvel when dealing with subjects within its own experience." These words come often to mind because the Conference represents the collective conscience of our Fellowship. Over the years, the Conference has produced that "marvel" Bill spoke of.

G.S.O. is grateful to delegates for helping with the Group Information Cards so our mailing list can be accurate, and for seeing that G.S.O. promptly received information on new delegates, committee officers, and district committee members.

Area committee secretaries have done a fine job reporting on assembly and committee meetings, and G.S.O. is grateful to receive these reports. The Conference secretary reads these minutes carefully, and it is a rewarding learning experience. Items concerning institutions, public information, relations with the professional community, Grapevine, literature, etc., go to the staff members involved. They, too, find the information helpful in their assignments.

Whenever we receive suggestions for the agenda, we present them to the trustees' Subcommittee and the Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee for approval, and share this information in the *Quarterly Report* and *Box 4-5-9*. However, agendas must be approved at the January meeting of the board's Policy Committee and so are not ready until early February. Many assembly meetings are held in January, before the agendas have received final approval, so it is difficult to provide the copies you need. If first assembly meetings of the year were somewhat later, the agenda would be available for discussion. Otherwise, agenda topics listed in *Box 4-5-9* and the *Quarterly Report* can be discussed.

Some responsibilities of the Conference secretary are:

1. Correspondence with past and present delegates (625 past delegates receive *Box 4-5-9* and the *Quarterly Report*).
2. Preparation of the *Quarterly Report* after each meeting of the G.S. Board and its committees.
3. Collecting suggestions for the Conference theme and agenda and presenting them to the two committees on the Conference for action, then reporting them in the *Quarterly Report* and *Box 4-5-9*.
4. Preparation of the Conference agenda in consultation with the general manager and the two appropriate committees.
5. Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee.
6. Correspondence with delegates in preparation for the Conference.
7. Scheduling material for Conference Manuals, Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*, and the final *Conference Report*.
8. Preparation of summaries of Ask-It Basket questions and answers and Conference advisory actions.
9. Working with the G.S.O. Conference Planning Committee and the staff in Conference matters, and enjoying their cooperation!

—Cora Louise B.

TRUSTEES' SUBCOMMITTEE: We met twice, in October and February. It was suggested our functions be: (1) considering suggested Conference themes and topics; (2) considering agenda scheduling; (3) reviewing preliminary agenda; (4) suggesting ways to

improve Conference participation of all members, format, scheduling, and communication.

We submitted three suggestions for the 1974 Conference theme to the Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee for final selection of one.

We considered the first rough draft of the 1974 agenda and agreed on major topics, then recommended acceptance of the preliminary agenda by the trustees' Policy Committee.

The subcommittee also reviewed suggestions for workshop formats, and delegates' choice of workshops.

—Margaret C., chairman

FINANCE

Expenses Rise, but Principle Of Self-Support Guards A.A.

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE — The financial picture of G.S.O. in 1973 was good. Sales of books and literature increased \$322,500 over 1972. Of this total, \$110,000 came from sales to the U.S. Navy and other government agencies. However, excluding \$15,000 in sales to the U.S. Government in 1972, regular sales for 1973 were still in excess of those of 1972 by 27%.

Contributions, a good indicator of growth and group activity, totaled \$645,900 for the year, \$25,100 more than forecast and \$80,500 more than received in 1972 — a 14% increase. Interest income, produced by depositing contributions in a savings account on a day-to-day basis until needed for expenses, was up \$7,400. Total income — publishing gross profit, contributions, and interest income — increased \$307,100 over the year 1972, a 29% increase.

Of course, expenses were also up. Excluding office expansion costs, totaling \$80,800, expenses increased \$204,600. This 21% increase was within 6% of the budget. The expense increase is directly related to a growing Fellowship and a higher cost of doing business.

To sum up the 1973 operations, the \$234,300 deficit of the board's General Fund was offset by A.A. World Services, Inc., publishing net income, which amounted to \$328,400. This left G.S.O. with a net income of \$94,200 for the year 1973 as compared to \$73,500 for 1972.

G.S.O.'s budget for 1974 has been reviewed and approved by the board's Finance Committee. It is a prudent one and allows increases in both income and expense. Total income — contributions, publishing gross profit from sales, and interest income — is budgeted 8% higher than 1973 actual. This increase is based on the anticipated growth

rate of A.A. for the coming year. Because of two major expenses incurred in 1973 that will not recur in 1974 (office expansion, \$80,800, and *World Directory: Part I*, \$34,000), total expenses are expected to remain within 2% of total 1973 expenses. Net income from all G.S.O. operations is expected to total \$182,000.

With the full participation of A.A. groups and members, the Fellowship's tradition of self-support will insure that the goals, dignity, and strength of A.A. will remain intact.

—Arthur Miles, chairman (nonalcoholic)

INSTITUTIONS

Institutions Groups Increase At Rate of 100-Plus Annually

STAFF REPORT: In 1970, we listed 767 hospital groups; in 1973, we provided service to 1,035. The 1970 records show 925 prison groups served; in 1973, 1,018. That's a present total of 2,053 — an increase of 361 in three years, or more than 100 A.A. groups per year!

The increase of A.A. in hospitals and rehabs clearly reflects the activity of national and local alcoholism agencies and treatment centers.

Correspondence indicates the following service needs of A.A. in hospitals: (1) more responsible sponsorship to groups and members; (2) more effort to carry the A.A. message to hospitalized alcoholics *without criticism of professional treatment*; (3) greater acceptance by A.A. groups of the newcomer who sobered up in a hospital and is still receiving professional help; (4) more A.A. literature for hospital groups.

Mail about A.A. in prisons indicates these needs: (1) more literature; (2) more A.A. sponsors; (3) more "outside" speakers; (4) more "outside" A.A.'s to correspond with those "inside."

We provide the following services to those in institutions: (1) correspondence, through the staff member and the Institutions Correspondence Service; (2) listing all such groups, and sending new ones complimentary literature; (3) institutions directories; (4) *World Directories*; (5) *Box 4-5-9*; (6) *Institutions Bulletin* (three times a year); (7) discount packages of A.A. literature for "inside" groups and institutions committees; (8) Guidelines for Cooperation With Rehabilitation Centers, for Cooperation With Courts, and for Institutions Committees; (9) tapes and films loaned free to institutions groups; (10) sharing of experience (through correspondence and literature) with local institutions committees.

Services from G.S.O. only open the door to A.A. recovery. Real recovery for the con-

finer alcoholic depends entirely on local institutions committees and sponsors who reach out the hand of A.A. in love and service to those who cannot come to us.

—Valerie S.

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE: Established in January 1973, this committee encourages A.A. members to carry the message to alcoholics in institutions, and reviews service to A.A. groups and members in institutions and to institutions committees.

Last December, we mailed a questionnaire to 2,000 prisons and hospitals with A.A. groups, also to institutions committees and groups. More than 450 responses came in, but results were not available when this report was prepared. We hope to use this material in updating "A.A. in Prisons" and "A.A. in Hospitals."

A letter from the chairman, like that sent to U.S. institutions, went to Canadian correctional facilities.

"Is A.A. for you? — Short and Simple" is now priced at a discount for institutions groups and committees. The committee is still reviewing all institutions literature in an attempt to reach all levels of understanding.

—Austin MacCormick,
chairman (nonalcoholic)

ARCHIVES

Archival Library Organized; Early A.A. Records Preserved

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE: The main purpose of the archival library is to keep the record straight, so that myth does not predominate over fact regarding the history of our Fellowship. The library can give A.A. a sense of its own past and the opportunity to study it. There is also interest in A.A. among sociologists, historians, and other professionals who want to find out what A.A. is and how it started. The archives should be accessible to historians, as well as to A.A.'s, but each request should be individually judged.

Bill's files from *Stepping Stones* have been integrated with his files at G.S.O. Early, irreplaceable A.A. material has been placed in a safe-deposit box, with copies made for the library. Directories, *Conference Reports*, and bulletins have been bound. Letters were sent to 190 old-time A.A.'s asking their help; 105 affirmative replies and much material have been sent in. Files of the first 100 groups in the U.S. and Canada have been collected. Papers are being prepared for microfilming, and steps are being taken to put sound material on permanent tape.

—George G., chairman

WORLD SERVICE MEETING

32 Representatives Headed for 1974 W.S. Meeting in London

STAFF REPORT: In London, England, at the Gloucester Hotel, the third World Service Meeting will be held Oct. 16-18, 1974. G.S.O. planning committees in New York and London are at work. We exchange reports, and the agenda is the responsibility of London G.S.O.

Represented by two delegates each will be: Australia, Belgium (Flemish), Central America (both Northern and Southern Zones), England, France, Germany, Ireland, Mexico, New Zealand, Norway, South Africa, South America, Sweden, United Kingdom, and U.S. and Canada.

The theme for the gathering is "Sharing." Some subjects to be discussed are: (1) public information; (2) creating mutual understanding and cooperation between the Fellowship and others concerned with helping alcoholics; (3) A.A. and industry; (4) how to encourage group contributions for support of G.S. offices; (5) participation of new countries in future W.S. Meetings.

The English A.A. Convention takes place Oct. 18-20, 1974, right after the W.S. Meeting.

—Waneta N.

John L. Norris, M.D. ("Dr. Jack"), non-alcoholic chairman of the G.S. Board, has agreed at the board's request to represent it at the 1974 World Service Meeting and has named Don A., Chappell Hill, Tex., Southwest regional trustee, as the other representative of U.S.-Canada A.A.

Niles P., G.S.O. assistant manager, and Waneta N., G.S.O. staff, will attend as working staff for the meeting.

NOMINATING

Candidates and New Procedures Get Careful Consideration

Established by the board in 1944, this committee reviews backgrounds of and makes recommendations on all trustee candidates for the board and directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., and the Grapevine. Its members help elect trustees. The committee corresponds to the Conference Committee on Trustees, meeting with it in April and maintaining communication with it between Conferences.

In the past year, the committee recommended to the board:

1. That it elect the following officers and directors of The Alcoholics Anonymous

Grapevine, Inc.:

Officers

Ralph A., *president, chairman*
Paula C., *vice-president, secretary*
George G., *treasurer*

Directors

Ralph A. Charles H.
Paula C. Joseph H.
Thomas C. Austin MacCormick
Charles E. Jack M.
George G.

2. That the following slate of trustee candidates be presented for election at the meeting of the General Service Board in April, following presentation to the 1974 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A (nonalcoholic)

John L. Norris, M.D.
John D. Bealer, M.D.
Vincent Dole, M.D.
Austin MacCormick
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
Arthur Miles

Class B (A.A. members)

Ralph A. Thomas G.
Junior A. James G.
Donald A. *Robert M.
Margaret C. Walter M.
George G.

1 regional trustee — S.E. U.S.
1 regional trustee — E. Cent. U.S.
1 regional trustee — Pacific U.S.
1 regional trustee — E. Canada
1 regional trustee — W. Canada

*A.A.W.S., Inc., proposed the name of Robert M. as G.S. trustee to replace Stephen O. when he rotated off the board in July 1973. The Conference Committee on Trustees and the trustees' Nominating Committee reviewed and approved Robert M.'s résumé.
3. That the following slate of officers presented by the General Service Board be elected at the annual meeting of its members in April 1974:

John L. Norris, M.D., *chairman*
Austin MacCormick, *1st vice-chairman*
Tom G., *2nd vice-chairman*
Junior A., *secretary*
Arthur Miles, *treasurer*
Ann M., *assistant secretary*
Dennis Manders, *assistant treasurer*

4. That the following director candidates of A.A. World Services, Inc., be elected at the annual meeting of A.A.W.S., Inc., in April 1974:

Christian A. Ann M.
Jerry D. Robert M.
Robert H. Walter M.
Martin L.

5. That a regional trustee should resign if he moves out of the region where he was elected before the expiration of his term of office.

6. That the following procedures (stated in the Bylaws of the G.S. Board) be followed when a trustee dies or resigns before the

expiration of his term: "In the event that any member trustee shall resign or shall die, the trustees may at any regular or special meeting elect a new member trustee to fill such vacancy, or, alternately, permit such a vacancy to continue until the next annual meeting of the General Service Board. In the event that the vacancy is that of a Class B regional member trustee, his successor shall be elected for the unexpired term of the Class B regional member trustee who may have resigned or died. In the event that the vacancy is that of a Class B general service member trustee, his successor shall be elected for a period of four years from the date of the meeting at which he is elected."

And that a Class B regional trustee who has been elected to fill the unexpired term of a trustee who has died or resigned should not be eligible to serve an additional four-year term, because the Bylaws of the General Service Board state that no Class B member trustee shall be eligible to serve more than four successive annual terms and because it would disrupt the even flow of new trustees coming onto the board as outlined in the schedule of elections on page 95 of "The A.A. Service Manual."

7. After receiving the report of its subcommittee to study electoral procedures for regional trustees, the trustees' committee recommended:

a. That procedure #4 from the 1973 Conference Questionnaire on electoral procedures be presented without recommendation to the 1974 Conference for consideration as an alternate electoral procedure for Class B regional trustees. It reads as follows: "The trustees' Nominating Committee continues to review résumés for each candidate's eligibility for nomination. Voters to consist of delegates from region involved — plus an equal number of voters — one-half to come from the Conference Committee on Trustees and one-half to come from the trustees' Nominating Committee."

b. That the Conference be asked to recommend a five-year moratorium at the Conference on discussion of electoral procedures of regional trustees, following the decision reached in 7-a above.

c. That a two-thirds majority of the present and voting members of the Conference be required to carry either of the above motions.

The committee reviewed the résumés of all 34 regional trustee candidates from E. Canada, E. Cent. U.S., Pacific U.S., S.E. U.S., and W. Canada and approved them as eligible for election with the exception of one nominee, whose résumé arrived at G.S.O. after the January deadline, and was returned to the area delegate in accordance with 1973 Conference action.

(continued)

The committee recommended that the résumé be presented to the 1974 Conference to decide whether they wish to honor it, overriding the 1973 Conference action.

The committee also noted three résumés did not indicate the procedure used for candidates' election in the area, and asked their nominators to clarify this at the Conference.

The committee was notified of the resignation of Dr. Travis Dancey from the General Service Board. Nominations for his replacement have not been formally solicited.

— Junior A., chairman

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Plans Accelerate for 1975 International Convention

STAFF REPORT: A.A.'s 40th Anniversary will be celebrated with an International Convention at Denver, Colo., July 4-5-6, 1975. It promises to be a memorable get-together for A.A.'s and their families. We have already received reports of charter flights from England, Belgium, Ireland, Switzerland, Germany, U.S., and Canada.

Three committees are planning this Convention: those of G.S.O., the trustees, and the Conference. G.S.O.'s committee meets at least once a month and reports quarterly to the trustees' committee, which refers various subjects to the board and the Conference committee.

Plans are to hold all meetings in Currigan Hall, but some alkathons may be in hotels. We will have the usual workshops and panel meetings. Some subjects under consideration are: Steps; Traditions; young people; armed services; Indian, Spanish-speaking, and French-speaking meetings; marathons; Big Book meetings. Also: hospitals, rehabilitation centers, prisons, central offices, Loners, Internationalists, relations with the professional community, and public information. There will be lots of alkathons!

Later, the date for the first mailing of registration and housing forms will be announced.

— Waneta N.

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE: This committee discusses all aspects of the Convention,

Denver Convention Complex

especially program changes from previous Conventions. As requested by the 1971 Conference, there will be fewer non-A.A. speakers at Denver than in Miami. G.S.O. will not pay expenses for any A.A. speaker, as always. A.A.'s will make their own arrangements with hotels for hospitality rooms.

At the committee's suggestion, the G.S. Board recommends to the Conference Convention Committee (among other items):

1. The following format for night and Sunday events: Thurs., dances; Fri., big A.A. meeting; Sat., show; Sun. a.m., spiritual meeting and closing ceremony; Fri. and Sat. midnights, alkathons.

2. That the registration and entertainment fees be combined.

3. That we include an Al-Anon and an Alateen speaker at one A.A. meeting.

4. That we prepare a questionnaire for speakers and distribute it to trustees, delegates, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and staff. It will list such items as areas of interest, length of sobriety.

5. That taping be handled by a non-A.A. professional taping service, with no individual taping being done.

6. That salable items be limited to one each for A.A.W.S., Grapevine, and Al-Anon.

7. That the Al-Anon Host Committee may sell tickets in the Convention Complex for some single event for Lois.

The committee also discussed the possible effect of the gasoline shortage on attendance, and all were optimistic that the situation will be greatly improved by 1975.

— Donald A., chairman

HOST COMMITTEE: Is Colorado A.A. ready for 1975? The answer is yes!

We are ready with 6,000 rooms under contract (more to come), many within ten minutes' walk of Currigan Convention Center, where the action will be. A few more minutes away, we will have dormitory units served by shuttle buses. Food will be available in Convention Hall. Within a couple of blocks are many eating places in all price ranges.

This can be a real adventure in your A.A. life. Denver is a great city; Colorado, a beautiful state in the "Heart of the Rockies" — a great place for a vacation. Try to join us a "Mile High in '75."

— Don P.

GRAPEVINE

Circulation Hits 76,000, but Pre-Inflation Price Holds

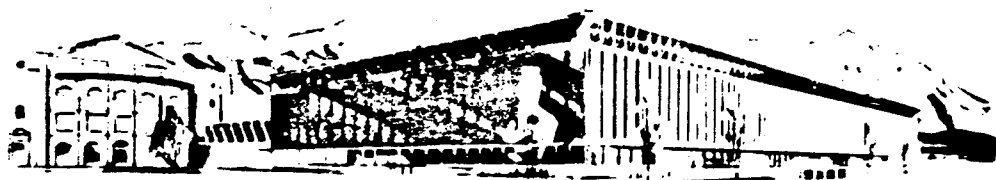
EDITORS' REPORT: Grapevine circulation is now 76,000, an increase of 5,000 over a year ago, and 25,000 calendars (5,000 over last year) were mailed. We have acquired additional needed space for offices, storage, and mailing. In 1973, we began conversion to computerized mailing. Just as we were beginning to roll, our mailers dropped their data-processing! This required a whole new conversion, and errors occurred. These are being corrected, and new steps are improving and speeding up Grapevine delivery.

Runaway prices on paper and other rising costs have been of great concern. After a long, hard look at figures, the Grapevine Corporate Board decided the price could remain 35¢. The Grapevine's objective is to reach as many readers as possible. A loss of readers as a result of a price rise would outweigh dollars to be gained.

Many readers comment on the magazine's timeliness. Pieces have dealt with newcomers sent by rehab programs and those "sentenced" to A.A. by courts. We have covered

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION

U.S.	Circulation April 1, 1974	Circulation April 1, 1973
Ala.	610	559
Alsk.	203	264
Ariz.	753	549
Ark.	526	491
Calif.	6,605	6,546
Colo.	750	631
Conn.	1,511	1,445
Del.	311	281
D.C.	335	342
Fla.	2,697	2,345
Ga.	1,250	1,239
Hawaii	165	104
Idaho	210	181
Ill.	2,952	2,713
Ind.	1,060	963
Iowa	1,024	941
Kans.	1,120	1,068
Ky.	650	548
La.	660	658
Me.	360	363



A.A. Birthday

A.A. relations with non-A.A. agencies, two-hatters, and armed-services programs. Most of all, readers appreciate emphasis on living soberly and happily through A.A.

— Jack M., Paula C.

CORPORATE BOARD: We meet quarterly to handle the *business* of the Grapevine. We are responsible for publishing the magazine and its adherence to the Traditions; we select the editorial staff and plan the budget. Daily operation is delegated to the editor and managing editor, traditionally A.A. members.

The Editorial Board, ten members with professional talents, meets bimonthly. Since 1958, this board has advised the editors, carrying out specific assignments and originating ideas for the magazine.

By December 1973, Grapevine circulation increased by 7% over 1972, and income from the magazine, calendar, and "Best of Bill" saw an increase of 7.3%. In January, the directors voted a contribution of \$8,000 to the General Fund of the G.S. Board.

In September, the Grapevine had its first computerized run. There have been problems expected in such a changeover, but with the understanding of subscribers, we hope to have smooth running shortly.

— Ralph A., chairman



TWO YALE SAVANTS
STRESS ALCOHOLISM
AS TRUE DISEASE

As the members of The Grapevine are well aware, the subject of alcoholism has been a recurring theme in the magazine. The attention to this subject is due to the fact that alcoholism is a true disease, and as such, it should be treated as such. The members of The Grapevine are well aware of this, and they are well aware of the fact that alcoholism is a true disease, and as such, it should be treated as such.

The first issue of the A.A. Grapevine, June 1944, was an eight-page newspaper, published primarily for members serving overseas during World War II. Today's 48-page magazine is designed for all A.A. members—and is read with interest by many people outside the Fellowship.

Anniversary **30** Issue

AA Grapevine Inc.

JUNE 1974 35c U.S.

GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

Total Circulation April 1, 1974: 75,702

Total Circulation April 1, 1973: 71,188

Increase for Period: 4,514

	Circulation April 1, 1974	Circulation April 1, 1973		Circulation April 1, 1974	Circulation April 1, 1973		Circulation April 1, 1974	Circulation April 1, 1973
Md.	1,498	1,445	S.C.	685	604	Canada		
Mass.	3,561	3,434	S. Dak.	415	381	Alta.	814	760
Mich.	2,585	2,408	Tenn.	755	671	B.C.	1,357	1,261
Minn.	2,338	1,972	Tex.	2,895	2,874	Man.	743	686
Miss.	540	535	Utah	310	273	N.B.	342	308
Mo.	1,110	1,059	Vt.	330	298	Nfld.	83	70
Mont.	350	329	Va.	1,335	1,279	N.W. Terr.	40	44
Nebr.	645	526	Wash.	1,550	1,383	N.S.	590	557
Nev.	230	205	W. Va.	420	414	Ont.	3,955	3,588
N.H.	402	391	Wis.	1,724	1,560	P.E.I.	143	119
N.J.	2,392	2,326	Wyo.	125	106	Que.	516	489
N.M.	380	384		65,306	61,519	Sask.	706	564
N.Y.	6,395	6,380	P.R.	97	94	Yukon	2	9
N.C.	1,534	1,425	U.S. Poss.	72	44	Total	9,291	8,455
N. Dak.	355	349				Increase for Period:		836
Ohio	2,460	2,245	Total	65,475	61,657	Foreign	936	1,076
Okla.	1,064	1,019	Increase for Period:	3,818		Decrease for Period:		140
Oreg.	614	533						
Pa.	2,210	2,159						
R.I.	347	321						

Conference Recommendations Are the

The group conscience of A.A. as a whole was plumbed and expressed by the following "advisory [to the board] actions," which the General Service Board approved at its formal annual meeting Saturday afternoon, immediately after the close of the 1974 Conference.

World Directory

The Conference approved the recommendations of the *World Directory* Study Committee that:

1. Part I (U.S. and Canada) of the *World Directory* be divided into three sections, each section subdivided by region:

- a. Eastern United States — Northeast Region, Southeast Region, and East Central Region
- b. Western United States — Pacific Region, West Central Region, and Southwest Region
- c. Canada

2. Work be scheduled so that Part II of the *World Directory* (all other countries) may be distributed before summer.

3. A staggered system of mailing, obtaining responses and processing changes on group information cards, be established to facilitate the spreading of work throughout the year.

4. Only full names and phone numbers that may be used for Twelfth Step referral and meeting information from any source be published. This will be clearly indicated on the group information card.

5. Group meeting-place information be included on back of group information cards. This is for reference at G.S.O. only, and not for the directory.

6. Delegates be asked to assume responsibility for all directory cards in their areas.

Regional Trustee Electoral Procedure

By more than a two-thirds majority, the Conference voted to make the following change in the electoral procedures for regional trustees [as presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee — see p. 25], recommending:

1. That the trustees' Nominating Committee continue to review résumés for each candidate's eligibility for nomination. Voters to consist of delegates from the region involved, plus an equal number of voters — one-half from the Conference Committee on Trustees and one-half from the trustees' Nominating Committee. And . . .

2. That a five-year moratorium be observed at the Conference on discussion of electoral procedures of regional trustees.

Five New Regional Trustees

The following regional trustees were named at the Conference by the Third Legacy election method (with the number of voters specified in #1 just above):

Peter W., E. Canada (four-year term); Bruce W., E. Cent. U.S. (three-year term); Stan W., Pacific U.S. (four-year term); Dave C., E. U.S. (three-year term); Terry P., W. Canada (two-year term).

1974 A.A. Survey

The Conference approved the proposal for A.A. survey to be conducted during the summer of 1974, and delegates agreed to cooperate in the distribution and collection of questionnaires. (See presentation on p. 13.)

Directory Listings

In special session Wednesday evening (continued from Tuesday afternoon), the Conference affirmed that all A.A. groups should be listed in the *World Directory*.* (See presentations on pp. 12-13.)

This action is in accordance with the description of "An A.A. Group" long carried in the *World Directory*:

"Traditionally, two or more alcoholics meeting together for purposes of sobriety may consider themselves an A.A. group, provided that as a group they are self-supporting and have no outside affiliation. Groups listed in the directory are listed at their own request. A directory listing does not constitute or imply approval or endorsement of any group's approach to or practice of the traditional A.A. program."

TV Appearances

Delegates were informed that the board will reconsider G.S.O.'s procedures for handling requests for TV appearances by "recovered alcoholics." In addition, the item on this subject in the November 1973 *Quarterly Report* will be further clarified.

*Conference members agreed that any A.A. member ideally should be welcome at any A.A. meeting. This would apply even to meetings held by members sharing special interests who choose (in line with Tradition Four on group autonomy) group names which may sound somewhat restrictive (such as groups for men only, women only, physicians, study, ethnic groups, those speaking certain languages, young people, priests, gay groups, policemen, beginners, lawyers and other professions or vocations, etc.) — especially when no other meeting is available for an alcoholic who needs a meeting.

The following Conference committee reports were unanimously accepted by the Conference as presented by the committee chairpersons, thus becoming Conference "advisory actions."

INSTITUTIONS

This Conference committee met separately, following the meeting with the trustees' Institutions Committee, and recommended:

1. That the 1974 trustees' Institutions Committee report be approved.

2. That G.S.O. send an inquiry to all delegates to find out the functions and structure of institutions committees in the areas, and the body to which committees report.

3. That all institutions committees and "outside" sponsors make every possible effort to cooperate with institutions' regulations and to maintain good communications with institutions' personnel.

4. That institutions committees and outside sponsors inform "inside" A.A. group officers what the "outside" A.A. members can and cannot do.

5. That the following topics be considered for the institutions session at the 1975 International Convention:

- a. Working with detox centers and rehabs.
- b. Making A.A. more attractive to inmates serving time for alcohol-related crimes.

The committee also discussed:

a. *Making A.A. more attractive to inmates.*

Some suggestions were: provide better "outside" sponsorship; rotate "inside" A.A. group officers; provide instructions for "outside" A.A. members who carry the message into institutions; provide orientation meetings about A.A. within correctional facilities prior to sending inmates to "inside" A.A. groups.

b. *Handling big influxes from detox centers.* Some suggestions were: beginners meetings; orientation discussion meetings about A.A. within detox centers; A.A. group secretaries' appointing temporary sponsors; more cooperation with halfway houses; involving more members in sponsorship; establishing sponsorship committees.

c. *The possible need for carrying the message to elderly alcoholics in nursing homes, retirement villages, and other institutions.* The sense of the meeting was that institutions committees be reminded to carry the message to the elderly alcoholic who is confined.

d. *The need for carrying the message to young people in institutions and the necessity of involving more young A.A. members in institutions activity.*

The committee felt that area and regional institutions committee get-togethers can be beneficial and might be encouraged.

Voice of the Fellowship in 1974

The committee considered an addition to its Composition, Scope and Procedure. But the sense of the meeting was that the present wording is satisfactory.

The committee elected Joe M., Tenn., chairman, and Fred B., N.Dak., alternate chairman.

REPORT AND CHARTER

The committee met in several sessions and . . .

1. Reviewed and approved rough layouts of the 1974 Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9*.
2. In an effort to familiarize A.A. members (especially those involved in service work) with the Twelve Concepts, suggested the following:

- a. That G.S.O. include a flyer in the Group Handbook informing new groups of the Concepts as a helpful tool in service work.
 - b. That the short form of the Concepts be included in a future issue of *Box 4-5-9*.
 - c. That the short form of the Concepts be included in "The A.A. Service Manual" when it is rerun.
3. Agreed to act as news reporters to assist Janet and Barry in gathering news items for the Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* and the *Conference Report*.
 4. Agreed to review and return completed draft of *Conference Report* one week after its receipt.
 5. Recommended a suggestion be made to all A.A. groups to purchase the *Conference Report*.
 6. As the Conference voted unanimously to use the alternate electoral procedure for regional trustees (see the opposite page), approved amending paragraph 3, page 98, of "The A.A. Service Manual" and Article 10 of the Conference Charter to reflect the change in electoral procedure.

The committee elected Margi B., Calif., chairman, and Bob F., Ga., alternate chairman.

LITERATURE

The committee met separately after the meeting with the trustees' Literature Committee, and recommended:

1. That the trustees' Literature Committee report be accepted.
2. That the progress report of the Big Book Subcommittee be approved, with the added suggestion that a story regarding retired persons be particularly considered.
3. That the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be reviewed and rewritten to include Twelfth Step calls as well as sponsorship, with a new suggested title, "Twelfth Step Calls and Sponsorship."
4. That in memory of A.A.'s co-founders, the last talk of each be prepared in pamphlet form and distributed.

5. That the partial draft of the new booklet "Staying Sober" be reviewed by the committee and returned with comments and suggestions to G.S.O. by June 1, 1974.

6. That the Grapevine reprints "Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous," "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends," and "Problems Other Than Alcohol" be prepared in standard pamphlet form.

7. That the trustees' Literature Committee explore the need for a pamphlet guide to taking the Fourth and Fifth Steps.

8. That the trustees' Public Information Committee continue trying to place articles about A.A. in publications for retired citizens.

The committee elected Chuck S., Ohio-Mich., chairman, and James M., N.Y., alternate chairman.

GRAPEVINE

The committee met in several sessions and recommended:

1. That the Grapevine continue to publish responsible personal opinion of A.A. members, although the Grapevine does not necessarily endorse that opinion.
2. That the "About Alcoholism" section on the gray pages of the Grapevine continue to report developments in the field of alcoholism, even though they may be contrary to A.A. philosophy.
3. That the Grapevine Corporate Board be given Conference approval to raise the price of the Grapevine for single copies and subscriptions, if the trend of rising costs indicates that the need is there.
4. That delegates carry back to their areas a proposal that groups institute the practice of giving birthday or anniversary gift subscriptions, with which the Grapevine will mail appropriate greeting cards.
5. That the use of full names in correspondence with the Grapevine would facilitate A.A. communication. (The Grapevine protects your anonymity at all times.)

PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS*

The Committee on Professional Relations met separately, following the joint meeting with the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, and recommended:

1. That information to A.A.'s about what is being done in the field of alcoholism is adequately covered in the gray pages of the Grapevine, and no additional publication is needed. Some members felt that a well-informed A.A. is a better servant.
2. That understanding the role of A.A. members who "wear two hats" would be advanced by discussion at assembly or committee meetings. A workshop on "Live and Let Live" could also be helpful in under-

standing this subject.

3. That the committee reaffirm the action of previous Conferences — that A.A.'s employed in the alcoholism field be eligible for election as trusted servants at all levels of service. It is up to the individual to assess his or her availability for the time and effort required. Criteria for choosing a trusted servant should be based on A.A. activities rather than on personal employment.

4. That, where possible, A.A. members of an area cooperate with alcoholism counselors in starting A.A. meetings in treatment centers, rather than leaving this responsibility to the counselors.

5. That, on the question of professionals' making A.A. contact, in some areas it is common knowledge how to reach A.A. In others, A.A. contacts are provided to professionals through intergroup offices, answering services, personal contact, etc.

6. That area committees on cooperation with the professional community would improve understanding and cooperation in the area.

7. That the name of the Conference Committee on Professional Relations be changed to Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, and that the full title be used instead of the initials.

Pete S., Mich., was elected chairman, and Jo H., Alaska, alternate chairman.

**Now to be called the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community (see #7 above).*

CONFERENCE POLICY

The Committee on Conference Policy met in several sessions and recommended that:

1. Committee members receive agendas for their committee *only*, but other committees' agenda be sent upon request. (The number of requests received will be reviewed at next year's meeting of this committee.)
2. Consideration be given to revising the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Committee on Conference Policy in order to clarify its function.*
3. Ex-officio committee members be discontinued. Past delegates can keep themselves informed through their delegates and the *Conference Report*.
4. Results of the 1974 evaluation questionnaire be forwarded to the delegates, and the Conference questionnaire and evaluation be continued each year (as recommended by the '73 Conference).
5. The Agenda/Admissions Committee consider the Committee on Conference Policy's recommendation that as many agenda items as possible be finalized for approval at the October trustees' Policy Committee and board meetings, so the November *Quarterly Report* will reflect this approval for early

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assembly discussions; and that further agenda items be sent to delegates as soon as approved. (See report of Agenda/Admissions Committee.)

6. The committee accept the recommendation of the Agenda/Admissions Committee that the "admissions" function of that committee be transferred to the Committee on Conference Policy.*

The committee elected Bob T., Mass., chairman, and Wesley S., Ariz., alternate chairman.

**In the future, the committee will be called the Committee on Conference Policy and Admissions. The Scope and History will be amended.*

AGENDA / ADMISSIONS

The Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee met separately, following the joint meeting with the trustees' Subcommittee on the General Service Conference, and recommended:

1. That the A.A. meeting at the opening dinner be retained, and G.S.O. and GV staffs be presented for short talks every other year, with one delegate speaker. That there be delegate speakers with a delegate chairman on alternate years, and that this format be reviewed every year by the Agenda/Admissions Committee.

2. That the "admissions" function of the Agenda/Admissions Committee be transferred to the Committee on Conference Policy, if agreeable to that committee. (See report of Committee on Conference Policy.)*

3. That this recommendation from the Committee on Conference Policy be considered: that as many Conference agenda items as possible be finalized for approval at the October Policy Committee and board meetings, so the November *Quarterly Report* will reflect this approval and allow for early assembly discussions, and that further agenda items be forwarded to the delegates as soon as the items have been approved.

4. That the 1975 Conference theme be built around unity, love, and service, and these suggestions are offered for possible 1975 Conference themes:

a. Unity Through Service

b. Unity Through Service — Gateway to the Future

c. The Traditions — Our Security

d. Unity — Through Love and Service

5. That these agenda topics be considered for 1975:

a. A discussion or workshop on the growing trend of holding regional get-togethers for past and present delegates and trustees.

b. Presentation followed by a workshop on the Twelve Concepts.

c. Presentation on "Understanding and Living the A.A. Traditions — Delegates Share Their Experience."

d. Workshop on understanding the role of A.A. members who "wear two hats."

e. Workshop on the responsibilities of district committee members.

f. A presentation on "Group Support for Group Service."

6. That the midweek A.A. meeting continue to be scheduled, with the understanding that it may be omitted if time is needed to discuss unfinished Conference business.

The committee elected Bill D., Sask., chairman, and Nancy R., Miss., alternate chairman.

**In the future, the Agenda/Admissions Committee will be called the Committee on the Conference Agenda, and its Scope and History will be amended.*

PUBLIC INFORMATION

The Conference Committee on Public Information met separately, following the joint meeting with the trustees' Public Information Committee, and recommended:

1. That the committee accept the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee.

2. That, in accordance with the G.S. Board's recommendation, the film "Bill's Own Story" be released to Al-Anon Family groups, under the same conditions as to A.A. groups.

3. That the wording of the Eleventh Tradition remain as is, and that delegates explain that "TV" is implicit in the last phrase of the Tradition: "... at the level of press, radio, and films." The committee requests that "TV" as part of the Eleventh Tradition in the P.I. Manual be deleted in the next printing.

4. That the following Conference action of 1968 be reaffirmed: "Showing the full face of an A.A. member, identified as an A.A. member, at the level of press, TV, and films, is a violation of our Tradition of Anonymity even though the name is withheld."

5. That because there are so few requests for it, G.S.O. discontinue distribution of the film "Time for Decision."

6. That we do a feature story on anonymity for press and media trade publications, and that all delegates receive a copy for local P.I. work.

7. That the following statements in the pamphlet "A.A. in Your Community" describe accurately what A.A. as a fellowship does *not* do, so the wording remain:

a. "A.A. does *not* (1) furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover . . ."

b. "A.A. does *not* (5) follow up or try to control its members."

8. That the P.I. Committee continue to review annually the P.I. Kit in an effort to delete duplicate material and make the kit more effective and manageable.

9. That G.S.O. make available to delegates the annual anonymity letter to the press, so it can be distributed to smaller newspapers in their areas.

The committee elected Jack B., Calif., chairman, and Don D., Vt., alternate chairman.

FINANCE

The Finance Committee of the Conference met jointly with the Finance Committee of the board on April 23, 1974, and reviewed the various finance reports and the G.S.O. and Grapevine budgets (see p. 39 for both). The Conference committee then met separately and made recommendations and suggestions as follows:

1. That the "money folder," "How Far Can \$3.00 Go?," be redesigned and rewritten as follows:

a. Less copy.

b. Use of a pie chart with appropriate footnotes.

c. Suggested titles: "A Penny a Day for Sobriety"; "Is Your Sobriety Worth a Penny?"

d. The section on "How to Contribute" to remain intact.

e. Inclusion of a section on how groups might distribute their contributions after group expenses are paid: that is, 60%, 30%, 10%, divided between central office or intergroup, G.S.O., and the area committee.

2. That there be better utilization of the slogan "A Penny a Day for Sobriety," maybe a brochure itemizing how little \$3.65 will buy today.

3. That the current "Regular Contribution" flyer be updated, adding a footnote, "If you have any other questions, see your G.S.R."

4. That the new flyer be sent in a mailing to groups.

5. That G.S.O. prepare a guideline for delegates on how to approach committee members and G.S.R.'s on the subject of financing, that is, how one area tackled the problem.

6. That there be broader use and explanation of the "in memoriam" envelopes.

7. Delegates emphasized that the cost to G.S.O. of servicing the Fellowship is not covered by contributions from the Fellowship; the deficit has to be made up by A.A.W.S.

8. That the area contribution toward Conference expenses be raised from \$150 to \$200.

The committee elected Richard M., Ky., chairman, and Carlton M., Me., alternate chairman.

COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

The Conference committee met separately, following the meeting with the trustees' Nominating Committee, and recommended:

1. That the report of the trustees' Nominating Committee be accepted as presented to the Conference, except for the recommendation to present a résumé received after the January 15 deadline to the 1974 Conference to allow the Conference to decide whether or not to honor it, which would override the 1973 Conference action.

2. That the slate of officers and trustees of the General Service Board (see both on p. 25) be accepted for April 1974 to April 1975.
3. That a subcommittee be set up to find a more equitable procedure for reducing the number of candidates for G.S. trustee, U.S./Canada, to be presented to the Conference for election. The subcommittee will consist of two members of the Conference Committee on Trustees and two members of the trustees' Nominating Committee. Norm A. and Horton S. will represent the Conference committee on this subcommittee, which will submit a proposal or proposals to the Conference Committee on Trustees at the 1975 Conference.

4. That the résumé form for regional trustee candidates be reviewed by the trustees' Nominating Committee and the 1975 Conference Committee on Trustees to obtain more specific information on A.A. service work, business experience, and both professional and nonprofessional work in the field of alcoholism. (Guidelines for complet-



ing résumés were discussed as a possible solution.)

Noel L., N.J., was elected chairman and Clyde J., Kans., alternate chairman.

DELEGATES-ONLY MEETING

1. Chairman offered a resolution of commendation for Kleina Jones (G.S.O. office manager, nonalcoholic) for her dedication. Unanimously approved.

2. Ted K. was thanked by the assembled delegates for his "Memo to a Delegate From

a Delegate." Suggest this continue to be a Conference mailing.

3. Motion was made from the floor to suggest to the appropriate committee that each day's meetings be opened with the Serenity Prayer and closed with the Lord's Prayer. Passed unanimously.

4. The scheduling this year was adequate and was flexible enough to meet the needs of the Conference.

5. Sense of the meeting was that all delegates felt they had free and completely involved participation in all Conference action.

— Don P., chairman

COMMITTEE ON THE 1975 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

The Conference Convention Committee met with the trustees' Convention Committee Wednesday, April 24, 1974, and elected Jack B., Calif., chairman of the Conference committee.

The committee accepted the report of the trustees' Convention Committee.

The secretary reported three trips to Denver by members of the G.S.O. Convention Planning Committee. Plans are to have approximately 26 alkathons, and perhaps an all-night alkathon. There will be workshops and panel meetings, with most meetings being large ones; all meetings except the midnight alkathons will be held in the Convention Complex. The secretary said there will be no advantage to A.A. members' staying in the headquarters hotel, because no meetings will take place there during the day.

She reported we have 250 rooms (housing 500 people) at Colorado College for Women (connecting bath between twin-bed rooms) and the same number of rooms at Loretta

Heights College, with three to five bathrooms on each floor. We are negotiating for rooms at Regis College (one bathroom on each floor). If camping facilities are available, we will try to mail a list of them about six months before the Convention.

The Conference committee will be kept informed by the trustees' committee from now through July 6, 1975. We will add five more members to this committee in January 1975.

The committee reviewed and confirmed recommendations of the 1972 Conference:

That the number of non-A.A. speakers be limited; that they be people interested in A.A. and alcoholism; that there be at least one A.A. meeting held at the same time non-A.A.'s are speaking, so that members will always have a choice; that speakers on the Sunday spiritual panel be A.A. members.

Other items discussed were:

1. Parking space near the Convention Complex. A new parking lot is being built near

the complex, so it was felt this would not be a problem.

2. The Host Committee requested that a subcommittee of the Host Committee be established to make certain all restaurants in and around the complex will be open during the holiday weekend. Food will be served at snack bars in the complex.

3. It was decided that Al-Anon be requested not to hold a sunrise meeting at Red Rocks, because it might call upon buses needed for the A.A. Sunday-morning spiritual meeting.

4. The Host Committee will have the responsibility of planning and handling the luncheon for delegates, past delegates, trustees, and past trustees.

5. Some delegates reported their annual conferences and conventions will not be held in 1975, so their members can apply this expense to attending the International.

6. First flyer on the Convention will be mailed in the fall, with information about Denver, the weather, and other pertinent data.

ALASKA — I stumbled into service out of my business background and a healthy fear of drinking again. Many members advised me never to turn down a request for any A.A. services — the only way to repay the debt I owed A.A. I served as secretary, G.S.R., and area treasurer before becoming delegate. No one mentioned the enormous rewards that would come. I have maintained sobriety and been associated with people in and out of A.A. who have become dear friends.

— Jo H.

ALBERTA — After being in A.A. a short time, I was told service was part of recovery. My sponsor felt newcomers should be told real soon. To serve with love is not something I was born with, and giving was not one of the few assets I had on arrival in A.A. But this changed with time. The training program is still in progress. Through tolerance and understanding, the impossible became reality. For all this, I will be forever grateful.

— Bill L.

ARIZONA — I was blessed with a very service-minded sponsor. I asked two questions: "Who are the bosses?" and "Who gets the money?" My sponsor recognized opportunity and shoved me into service work. It has been pretty much a do-as-you-are-told arrangement ever since: member, secretary, G.S.R., court class speaker, meeting-starter, state chairman, dance-arranger, play actor, stage manager, and now delegate. The most personally gratifying, other than twelfth-stepping, was a part in our Twelve Traditions play. This half-hour skit takes a humorous approach. "Service work" is a misnomer; I call it "service fun or pleasure." The rewards of serving outweigh the effort.

— Wes S.

CALIFORNIA (Mid-Southern) — After several stints as group secretary, I began thinking, "What comes next?" I was married to the group's G.S.R., but never thought such work might hold interest for me. Recovery was my sole concern. But then he became a committee member, and I began to hear about groups' responsibility to elect qualified G.S.R.'s. I began reading the Traditions, "A.A. Comes of Age," and "The A.A. Service Manual." Before I was through, I was G.S.R. and shortly thereafter, district secretary. My work on the area committee has helped me with personal tragedies that might have overwhelmed me were it not for this Fellowship and the privilege to be involved in the *total program* as a trusted servant.

— Genevieve L.

CALIFORNIA (Northern Interior) — First elected G.S.R. about ten years ago, I didn't know what a G.S.R. was. I remember my surprise when I saw my name in the *World Directory* and wondered how it got there. (The secretary had sent it.) Later, a member came to speak on the Third Legacy. I wondered what the First and the Second were. Still later, I was able to ask questions and was given a copy of "The A.A. Service Manual." I have also been group secretary, and in intergroup, hospital, and institutions-committee work. A.A. service is one of the most exciting and fulfilling experiences of my life.

— Jack B.

CALIFORNIA (San Diego) — Two years sober, I started attending our assembly. My husband, a very active member, was always going to every kind of meeting, and I didn't want to be left out. About this time, I asked a new women's group if they would like to be represented at the assembly. They just left it up to me. As a committee member, I worked very hard to get all the groups represented. We have now

tripled the size of our assembly. One important part of our growth has been Traditions breakfasts. Someone speaks on how Traditions have helped him.

— Margi B.

DELAWARE — Through attending state assembly meetings, first as an onlooker, when my co-sponsor asked me to go with him, and then as a G.S.R. myself, I found out how important the service part of A.A. is. My favorite theme is "I am responsible." Having the A.A. answering phone in my area and being fortunate in having been elected delegate this year, I am looking forward to growing more in my A.A. way of life.

— Clayton H.

GEORGIA — When I was finally dry, I was told I must do those things that needed to be done. I tried to get someone else to do them before I had to. I went on many calls and talked whenever asked. But when it was time to elect a G.S.R., I helped find someone else. When my group told me I would be the next G.S.R., I tried it, and I liked it. When first approached to become delegate, I refused. I was finally persuaded my friends were entitled to a choice. During my drinking, I never bothered to ask God's will for me. Since I have been asking, my cup runs over with the nectar I long rejected.

— Bob F.

IDAHO — To me, general service is the transport system of A.A. We could not live without such a system, to bring us products we need and to deliver what we produce. In our body, our circulatory system is this means of transportation. It brings nutrients to each of our billions of cells. Without a good transport system, A.A. would have a hard time surviving.

— Donald B.

ILLINOIS (Northern) — My group needed someone to be G.S.R. I volunteered, but my services were declined, as I had only been on the program two months. I started to read A.A. literature to further my knowledge. I acquainted myself, not only with the Steps, but with the Traditions. Before the year was up, I was G.S.R. I served five consecutive terms, as the group was quite small and I didn't have much of a choice. I became acquainted with "The A.A. Service Manual," though I did not read it thoroughly until after I was elected committee member. I have made A.A. service a hobby, and I really enjoy it.

— Hank S.

INDIANA (Southern) — I helped start a group in our city, so I became the G.S.R., knowing nothing about G.S.O. I began getting Box 4-5-9, and sent for "The A.A. Service Manual," which made me want to know more. At my first state committee meeting, I was elected treasurer. I realized the need for better communications. I was enjoying life at last. I belonged, I was wanted, and for the first time I had a feeling of being responsible. I became involved in helping plan G.S.R. meetings and an A.A. conference. The more activities we created, the less dissension there was. We formed an intergroup among small towns within a radius of 50 miles. Maybe the word is gratitude.

— Don W.

KANSAS — I served as secretary and program chairman of some groups, and four years ago I was asked to be G.S.R. of my hometown group. Soon after, I was elected district committee member. Our committee started a meeting on Saturday evenings to study "The A.A. Service Manual." I attended every round robin in our district and always said something about general service, the Grapevine, or our state committee — to

pass along the idea it was important to be of service in a larger way than just our own district or group. — *Clyde J.*

KENTUCKY — I was elected G.S.R. twice. The first time, I did nothing and got nothing out of it. The second time, I was still lazy. However, we were having elections at a state committee meeting. Since no one wanted the secretary-treasurer job, my sponsor talked me into it. I honestly became interested. The rewards were more than I ever dreamed. I saw a lot of people like me who hadn't taken the time to read or learn about service. I decided to do everything I could to let A.A.'s know about our service structure. I owe A.A. any service and time it asks. I know who will benefit — as always, me.

— *Mick McF.*

MAINE — After I was a member for about six months, I became group secretary. The group had three meetings a week, and I made coffee and brought refreshments for five and a half years. I went to district and area meetings as acting G.S.R. when our G.S.R. and alternate were not available. About three years ago, I was given a state office, and now I am the delegate. I must have been aware of the "I am responsible" theme, although I do not recall thinking of it at the time. So here I am!

— *Carlton M.*

MANITOBA — On my first A.A. birthday, I was given "A.A. Comes of Age," one of the most fascinating histories I ever read. As I marveled at the early members who persevered through the trial-and-error period of A.A.'s growth, the service picture came into focus: The Three Legacies belong to *all* the members, to put into action. I felt gratitude for the experience that had gone before. The responsibility slogan took on new dimensions when my group elected me alternate G.S.R. I look forward to the loving and learning through service that ensure A.A. will be available for the alcoholic yet to come.

— *Reeta H.*

MARYLAND — I was blessed with two wonderful sponsors, who gave me a desire to learn all I could about A.A. I read the Big Book, "A.A. Comes of Age," and the pamphlets available then. One sponsor explained to me the Three Legacies of A.A. — Recovery, Unity, Service — and the importance of them all to my personal sobriety, my group, and A.A. as a whole. When I read "The Third Legacy Manual," I became interested enough to attend assembly meetings as a visitor. Maryland general service has grown from 20 people to over 100 representatives participating regularly.

— *Tom S.*

MASSACHUSETTS (Western) — I came back to A.A. for a second try in 1968, still unwilling to accept the recovery program, let alone become active in the service structure. But a few people volunteered my services for the institutions committee. Members made the effort, week after week, to bring A.A. to out-of-the-way prisons. Almost without realizing it, I began to feel a part of this tremendous service structure. Most of the new institutions have been medical, rather than correctional. Through our activities, there has been frequent exposure of A.A. to the professional community. More and more, we are becoming aware of our need to communicate freely with the professionals, to insure that a feeling of cooperation and not competition exists.

— *Bob T.*

MICHIGAN (Western) — On December 17, 1947, when I exchanged my number for a name, I never in my wildest

imagination believed I would be chosen by my fellow A.A.'s to be their delegate in New York. My sponsor was a great one for getting new members involved. He stated that A.A. was more than sobriety; it meant getting involved. The heart of the program was to really "practice these principles in all our affairs" — and that meant general service also. Now, when I have a bad day, I know I am not practicing the principles in *all* my affairs.

— *Pete S.*

MINNESOTA (Northern) — When I joined A.A., in 1969, we met in the public library, once a week. As we grew to 50 or 60 members, some of us felt all of us were not getting all we should out of A.A. So we formed a corporation to provide meeting quarters. We now have five meetings a week, look forward to more and to starting more groups. We have a rehab center in our city; a halfway house should be going soon, giving us a chance to take A.A. to many.

— *Gordon H.*

MISSISSIPPI — During my first year, I accidentally ordered "The Third Legacy Manual." It confirmed that there was a big, wonderful A.A. world outside my own group. Little by little, I came to realize the difference between local and general service. It seemed to me the "happies" were involved in *everything*. My endeavors to cooperate with our state hospital and other agencies made me keenly aware of our Traditions. Only brand-new delegates can understand my feelings of inadequacy and unworthiness, coupled with responsibility and gratitude.

— *Nancy R.*

MONTANA — My group needed a steward, to make coffee and do dishes and other janitorial jobs. They chose me. It was a proud day in my life; somebody wanted me. I became G.S.R., made state conferences, and in 1970 became state chairman. When I recited the Unity pledge in Miami with 99 other A.A.'s, I cried so hard I couldn't find my way off the stage. I knew then I had to do more than just stay sober. I've served in every capacity I could.

— *Wayne B.*

NEBRASKA — When I came into A.A., my physical health was partially repaired in a hospital, but my mental self was a mess. I stayed dry, but was not happy. One sponsor told me, "Get into the A.A. program. You are just *on* it!" He told me to twelfth-step, go to outside meetings, talk to non-A.A. groups, and help make coffee and clean up. After a couple of years, I started going to state meetings as our G.S.R., finally became a committee member, and now delegate. I feel humble to be a very small part of the service part of A.A.

— *Neal B.*

NEW BRUNSWICK/PRINCE EDWARD ISLAND — I became interested in service when my sponsor started a new group and asked me to join him. Together, we went on many Twelfth Step calls. From this group, five others started. I became secretary, G.S.R., then committee member, and we attended all the roundups and assembly meetings. Being area secretary-treasurer was a service I enjoyed immensely. I met so many wonderful people. Now I have the privilege of being the delegate for my area. I ask my Higher Power and A.A. to help me do the best possible job.

— *Eddie MacI.*

NEW HAMPSHIRE — On arrival in Vietnam in 1966, three of us formed a group at Cam Ranh Bay to insure our own sobriety. We received many new prospects referred to us by chaplains and the wing psychiatrist. By the time I rotated home, A.A. was well established. With more A.A. members

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coming from the U.S., it grew throughout Vietnam. Returning home, I became active in local A.A. and served as group treasurer, alternate G.S.R., G.S.R., and state institutions chairman. I served on a committee to rewrite procedures for the assembly, because we've been suffering growing pains and changing our assembly structure. And now I'm a delegate.

— *Pete C.*

NEW JERSEY (Southern) — My introduction to A.A. was at Lewisburg Federal Penitentiary. I have been sober since 1958. I held the positions of group and intergroup treasurer, secretary, and chairman. I staged intergroup banquets, with proceeds to G.S.O., and public information meetings. We tried a Spanish-speaking group. In 1968-69, I became a G.S.R., then area committee member. Recently, we've had seminars for G.S.R.'s, also attended by committee members and other A.A.'s, arousing interest in the Traditions. As alternate delegate, I filled in at the 1973 Conference.

— *Noel L.*

NEW MEXICO — I was introduced to A.A. in a hospital for alcoholics. A few words of the counselors remained with me: "Attend meetings," "Stick with the winners," and "To keep what we have, we must give it away." "Giving it away" was a problem. It seemed unlikely I had anything anybody wanted. Eventually, I was group secretary, then G.S.R. Serving on our intergroup committee was the beginning of a new world for me. I began to learn the importance of our Third Legacy and the many services to be performed. In 1973, my name was drawn from the hat. I shall be forever grateful.

— *Lorraine S.*

NEW YORK (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire) — In November 1959, I had my last drink. In December, I volunteered to wash the dishes. My sponsor said if I wanted sobriety I had to put something back into A.A. Now this year, 1974, the Conference! How fortunate we are! Please continue to make A.A. better. People in A.A. are so good and kind to me. I've learned so much from my Conference buddy, Paul, and from the chairman of my committee, Don. I could hardly wait for this wonderful A.A. week.

— *A. ("Tiny") D.*

NEW YORK (Western) — Being taken by my sponsor to an assembly to make coffee and set up for the meeting opened a new way of life for me. I held all offices at group level; promoted the Grapevine person to person; became G.S.R.; went to a world Convention and met Bill; to New York for his anniversary dinner, and met Lois and Bill; got involved in the P.I.C., seeing the interest of others in A.A. Then mine was one of two names to go into the hat, and here I am. Highlights? I'd rather call them blessings.

— *James McC.*

NORTH DAKOTA — Shortly after I entered the program, a growling little five-foot ex-drunk (my sponsor) informed me that if I expected help, I'd have to get involved. The quickest way was to empty ashtrays, sweep the floor, and wash cups. Little did I realize a great gift was being offered me — doing something for someone else. I found myself visiting treatment centers, involved in Twelfth Step calls. Later, I was elected G.S.R. I was able to help a couple of new groups get started. Last fall, I received the trust of A.A.'s from my state to be their delegate. You people in A.A. have kept me so busy, I haven't had time to drink.

— *Fred B.*

OHIO (Northwestern) / MICHIGAN (Southeastern) — I had the opportunity of meeting Bill W. in Akron, and heard him

tell his story of early general service work. Having a close relationship with past delegates of our area, I participated in two state conferences, and have been active in intergroup work. I have attended many regional and state conferences. My attendance at four to five meetings a week apparently has given A.A.'s in our area confidence in me to represent them.

— *Chuck S.*

OHIO (South Southwestern) / KENTUCKY (Northern) — One day, a close friend told me she was moving to Florida and I was to be G.S.R. beginning the following Sunday. Well, I immediately was elected committee member. In our area, committee officers are chosen from committee members. Although there is a free election, a sort of rotation has become a pattern. I was made treasurer, then chairman. The delegate remarried and moved, and I became delegate by default — all this after only twelve short and beautiful years of affiliation with G.S.O.

— *Roy H.*

ONTARIO (Western) — My sponsor volunteered me as group secretary, then intergroup representative, then alternate G.S.R. Here, I found that service was the heart of A.A. Here, I might in some small way repay a little of what I received. I strongly suggest: If you do not have a good area-committee setup, get one soon — it gets a lot done. Also, have fully informed and knowledgeable alternate G.S.R.'s. Then we will no longer hear that cry, "My group made me G.S.R. What does this mean?"

— *Duncan McA.*

OREGON — I heard a member say his sponsor urged him to get *in* the program, not *on* it, because it was easier to fall *off* than to fall *out*. The member explained that becoming active in service work helped him maintain his sobriety. I asked him what I could do. He nominated me for secretary, and my service career began. Since then, I have served as G.S.R., hospital chairman, and state treasurer and in various conference and intergroup activities. The privilege to serve is the most rewarding activity of my life.

— *Howard S.*

PUERTO RICO — Since I came to the program from the bottom, I started to serve from that bottom. Frequently, I go back there for my own good. I refer to the services that were the easiest ones for me, and still are — to sweep, mop, and arrange the chairs of the meeting place. I have served as treasurer, secretary, chairman, intergroup representative, twelfth-stepper, and finally G.S.R. At the delegate elections, the chairman asked that persons interested in running for the service keep seated, and persons *not* interested stand up. I was the only person to stay seated. I am still surprised, but trying to do my best — learning and asking.

— *Trinidad R. C.*

QUEBEC (Northeastern) — I did all the jobs in A.A.: coffee-maker, ashtray-cleaner, secretary. I had the Twelfth Step phone at home many months, and when intergroup opened, I gave all the hours I could. I went around the province listening, catching the fever and the attraction of general services. In 1963, we had the Big Book in French, so we read more about Bob and Bill, and then I got very interested. A.A. is my real family. I have a few babies. I suggested to all of them to read the Big Book and "The A.A. Service Manual." Maybe one of them will be a responsible member of the general service structure.

— *Julie P.*

QUEBEC (Northwestern) — My area covers about 40,000

square miles, with 115 groups, mostly French. Communications are very difficult on account of the distances — 400 miles north and 150 miles west. Moreover, the area includes a national park without any population — 125 miles of bush country. Therefore, the Abitibi District is completely isolated from the rest, and its groups are isolated from each other. Five district members have the responsibility of about 20 groups per district, but I still have to organize Abitibi.

— *Clarence G.*

QUEBEC (Southwestern) — My area is fortunate, for the services at our disposal are numerous and complete. About 70 of the 250 groups are English-speaking; the balance, French. Our area, approximately 100 square miles, includes most of greater Montreal. We have, as yet, no area committee. But we have literature in French, French tapes, a penal and hospital committee, public information at all levels (French and English), and our magazine, *La Vigne*. I became interested in general service work through being a G.S.R. and through the public information committee.

— *Louis G.*

RHODE ISLAND — I remember a deep feeling of security when the news of our inheritance of the Three Legacies was first given to us, in 1955. Every service in A.A. had always been fulfilling to me, and now I knew I was a part of a fellowship which was solid. The more active I became and the more I read all literature which came out, the more secure and fulfilled I became. I am truly grateful to A.A. for giving me the privilege of serving and sharing.

— *Dorothy G.*

SASKATCHEWAN — My interest in service work began when a friend of mine asked me to sponsor a group at a correctional center. I became a G.S.R., then D.C.M., and now here I am, delegate. Perhaps the most rewarding highlight in my service career was when I was asked to make up a kit for each committee member. The kit contained Guidelines, "Service Manual," directories, Group Handbook, registration cards for new groups, the latest *Conference Report*, etc.

— *Bill D.*

SOUTH CAROLINA — I became interested in general service work while still drinking! My husband is also an alcoholic and found sobriety in A.A. six years before I did. He would persuade me to stay away from the bottle some Sunday mornings and attend state assemblies with him. I'd sit there shaking, sweating, watching the clock for the time I could get out and get at the bottle always carried in my bag. However, I realize now these meetings played a vital part in my sobriety. I was intrigued and awed by the scope of this wonderful Fellowship. I still am.

— *Peggy B.*

SOUTH DAKOTA — Starting a new group, I was there when we got our first kit from G.S.O. Because I had a car and the time, it was soon my turn to be G.S.R., to begin to learn what A.A. is all about. I served on the district, P.I. and institutional committees. At the Toronto Convention in 1965, I was all eyes and ears, with a feeling of awe and gratitude. I also left Miami Beach in 1970 with the I-can't-believe-it feeling. That so many fragments from so far apart could actually make a whole was almost unbelievable. Our midterm workshop has grown from eight G.S.R.'s and committee members to about 200 people.

— *Horton S.*

TENNESSEE — Formation of a new group brought me into Service. I saw fewer people interested in this, as opposed to

the Legacies of Recovery and Unity — hence my decision to remain active in the Third Legacy. Dr. Bob stressed the importance of love and service. Dedicated pursuance has been rewarding and gratifying. I see Service as an excellent means of communication among groups, for the growth of the whole. It guarantees A.A. will be here for the alcoholic, this year or 30 years from now.

— *Joe M.*

TEXAS (Northwestern) — I did not get into service because of prior knowledge or interest, but because of willingness to do whatever was asked in this Fellowship. It is the umbrella that shields me from the little black cloud that used to hover over me all the time. My A.A. education consisted mostly of fellowship, the Big Book, and the "Twelve and Twelve." Making sure that groups have literature still is one of my favorite projects. As G.S.R., I began to learn that A.A. was no accident. Its continued growth depends on our willingness as individuals to use all the tools given to us so freely.

— *Brian G.*

TEXAS (Southwestern) — My interest in the structure of A.A. began soon after my first meeting. I had purchased the Big Book, "A.A. Comes of Age," and a Grapevine subscription. I had no thought of not drinking, but . . . might as well read them. My interest in service picked up when I became G.S.R. We were a small, isolated group, and visiting other groups was what I needed. As committee member, I began to realize the meaning of responsibility and how little I knew. "Read the Manual," our delegate advised. But I must not forget how wonderful it is to drink a cup of coffee with someone in an institution, because I came to my first meeting so I would not have to go back to jail.

— *Tony F.*

VERMONT — I finally realized I had received much in A.A. and given little. Maybe my group felt the same way; they elected me G.S.R. In 1972, our county groups were asked to put on the '73 state convention. We became the first structured district in Vermont. The committee felt one committee member — me — did not have much to do, so he should be convention chairman. Six weeks before the convention, I was injured in an accident. I heard they panicked, but with the structure and unity they had, they put on a beautiful convention.

— *Don D.*

WISCONSIN (Northern) / MICHIGAN (Upper) — I first saw the importance of general service when I went to help conduct meetings in prisons. I realized how much outside information and communication meant to these individuals and to new members. I serve 160 groups with 1,682 members, holding 201 meetings a week. We have spring and fall conferences with Al-Anon and Alateen. We maintain good communications with social workers, hospitals, courts, etc. County-operated alcoholism information centers help a great deal in directing people to A.A. Intergroup meetings are held monthly. Many times, we would be at a loss were it not for sharing through G.S.O.

— *Paul S.*

WYOMING — At first, most of my work in A.A. was on the local level. At a state conference six years ago, the delegate-elect asked me to stand for alternate delegate, and I was elected. He could not go his second year, so the job fell to me. Many aspects of service I had never dreamed of were revealed to me. There is more to giving this program away than just making a Twelfth Step call now and then. Over the years, this work in A.A. has been most rewarding to me.

— *Sam L.*

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1973

INCOME	1973	1972
Net Sales, after book discounts waived of \$80,561 in 1973 and \$62,397 in 1972	\$1,152,873	\$ 830,347
Less: Cost of printing	324,182	244,472
Royalties	116,997	89,396
Gross Profit from Literature	711,694	496,479
Contributions – A.A. Groups and Members	645,903	564,334
Interest Income	10,526	2,054
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>1,368,123</u>	<u>1,062,867</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	608,775	510,157
Rent	66,214	50,747
Office construction costs	82,468	9,194
Box 4-5-9	29,544	23,569
World Directory	44,664	37,559
Other Service Office printing	28,089	25,397
Shipping and mailing	124,028	95,148
Other office expenses	128,193	90,364
Insurance and taxes	51,087	40,433
Professional services	20,000	13,880
Board, committee, staff meetings	22,129	18,451
1972 World Meeting	—	14,747
Writing, research	3,911	1,882
P.I.C., P.R.C., travel	22,463	13,410
General Service Conference	46,394	39,417
Foreign literature aid	650	898
Film, film strip, display boards	1,667	4,144
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>1,280,276</u>	<u>989,397</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>87,847</u>	<u>73,470</u>

NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION

Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 321,841	\$ 190,881
General Fund – General Service Board	(233,994)	(117,411)

CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS – 1973

	Reserve	Pension	Memorial	Convention Guaranty
Balance, January 1, 1973	\$289,896	\$13,161	\$39,755	\$14,036
Book discounts		80,561		
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		3,500		
Investment Income	19,278	1,841		848
Transferred to General Fund			(39,755)	
Less: Current funding costs		(34,782)		
Actuary Fee		(4,678)		
Balance, December 31, 1973	<u>309,174</u>	<u>59,603</u>	<u>-0-</u>	<u>14,884</u>

() Denotes red figures.

Amounts in these financial statements under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 – by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts – for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance Committee.

(continued on opposite page)

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1973

	1973	1972
INCOME – from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$310,608</u>	<u>\$289,373</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries	\$ 44,679	\$ 41,924
Printing	71,407	65,166
Mailing – Service	31,474	27,601
Postage	4,534	2,025
Other printing costs	5,341	3,667
Calendar costs	12,845	10,198
Best Cartoons	1,089	1,053
Rent	7,940	6,594
Telephone	1,235	1,324
Office supplies and expense	2,579	2,305
Other editorial expenses	3,503	2,939
Office cleaning	1,348	1,041
<u>Total</u>	<u>\$187,974</u>	<u>\$165,837</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	58,222	52,729
ADP processing costs	7,662	–
Stationery and supplies	2,513	2,565
Rent	7,940	6,594
Telephone	1,235	1,324
Other office expense	1,349	1,101
Selling expense	11,947	7,524
Postage	7,873	7,294
Office cleaning	1,348	1,040
Bad debts	1,842	1,129
<u>Total</u>	<u>101,931</u>	<u>81,300</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	3,387	3,204
Legal and accounting	4,300	7,215
Taxes	5,143	6,426
Meetings and conferences	974	540
Furniture and equipment	1,525	–
Contribution to Retirement Plan	3,500	3,500
Office relocation	2,666	–
<u>Total</u>	<u>21,495</u>	<u>20,885</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>311,400</u>	<u>268,022</u>
INCOME (DEFICIT) FROM OPERATIONS	(792)	21,351
Add: Interest on savings accounts	<u>10,267</u>	<u>9,430</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u><u>9,475</u></u>	<u><u>30,781</u></u>

(continued)

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND, which was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the benefit of employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. prior to transfer to the Trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

The CONVENTION GUARANTY FUND was established in 1972 by subscriptions from A.A. members in Colorado, and by a transfer from the General Fund for the purpose of making up a deficit, if any, incurred in connection with the Convention to be held in Denver in 1975. To the extent not so used it is to be refunded to the original subscribers.

(continued on next page)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1973

OPERATING FUNDS	December 31, 1973		December 31, 1972	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash	\$ 89,538	\$ 92,412	\$102,386	\$ 53,373
Savings accounts and certificates	162,421	20,386	127,049	9,354
Marketable securities	—	125,169	—	125,169
Accounts receivable	123,963	8,392	55,406	13,163
Quebec General Service Committee	—	—	3,913	—
Due from Grapevine	8,000	—	2,000	—
Inventories	300,318	8,625	169,300	8,722
Prepaid expenses	24,563	7,585	21,287	5,860
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>708,803</u>	<u>262,569</u>	<u>481,341</u>	<u>215,641</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	150,353	19,035	60,674	8,372
Due Pension Fund	6,625	—	4,444	—
Prepaid subscriptions, unearned income	—	170,913	—	136,122
Reserve for Retirement Plan payments	—	7,000	—	7,000
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>156,978</u>	<u>196,948</u>	<u>65,118</u>	<u>151,494</u>
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	416,223	64,146	337,253	45,366
Net income for year (Exhibits A and B)	87,847	9,475	73,470	30,781
Contribution received (paid)	8,000	(8,000)	12,000	(12,000)
Transfer to Convention Fund	—	—	(6,500)	—
Transfer Memorial Fund	39,755	—	—	—
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>551,825</u>	<u>65,621</u>	<u>416,223</u>	<u>64,147</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$501,380		\$329,539	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note A)	50,445		86,684	
<u>Total Operating Funds — as above</u>	<u>551,825</u>		<u>416,223</u>	
Reserve Fund	309,174		289,896	
Deferred Pension Fund	59,603		13,161	
Memorial Fund	—		39,755	
Convention Guaranty Fund	14,884		14,036	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>935,486</u>		<u>773,071</u>	
RESERVE, DEFERRED PENSION, MEMORIAL AND CONVENTION GUARANTY FUNDS	<u>Reserve</u>	<u>Pension</u>	<u>Memorial</u>	<u>Convention</u>
Cash	\$ 25,559			
Savings accounts and certificates	14,443	\$ 61,810		\$ 14,675
Due from A.A.W.S. and Grapevine		7,500		
U.S. Treasury obligations	155,021			
Government Agency and Corporate Bonds	109,320			
Accrued interest	4,831			209
Less: Due Retirement Trust		(9,707)		
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>309,174</u>	<u>59,603</u>	<u>—0—</u>	<u>14,884</u>

() Denotes red figures.

(continued from p. 37)

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and which may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed. In 1973 the Conference approved the consolidation of the MEMORIAL FUND — which was established in 1971 to receive contributions from A.A. groups and members in memory of Bill W. — with the GENERAL FUND.

NOTE A — After transfers of \$150,000 in 1973 and \$100,000 in 1972 from Publishing to General Fund.

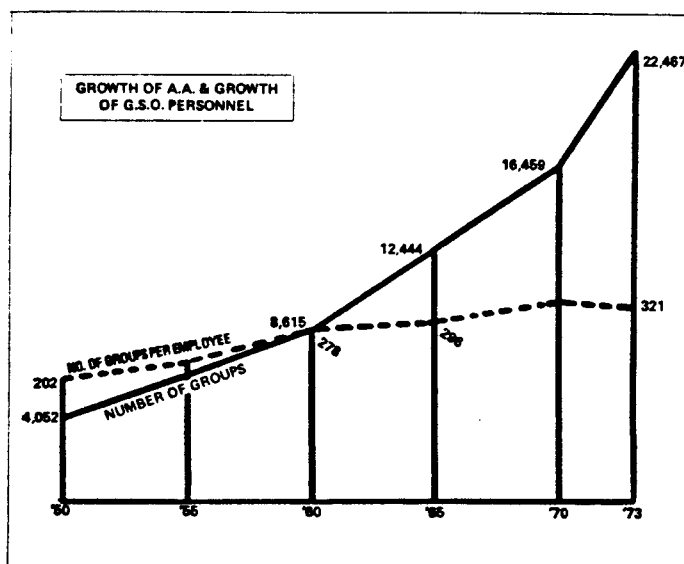
These financial statements and notes have been prepared by the independent certified public accountants from the figures contained in their reports on the three separate corporations.

Growth & Money at G.S.O.

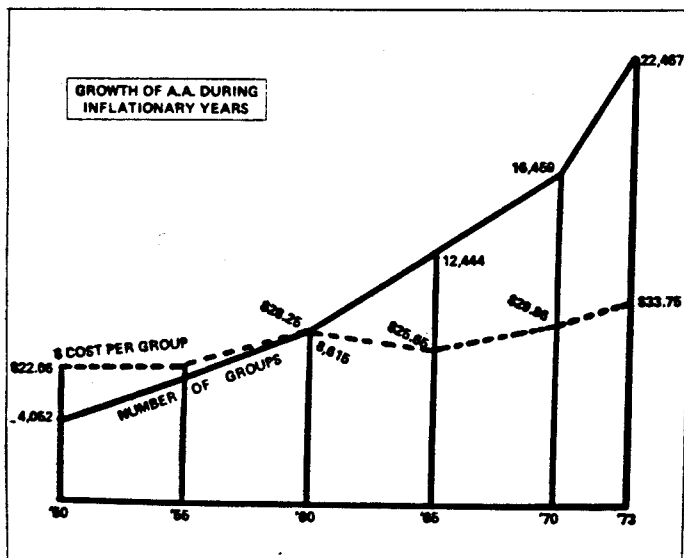
How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel – in 1950 there was one employee for each 202 groups. Today, one employee serves each 321 groups.

During the past twenty-three years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$89,500 to \$758,200 for group services. During that same period, cost of living increased 95%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per group actually showed a decrease from \$22.06 to \$17.21.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Cost
1950	4,052	20	202	\$22.06	100
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	107
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	119
1965	12,444	42	296	25.65	126
1970	16,459	50	329	29.86	159
1973	22,467	70	321	33.75	195



1. (Above) There are more than 5 times as many groups today as in 1950. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 321 groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 202 in 1950.



2. (Above) During the years 1950 through 1973, even though the cost of living increased 95 percent, constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per group to \$33.75 in 1973 compared with \$22.06 in 1950, an increase of only 52 percent.

1974 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1974 Operations of G.S.O. activities – exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine – is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$1,302,000*
Less: Cost of Products	534,000
Gross Profit from Sales	768,000

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	334,500
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*Based upon the sale of:

123,300 Books – "Alcoholics Anonymous"

50,200 Books – "12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Reg.)

17,700 Books – "12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Pocket)

13,500 Books – "A.A. Comes of Age"

20,600 Books – "As Bill Sees It"

and
Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$698,600
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TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	787,900**
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**Includes cost of General Service Conference – \$50,400

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 9,000
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TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of Income (Expense)	72,500***
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***Board Meetings, P.I.C. Expense, C.P.C. Expense and Special Projects.

The Publishing activity will contribute \$152,800 to offset the budgeted deficits.

1974 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales.....	\$324,600
Estimated Expense.....	329,500

Net income from operations..... (4,900)

Interest from investments..... 11,000

Net Income..... 6,100

1973 Group Contributions

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alabama	110	51	46.4%	17	33.3%	\$ 3,377.86	1,496	\$ 2.25
Alaska	39	29	74.4	7	24.1	1,788.77	392	4.56
Arizona	200	115	57.5	31	27.0	6,651.85	2,183	3.05
Arkansas	93	53	57.0	17	32.1	3,538.10	1,201	2.95
California	1,892	1,036	54.8	399	38.5	74,398.72	43,550	1.70
Colorado	183	115	62.8	43	37.4	7,652.96	2,906	2.63
Connecticut	297	181	60.9	55	30.4	13,159.48	5,169	2.45
Delaware	43	34	79.1	13	38.2	2,377.60	711	3.34
Dist. of Columbia	73	52	71.2	32	61.5	6,568.48	2,236	2.94
Florida	463	299	64.6	133	44.5	37,001.71	8,243	4.49
Georgia	187	148	79.1	62	41.9	7,935.48	3,161	2.51
Hawaii	48	38	79.2	11	28.9	3,795.26	1,080	3.51
Idaho	57	31	54.4	8	25.8	1,301.60	778	1.67
Illinois	1,019	448	44.0	129	28.8	21,705.52	18,079	1.20
Indiana	240	173	72.1	64	37.0	13,318.81	3,463	3.84
Iowa	145	91	62.8	27	29.7	6,283.00	2,653	2.37
Kansas	149	97	65.1	35	36.1	7,610.78	2,671	2.85
Kentucky	154	62	40.3	25	40.3	5,185.98	1,851	2.80
Louisiana	132	82	62.1	24	29.3	4,697.25	2,060	2.28
Maine	71	50	70.4	19	38.0	2,552.12	912	2.79
Maryland	265	176	66.4	68	38.6	12,260.23	3,819	3.21
Massachusetts	404	208	51.5	97	46.6	14,689.68	8,631	1.70
Michigan	468	305	65.2	144	47.2	28,383.91	8,669	3.27
Minnesota	351	232	66.1	61	26.3	18,037.75	10,320	1.75
Mississippi	69	44	63.8	17	38.6	2,200.82	905	2.43
Missouri	250	139	55.6	49	35.3	7,229.48	3,799	1.90
Montana	85	47	55.3	19	40.4	1,921.96	949	2.03
Nebraska	121	86	62.8	38	44.2	5,336.63	1,748	3.06
Nevada	68	49	72.1	25	51.0	4,392.86	1,201	3.66
New Hampshire	70	44	62.9	16	36.4	2,419.60	1,121	2.16
New Jersey	395	260	65.8	133	51.2	21,842.87	6,419	3.40
New Mexico	78	50	64.1	21	42.0	3,248.28	887	3.66
New York	887	558	62.9	286	51.3	49,511.52	16,011	3.09
North Carolina	250	162	64.8	64	39.5	10,289.81	3,310	3.11
North Dakota	74	49	66.2	13	26.5	2,397.45	857	2.80
Ohio	627	339	54.1	104	30.7	20,300.70	11,146	1.82
Oklahoma	145	119	82.1	75	63.0	8,751.58	1,910	4.59
Oregon	143	88	61.5	47	53.4	4,577.51	1,521	3.01
Pennsylvania	456	320	70.2	154	48.1	25,346.31	7,446	3.40
Rhode Island	50	34	68.0	17	50.0	3,728.23	594	6.28
South Carolina	91	52	57.1	29	55.8	4,028.80	1,184	3.40
South Dakota	57	40	70.2	15	37.5	1,868.00	987	1.89
Tennessee	135	79	58.5	29	36.7	3,753.30	1,843	2.04
Texas	577	292	50.6	130	44.5	20,906.81	10,925	1.91
Utah	74	41	55.4	18	43.9	1,579.73	888	
Vermont	53	31	58.5	9	29.03	1,853.17	612	3.03
Virginia	237	169	71.3	85	50.3	12,313.31	3,583	1.78
Washington	295	204	69.2	96	47.1	14,446.50	3,612	4.00
West Virginia	77	48	62.3	24	50.0	4,369.34	852	5.13
Wisconsin	331	187	56.5	54	28.9	9,548.31	3,931	2.43
Wyoming	27	16	59.3	4	25.0	889.55	258	3.45
Commonwealth of P.R.	52	28	53.8	12	42.8	1,522.40	977	1.56
Canal Zone	3	2	66.7	2	100.0	475.00	78	6.09
Bahama Islands	5	-	-	-	-	-	68	-
Virgin Islands of U.S.	4	3	75.0	2	66.7	245.00	55	4.45
Total for U.S.	12,869	7,686	59.7%	3,108	40.4%	\$555,567.73	225,911	\$ 2.46

CANADA								
	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alberta	203	111	54.7	9	8.1	\$ 5,795.79	1,942	\$ 2.98
Atlantic Provinces								
New Brunswick	61	38	62.3	8	21.1	1,737.68	745	2.33
Newfoundland	23	9	39.1	-	-	431.32	196	2.20
Nova Scotia	84	43	51.2	9	20.9	2,077.06	910	2.28
Prince Ed. Is.	26	13	50.0	3	23.1	942.98	349	2.70
British Columbia	289	174	60.2	39	22.4	13,411.94	3,468	3.87
Manitoba	83	47	55.3	10	21.3	3,892.28	1,725	2.26
N.W. Territories	8	-	-	-	-	119.23	53	2.25
Ontario	572	352	61.5	151	42.9	32,836.43	8,693	3.78
Quebec	628	358	57.0	147	41.1	13,794.30	15,248	.90
Saskatchewan	142	88	62.0	10	11.4	5,359.51	1,696	3.16
Yukon Terr.	3	-	-	-	-	-	66	-
TOTAL for CANADA	2,122	1,233	58.1%	386	31.3%	\$ 80,398.52	35,091	\$ 2.29
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	14,991	8,919	59.4%	3,494	39.2%	\$635,966.25	261,002	\$ 2.44

FOREIGN & OTHER								
	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Foreign						4,186.84		
World Hello						59.00		
International Doctors						300.00		
Hospital Groups						3,194.04		
Prison Groups						348.56		
Internationalists						686.02		
Amateur Radio						10.00		
GRAND TOTAL						\$644,750.71		

GROUP CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1973 — 1972								
	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
U.S.A. 1973	12,869	7,686	59.7%	3,108	40.4%	\$555,567.73	225,911	\$ 2.46
U.S.A. 1972	12,137	7,227	59.5	2,806	38.8	486,117.24	211,686	2.30
Increase (Decrease)	732	459	0.2%	302	1.6%	69,450.49	14,225	.16
Canada 1973	2,122	1,233	58.1%	386	31.3%	\$ 80,398.52	35,091	\$ 2.29
Canada 1972	2,031	1,213	59.7	357	29.4	71,709.31	32,740	2.19
Increase (Decrease)	91	40	(1.6)%	29	1.9%	\$ 8,689.21	2,351	\$.10
U.S. & Canada 1973	14,991	8,919	59.4%	3,494	39.2%	\$635,966.25	261,002	\$ 2.44
U.S. & Canada 1972	14,168	8,440	59.6	3,163	37.5	557,826.55	244,226	2.28
Increase (Decrease)	823	479	(0.2)%	331	1.7%	\$ 78,139.70	16,776	\$ 0.16

1974 Conference Members*

Trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine Staffs

NONALCOHOLIC (Class A) TRUSTEES

JOHN L. NORRIS, M.D. (Box 251, New London, N.H. 03257), is chairman of the General Service Board, the General Service Conference, and the Long-Range Planning Committee, and a member of the trustees' Nominating Committee. He was elected to the board in January 1951. Before his retirement, "Dr. Jack" was associate medical director of Eastman Kodak Co., Rochester, N.Y. He is former chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism and former president of the Industrial Medicine Association and the American Academy of Occupational Medicine.

JOHN D. BEALER, M.D. (3639 Emerson Circle, Bethlehem, Pa. 18017), elected to the board in April 1971, is assistant medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corp. He has long been interested in the problem of alcoholism in industry and is a member of the American Medical Society on Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism. Dr. John serves on the trustees' Policy and Financial Committees and on the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

*****TRAVIS E. DANCEY, M.D.** (6550 Sherbrooke St. W., Apt. 1612, Montreal 261, Que., Canada), was elected to the board in January 1965. Before his partial retirement, Dr. Dancey was chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital. Now he is senior psychiatrist at Montreal General Hospital and associate professor at McGill University. A good friend of the Fellowship since the formation of the first A.A. group in Quebec, he is the first nonalcoholic trustee from Canada. Dr. Dancey serves on the trustees' Policy Committee and Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

VINCENT P. DOLE, M.D. (Rockefeller University, 66th St. and York Ave., New York, N.Y. 10021), was elected to the board in April 1965. He is a professor and senior physician at the Rockefeller Institute Hospital. Dr. Dole developed a method used in treatment of narcotic addiction; he is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves on the trustees' Policy Committee.

AUSTIN H. MacCORMICK (Osborne Association, 114 E. 30th St., New York, N.Y. 10016) is 1st vice-chairman of the General Service Board; was elected to the board in April 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the board previously from October 1949 to April 1951. He left in 1951 to become professor of criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as executive director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a member of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate and Editorial Boards, chairman of the trustees' Institutions Committee, and a member of the Nominating Committee.

MILTON A. MAXWELL, Ph.D. (86 Mitchell Ave., Piscataway, N.J. 08854), was elected to the board in April 1971. He is professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. From 1965 through 1973, he was also executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies. For 18 years prior to that, he was on the faculty of Washington State University, Pullman. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics, and A.A. He serves on the Policy, Archives, and Long-Range Planning Committees.

ARTHUR J. MILES (Dime Savings Bank of New York, Fulton St. and DeKalb Ave., Brooklyn, N.Y. 11201) was elected to the board in April 1970. He is a senior vice-president and treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of New York and on the Board of Trustees of the American Institute of Banking and the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. He resides in Floral Park, L.I., with his wife and two children; serves as chairman of the trustees' Finance and Employee Retirement Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (Class B) TRUSTEES

RALPH W. AHRINGER (73 Plymouth Dr. N., Glen Head, N.Y. 11545), elected to the board in April 1971, is chairman and president of the Grapevine Corporate Board and a member of the Nominating, Literature, and Policy Committees. Ralph had his last drink in 1954. He is a former delegate (Panel 13), former chairman and treasurer of the Southeastern New York General Service Committee, and former president of New York Intergroup. He is advertising manager of Sabin Robbins Paper Co.

JUNIOR H. ANDERSON (31 LaSalle Rd., Needham Heights, Mass. 02194) was elected as regional trustee in 1972 from the Northeast region. He has been sober 15 years and active in group and area A.A., including service as delegate (Panel 19). Junior is sales representative in the Boston district office of the Otis Elevator Company. He is married, with four daughters. He serves as chairman of the Nominating Committee, and is a member of the Policy and Convention Committees.

DONALD G. AUSTIN (P.O. Drawer #1, Chappell Hill Farm, Chappell Hill, Tex. 77426) was elected to the board from the Southwest region in April 1971. Don had his last drink in 1953. He is a former chairman of the Texas State A.A. Convention. He is also chairman of the Texas Commission on Alcoholism and a member of the board of the Houston Council on Alcoholism. Don serves on the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community and Policy, Finance, Institutions, and Convention Committees.

MARGARET J. CARLSON (218 Regency Park Drive, Regency Park Apts., Agawam, Mass. 01001) was elected to the board as a general service trustee, U.S., in April 1973. She has had continuous sobriety since February 1959 and is interested in P.I. and general service activities. Margaret is a former delegate (Panel 20) and was area delegate chairman in 1971. She is currently a member of the Executive Committee of the Springfield Alcoholism Coalition. Margaret is a member of the Policy and Literature Committees and chairman of the Conference Subcommittee.

**** DAVID T. COOKE** (229 Dublin Rd., Raleigh, N.C. 27609) was elected in 1974 as Southeastern U.S. regional trustee for a three-year term. Dave had his last drink in 1957, began Third Legacy work as G.S.R., and in 1965 became area committee member and officer. He was Conference delegate in 1967-68. Dave served as chairman of his state committee in 1969-70 and has served on his state governor's Advisory Council on Alcoholism. Married, he has been a high-school teacher and is now a highway engineer for a state department.

GEORGE N. GORDON, Ph.D. (110-15 71 Rd., Forest Hills, N.Y. 11375), was elected a director of the A.A. Grapevine in 1969 and has served as its treasurer since 1970. Since his last drink, in 1964, he has served his local group in most offices and the New York Intergroup Association on several committees. He is director of the Communications Center at Hofstra University in Hempstead, N.Y. and author or co-author of 13 nonfiction books, 11 of them written after joining A.A. George is a member of the Finance Committee in the capacity of Grapevine treasurer, a member of the Literature, Policy, Long-Range Planning, and Employee Retirement Committees, and chairman of the Archives Committee.

THOMAS D. GRAFTON (#1 Iroquois Bay, St. Boniface 6, Man., Canada) was elected to the board as general service trustee, Canada, in April 1971. He had his last drink in 1960 and is a former delegate (Panel 18) from Manitoba and former chairman of the Manitoba General Service

ROSTERS

Committee. A member of the legal firm of Grafton and Co., Tom is also a member of the Canadian Bar Association. He serves as a member of the Policy, Institutions, Nominating, and Conference Committees.

JAMES G. GRIFFIN (302 S. Jefferson, North Platte, Nebr. 69101) was elected trustee from the West Central region April 1972. He has been sober 20 years and has served as G.S.R., committee member, chairman of the state committee, and delegate (Panel 18). He is married, owns and pilots his own plane, and has had a successful career for 16 years in the insurance business. He is a member of the Policy, Literature, and Convention Committees.

*****GEORGE GRIMSTAD** (3801 N. 51st Ave., Phoenix, Ariz. 85031) was elected to the board from the Pacific region in April 1971. George was a delegate (Panel 11) from Chicago, Ill., before moving to Arizona. He was one of the founders of the general service committee and intergroup in Chicago, and had his last drink in 1950. He is coordinator for the A.S.A.P. program at St. Luke's Hospital, Phoenix, and a director for Northern Arizona Recovery Centers. He serves on the trustees' Policy, Institutions, and Nominating Committees.

*****ROBERT MACPHERSON** (Rocktree Apts., P.O. Box 192, Pleasant Valley, Conn. 06063) was elected to the board in July 1973. He had his last drink in 1947 and has been an active member of the same group since 1949. Bob was a member of the first Connecticut General Service Assembly in 1951 and a Panel 9 delegate. His business life was in office management and accounting. Bob is married and retired, with a small accounting and tax practice. He serves on the Policy, Finance, and Employee Retirement Committees, and is chairman of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

*****JACK R. MEAGHER** (1015 Whites Rd., Kalamazoo, Mich. 49001) was elected to the board from the East Central region in April 1971. He had his last drink in 1949. A former delegate (Panel 6) from Western Michigan, Jack also served as chairman of the state conference and Western Michigan General Service Committee. He is director of the Computer Center and is professor of Computer Science and Mathematics at Western Michigan University. Jack serves on the Finance, Policy, and Conference Committees.

*****TOM W. MOORE** (Box 458, Pulaski, Tenn. 38478) was elected to the board in April 1971, from the Southeast region. He had his last drink in 1950. He is a former delegate (Panel 18). A lawyer, Tom is senior partner of his firm and past president of the county Bar Association. Tom currently serves on the Nominating Committee and is co-chairman of the Policy and Institutions Committees.

WALTER J. MURPHY (401 E. 81st St., New York, N.Y. 10028) was elected general service trustee in 1973. He has been active in A.A. for 14 years. He is currently chairman of A.A.W.S. and the Public Information Committee and is a member of the Nominating, Policy, and Employee Retirement Committees. He is on the Advisory Council to the New York City Bureau on Alcoholism and is public relations counsel for N.C.A., its New York City affiliate, the Smithers Alcoholism Center, and A.D.P.A. He is married and has one son.

*****MATT NEWELL** (1014 Prospect Ave. S.W., Calgary 3, Alta., Canada) was elected as regional trustee from Western Canada in 1972. He has been sober 22 years. In 1950, he started the first group in Chadron, Nebr. He is a past provincial secretary. He is president of Spruce Oils, Ltd., and is married. He serves on the Policy and Convention Committees and Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

*****TERRANCE PENTON** (132 28th St., Brandon, Man.) was elected in 1974 to serve the last two years of retiring Matt Newell's unexpired term as regional trustee for Western Canada. Then sober 14 years, Terry served on roundup and area G.S. committees and as Conference delegate (Panel 20). He has chaired the advisory committee of his provincial alcoholism foundation. A chartered life underwriter for 24 years, Terry is married and owns an estate-planning consulting firm.

*****ROBERT ROY** (75 Marengere St., Apt. 6, Hull, Que., Canada) was elected in April 1971, from Eastern Canada. He had his last drink in 1959. A former delegate (Panel 14), Bob is co-founder of *La Vigne*, a

***New trustee

***Retiring as of April 1974

French-language publication for A.A.'s, and was chairman of the Quebec General Service Committee and secretary of Montreal Intergroup. He is an auditor with the government of Canada. Bob serves on the Policy, Finance, Literature, and Convention Committees.

****PETER A. G. WATTERS** (Box 384, Oakville, Ont.) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1974. Pete has been sober since 1960. He was chairman of Toronto Intergroup 1965-66, Conference delegate 1967-68, and chairman of the Ontario G.S. Committee. He has been on advisory committees to local recovery and addiction-research facilities. Single, Pete is vice-president and owner of an educational products distributorship.

****R. BRUCE WIGHT** (2336 North Lewis Ave., Waukegan, Ill. 60085) was elected in 1974 to a three-year term as East Central U.S. regional trustee. Bruce had his last drink in 1951. He was Conference delegate on Panel 14, and is still on his area G.S. committee. He serves on his county mental health advisory board. Bruce has had extensive military and business experience, and is president of a manufacturing corporation. His wife, Helen, is also in A.A.

****STANLEY R. WILSEY** (110 Toyon Drive, Fairfax, Calif. 94930) had been sober 23 years when elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1974. Stan has been a Conference delegate and editor of *Good News*, local A.A. newspaper, and was advisory co-chairman of the 1960 International A.A. Convention in Long Beach. Married, Stan has had experience in the food, insurance, and auto businesses and as a police official. He now supervises investigation for a state department concerned with registration of vehicles and the licensing of drivers.

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1974 Conference Committees

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Conference Report & Charter

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1974 Final Conference Report

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What Do Panel Numbers Mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 24th Conference is made up of Panel 23 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 24 (new delegates).

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(23) Gerald Hicks, 307 E. Mountain Avenue, Jacksonville, Alabama 36265

(24) Jo Hadju, Box 627, Kodiak, Alaska 99615

(24) Wesley T. Smith, 3022 West Glenrosa, Phoenix, Arizona 85017

(23) Anna Koerner, 2326 Louisiana Street, Little Rock, Arkansas 72206

(23) Southern - David Hall, 309 S. Alexandria Avenue, Los Angeles, California 90020

(23) Northern Coastal - Merle Garth, 350 Laurel Avenue, Millbrae, California 94030

(24) Northern Interior - Jack Barnes, 1117 El Terino Avenue, Modesto, California 95350

(24) San Diego - Margi Blake, P.O. Box 719, Oceanside, California 92054

(24) Mid-Southern - Genevieve R. Leher, P.O. Box 3134, Torrance, California 90510

(23) Don Pross - 2512 S. University Boulevard, Apt. 211, Denver, Colorado 80210

(23) John Collins, P.O. Box 289, Westport, Connecticut 06880

(24) Clayton Hocker, Ocean View, Delaware 19970

(23) John Waterfield, 2900 Adams Hill Road N.W., Washington, D.C. 20009

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(23) H. J. (Pete) Peterson, 918 Koloa Street, Honolulu, Hawaii 96816

(24) Donald E. Browns, 318 N. Fifth, Payette, Idaho 83661

Note: John L. Norris, M.D., and Robert E. Hitchins are ex-officio members of all committees.

Conference Area Delegates

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
ILLINOIS	(23) Chicago – Norm Adams, 3310 Grant, Evanston, Illinois 60201	MISSOURI	(23) Western – Lucille Thompson, 108 W. 6th, Route #1, Ulrich, Missouri 64788
	(24) Northern – Hank Skees, 7828 40th Avenue, Kenosha, Wisconsin 53140	MONTANA	(24) Wayne Bramble, 620 Grand Avenue, Billings, Montana 59102
	(23) *Southern – John Neal, Box 68, Louisville, Illinois 82858	NEBRASKA	(24) Neal Boeshart, 104 Hillcrest Avenue, Laurel, Nebraska 68745
INDIANA	(23) Northern – Jim Shell, 3512 Harvester Avenue, Fort Wayne, Indiana 46803	NEVADA	(23) Bob Horrigan, Box 443, Sparks, Nevada 89431
	(24) Southern – Don Wenning, 324 E. North Street, Greensburg, Indiana 47240	NEW HAMPSHIRE	(24) Pete Charland, 45 Clover Lane, Portsmouth, New Hampshire 03801
IOWA	(23) Laurence (Van) Van Note, Route #1, Blairs Ferry Road, Marion, Iowa 52302	NEW JERSEY	(23) Northern – Marge Raven, 278 Parker Avenue, Hackensack, New Jersey 07602
KANSAS	(24) Clyde Jones, Box 454, Coffeyville, Kansas 67337		(24) Southern – Noel LeClair, 157 Cooper Avenue, Woodlynne, New Jersey 08107
KENTUCKY	(24) Richard (Mick) McFarland – 1903 Payne Street, Louisville, Kentucky 40206	NEW MEXICO	(24) Lorraine Schall, 4212 Constitution, N.E., Albuquerque, New Mexico 87110
LOUISIANA	(23) Travis Howard, 100 Rogers Road, West Monroe, Louisiana 71281	NEW YORK	(23) Central – Lawrence (Larry) Jewell, 171 Robinson Street, Binghamton, New York 13904
MAINE	(24) Carlton Mendell, Box 1861, Portland, Maine 04104		(24) Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire – Arthur (Tiny) Donaldson, Box 247, R.D. 2, Catskill, New York 12414
MARYLAND	(24) Tom Shoemaker – 482 Mirable Lane, Baltimore, Maryland 21224		(23) Southeastern – Ruth K. Hartshorn, 190-18 89th Avenue, Hollis, New York 11423
MASSACHUSETTS	(23) Eastern – Donald Santry, 99 Pioneer Avenue, Brockton, Massachusetts 02401		(24) Western – James McCartin, 82 Collette, Cheektowaga, New York 14225
	(24) Western – Robert Tetrault, 266 Centre Street, Indian Orchard, Massachusetts 01051		
MICHIGAN	(23) Central – William H. Hamlin, 1410 W. Jackson Avenue, Flint, Michigan 48504	NORTH CAROLINA	(23) Zeb Mauney, P.O. Box 306, Newport, North Carolina 28570
	(23) Southeastern – William (Gus) A. Jenkins, 11011 Hudson Street, Warren, Michigan 48089	NORTH DAKOTA	(24) Fred Blair, 2515 S. 10, Grand Forks, North Dakota 58201
	(24) Western – Pete Slager, Box 211, Montague, Michigan 49437	OHIO	(23) Central & Southeastern – Lowell E. Beaty, 129 West North Street, Worthington, Ohio 43085
MINNESOTA	(24) Northern – Gordon B. Hagen, 214 E. Cedar Street, Fergus Falls, Minnesota 56537		(23) Northeastern – John Baker, 23747 Vincent Drive, North Olmsted, Ohio 44070
	(23) Southern – Earl Lietzau, 520 S. Jefferson, New Ulm, Minnesota 56073		(24) N. W. Ohio/S. E. Michigan – Chuck Sherrer, 1704 Mulberry Street, Toledo, Ohio 43608
MISSISSIPPI	(24) Nancy Rushing, 2833 14th Place, Meridian, Mississippi 39301		(24) S.S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky – Roy Homer, 4560 Walton Creek Road, Cincinnati, Ohio 45243
MISSOURI	(23) Eastern – Paul Cavanaugh, 201 Pralle Lane, St. Charles, Missouri 63301	OKLAHOMA	(23) Wilson F. Pruitt, 721 N.W. 15th Street, Oklahoma City, Oklahoma 73103

*ALTERNATE DELEGATE

Delegates (continued)

STATE	PANEL	CANADA	PANEL
OREGON	(24) Howard Smith, 2719 S.E. 60th Avenue, Portland, Oregon 97206	PROVINCE	
PENNSYLVANIA	(23) Eastern - Joseph De Beaumont, 1736 Prospect Avenue, Croydon, Pennsylvania 19020	ALBERTA	(24) Bill Leicht, Box 274, Innisfail, Alberta, Canada
	(23) Western - Francis Flack, 1426 Wakefield Drive, Sharpsville, Pennsylvania 16150	BRITISH COLUMBIA/ YUKON	(23) Al Bennett, 2032 Melville Street, Sidney, British Columbia, Canada
RHODE ISLAND	(24) Dorothy Gadoury, 45 East Shore Drive, Apt. 1, Coventry, Rhode Island 02816	MANITOBA	(24) Reeta Hourie, 494 Main Street, Selkirk, Manitoba, Canada R1A 1W3
SOUTH CAROLINA	(24) Peggy Busch, 1212 Hahn Street, Aiken, South Carolina 29801	NEW BRUNSWICK/ PRINCE EDWARD ISLAND	(24) Eddie MacInnis, Box 1444, Charlottetown, Prince Edward Island, Canada
SOUTH DAKOTA	(24) Horton Stoakes, 302 N. Sherman Avenue, Sioux Falls, South Dakota 57103	NOVA SCOTIA/NEW- FOUNDLAND/ LABRADOR	(23) Allister (Al) MacRae, Box 1043, Sydney, Nova Scotia, Canada B1P 6J7
TENNESSEE	(24) Joe J. Mulloy, P.O. Box 2763, Nashville, Tennessee 37219	ONTARIO	(23) Eastern - Charles Parks, 1071 Ambleside Drive, Apt. 1212, Ottawa, Ontario, Canada K2B 6V4
TEXAS	(23) Northeastern - Patrick Mullarkey, 3138 Valley Meadow #151, Dallas, Texas 75220		(23) Northeastern - Bob Fournier, 91 Elmhurst Avenue, Sudbury, Ontario, Canada
	(24) Northwestern - Brian Gilmore, 2508 62nd Street, Lubbock, Texas 79413		(23) Northwestern - Murray Slaton, 535 S. Vickers Street, Thunder Bay, Ontario, Canada
	(23) Southeastern - Don Angelloz, 4145 Casan, Houston, Texas 77005		(24) Western - Duncan McArthur, 337 Dunlop Crescent, Burlington, Ontario, Canada
	(24) Southwestern - Tony Fowler, 1609 N. Laurent, Victoria, Texas 77901	QUEBEC	(24) Southwestern - Louis Geoffrion, 327 Stuart, Outremont, Quebec, Canada
UTAH	(23) *Ike Bowers, 5072 El Amador, Salt Lake City, Utah 84117		(23) Southeastern - Marcel Lainesse, 32 John Cannon Street, Arthabaska, Quebec, Canada
VERMONT	(24) Don Dusha, P.O. Box 175, East Arlington, Vermont 05252		(24)**Northeastern - Julie Prince, 1110 Chemin Ste. Foy, Quebec, Quebec, Canada
VIRGINIA	(23) Fred Calvert, 1013 Five Forks Road, Virginia Beach, Virginia 23455		(24) Northwestern - Clarence Gauthier, 10 Jolly Street, Ste. Therese West, Quebec, Canada
WASHINGTON	(23) Ted Knightlinger, 2501 N. Junette, Tacoma, Washington 98406	SASKATCHEWAN	(24) W. G. (Bill) Davis, 616 20th Street West, Prince Albert, Saskatchewan, Canada S6V 4H3
WEST VIRGINIA	(23) George Ellison, 6 Granview Drive, Charleston, West Virginia 25302		
WISCONSIN	(24) N. Wisconsin/Upper Michigan - Paul Slatky, 1132 13th Avenue, Green Bay, Wisconsin 54304		
	(23) Southern - Virginia Hallman, 4304 North Alpine Avenue, Shorewood, Wisconsin 53211		
WYOMING	(24) Sam Leckie, Box 592, Rock Springs, Wyoming 82901		
PUERTO RICO	(24) Trinidad Rivera Chevere, 1102 14th N.E. Street, Puerto Nuevo, Puerto Rico 00920		

***Province reorganized (1974) into four areas. Northeastern area delegate serving one year (1974) only. Delegate elected to 1975 Conference will be Panel 25 and serve full term, enabling province to have two delegates on each panel.*

*ALTERNATE DELEGATE

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